WEDNESDAY, JUNE 24, 2026

The Indian EXPRESS

JOURNALISM of COURAGE

NEW DELHI, LATE CITY, 20 PAGES

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MINISTRY OF
PORTS, SHIPPING
AND WATERWAYS
Government of India

सत्यमेव जयते

12 YEARS OF MARITIME TRANSFORMATION

SAGAR SE SAMRIDDHI JALMARG SE VIKAS

A nation shaped by its waters, rising towards a bold new future

"We Indians are the inheritors of a glorious maritime heritage, and it is the endeavour of our Government to restore India's position of eminence in the global maritime sector.

~ **Narendra Modi,** Prime Minister

12 YEARS BY THE NUMBERS

1,668 MMT — Total cargo handled at Indian ports, a 59% rise from 1,052 MMT

2,818 MMT — Total port capacity, an 81% rise from 1,561 MMT

218 MMT — Cargo on national waterways, a 652% rise from just 29 MMT

3.23 LAKH — Indian seafarers deployed globally, up 155% from 1.27 lakh. Women seafarers grew 340%

₹26,583 CR — Major port annual revenue, up 126% from ₹11,760 Cr

India — World No. 1 in Ship Recycling
Maritime India Vision 2030 target achieved five years ahead of schedule

PILLARS OF TRANSFORMATION

PORTS
BIGGER & SMARTER

- **₹15,000 Cr** Annual maritime CAPEX, up 362% since 2014.
- PPP investment alone surged 836% to **₹8,000 Cr.**
- Coastal cargo more than doubled, from **74 to 177 MMT.**

WATERWAYS
A REVOLUTION UNDERWAY

- **111 National Waterways** notified, up from 5 in 2014.
- Operational waterways grew from **3 to 32.**
- Over **10 crore** passengers now travel by inland waterways every year.

SHIPBUILDING
RISING TO THE WORLD STAGE

- Mega Shipbuilding push: ~ **₹70,000 Cr**
- **New dry dock** at Cochin Shipyard inaugurated 2024.
- Domestic fleet acquisition plan: 437 vessels worth **₹2.2 lakh Cr.**

GREEN TRANSITION
CLEANER SEAS, CLEANER RIVERS

- Renewable energy use at major ports **up 30x** since 2014.
- **India's first hydrogen-powered ferry** launched at Varanasi, December 2025
- **Green Tug Transition Programme** targets zero-emission tugs at all major ports by 2040.

LANDMARK PROJECTS

- **Jal Marg Vikas Project —** Transforming NW-1 from Haldia to Varanasi, ₹5,061 Cr
- **Jogighopa IWT Terminal, Assam —** New gateway for Northeast India's trade corridor
- **Mumbai Marina —** 424 yacht berths, ₹887 Cr, India's first world-class marina, 2028
- **Vadhvan Port, Maharashtra** — India's future largest container port, ₹76,000 Cr investment
- **National Maritime Heritage Complex, Lothal —** Envisioned as the world's largest maritime museum
- **Tuna Tekra Container Terminal, Gujarat —** 2.19 million TEU annual capacity

REFORMS & MILESTONES

- **3 Indian ports in Global Top 30** — 7 in Global Top 100 (World Bank Container Port Performance Index 2025)
- **Sagarmala Programme** — 7,100+ km of port connectivity infrastructure across India
- **11 landmark Acts enacted** — including the Merchant Shipping Act 2025 and Indian Ports Act 2025, replacing colonial-era laws
- **One Nation One Port Process** — Over 39% reduction in documentation transactions at all 12 major ports
- **Sea cruise passengers up 328%** — from 1.08 lakh to 4.62 lakh
- **Maritime Amrit Kaal Vision 2047** — 300+ initiatives targeting 10,000 MMTPA port capacity

12 Saal Vishwas ke, Vikas ke, Jan-kalyan ke

Propelling India's Vikas Yatra through Maritime Excellence

www.shipmin.gov.in
Maritime India Vision 2030 | Maritime Amrit Kaal Vision 2047 | Sagarmala Programme

THE INDIAN EXPRESS

The World

WEDNESDAY, JUNE 24, 2026

TRUMP SAYS UNFROZEN IRANIAN ASSETS WILL BE USED TO BUY MEDICINE AND FOOD FROM THE U.S.

Tehran agreed to n-inspections into 'infinity', says Trump; Iran denies

Iran's missiles are not in the agreement, and 'will never be', says Pezeshkian

Reuters
Dubai, Islamabad, June 23

US PRESIDENT Donald Trump said on Tuesday Iran had agreed to nuclear inspections into "infinity", despite Tehran's denials, and that unfrozen Iranian assets would be used to buy humanitarian supplies from the US.

Washington agreed to waive sanctions on Iran for 60 days from Monday after the first round of talks under a nascent peace deal.

US Vice President J D Vance said the talks with Iranian officials in Buergenstock laid a good foundation for a final accord and that Tehran had agreed to allow nuclear inspectors back into the country.

But Iran denied it had begun discussions on its nuclear programme at the talks, mediated by Qatar and Pakistan, and said it had not agreed to invite back IAEA inspectors.

At a joint press conference on Tuesday with Pakistan PM in Islamabad, Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian said Iran's missiles were not in the MoU and "will never be".

Iran will never negotiate its defence capabilities with any country and believes strongly that regional peace and stability can only be reached through honest discussions and intraregional cooperation, Pezeshkian added.

Foreign Ministry spokesperson Esmail Baghaei said on Tuesday Iranian officials had not held a meeting with IAEA chief Rafael Grossi in Switzerland and had no plans for IAEA to inspect Iran's damaged nuclear facilities.

Trump hit back Tuesday at what he said were Iran's "protestations and false statements".

"Iran has fully and completely agreed to highest level Nuclear inspections long into the future (Infinity!!!)," Trump said in a post on Truth Social.

He also said any Iranian assets unfrozen under the deal would be placed in an escrow account and used to buy food and medical supplies from the US "including Corn, Wheat, and Soybeans from our great American Farmers".

Earlier in the day, Iran's ambassador to the UN, Ali Bahreini, denied there had been any such agreement. "Iran is the only country to decide what to do with its assets, which are going to be defrozen, and so I reject any claim about that if there would be any role for any other country to have an influence on those decisions or on those processes," Bahreini told reporters.

The conflicting statements highlighted the uncertainty facing efforts to halt a war that has upended the Middle East.

Bahreini said "good progress" had been made in the talks and that two working groups would be established in coming days to focus on the removal of sanctions and Iran's nuclear activities.

He told reporters five parts of the initial deal need to be fully implemented before negotiations begin on the nuclear dossier and any role for the IAEA.

The ambassador said Lebanon was an "unquestionable" part of the interim accord and that it included the withdrawal of Israeli troops from Lebanon.

Israel and Lebanon began a new round of talks in Washington Tuesday, with Beirut determined to press ahead with direct negotiations even as they appear to be overshadowed by Iran's decision to make Lebanon part of its talks with the US. Lebanon's presidency said Vance and Secretary of State Marco Rubio told Lebanese President Joseph Aoun in a call that Washington was following up on agreements reached, including plans to establish a joint cell comprising the US, Lebanon and Iran to help consolidate Lebanon ceasefire and monitor implementation of related steps. **REUTERS**

Displaced residents drive back to their villages following a ceasefire between Israel and Hezbollah in Rmayleh in Lebanon, Tuesday. AP

Won't allow Iran to charge tolls in Hormuz: Rubio

Plan underway to evacuate seafarers stranded in the Gulf, says UN agency

Reuters
Washington, London, June 23

US SECRETARY of State Marco Rubio said on Tuesday that Iran would not be able to charge tolls in the Strait of Hormuz as part of any final agreement with the US while United Nations' shipping agency said on Tuesday an evacuation plan to enable hundreds of ships with some 11,000 seafarers stranded in the Gulf to sail through the Strait of Hormuz is underway.

Rubio said that an arrangement of charging tolls, if allowed, would be contrary to international law.

Without providing a timeframe, a spokesperson with the UN's International Maritime Organization (IMO) said, "We have now started contacting the ships to start the evacuation."

"This large-scale operation will be carried out in close cooperation with Iran, Oman, all other coastal states in the region, the US and the maritime industry," IMO Secretary-General Arsenio Dominguez said in a statement.

The evacuation process under the IMO plan will be phased due to the "elevated risk of collision in the current environment", Oman's defence ministry said in an advisory. The Omani ministry said the so-called Traffic Separation Scheme was "not safe for use at this time" and two temporary routes to the north and south of the scheme could be used for evacuation.

"Vessels will be contacted individually and advised of their allocated transit day by the parties coordinated by IMO," the ministry advisory said.

Andy Burnham prepares for UK Labour leadership contest

Jill Lawless
London, June 23

ANDY BURNHAM, Britain's newest lawmaker and likely its next prime minister, was meeting Labour colleagues on Tuesday in preparation for a leadership contest in which he may be the only contender.

Burnham is the strong front-runner to replace PM Keir Starmer, who announced Monday that he will step down within weeks after two years in office marred by missteps and judgment errors that eroded his standing with party and public.

Burnham, a former Cabinet minister who served since 2017 as mayor of Greater Manchester, won a special election last week for a seat in Parliament with the express aim of challenging Starmer for the leadership. Burnham's chances got a big boost on Monday when former Health Secretary Wes Streeting, who was considered his main rival, announced his support.

If Andy Burnham is the only contender, he could be the Prime Minister by July 17. AP

Nominations for the Labour leadership will open July 9 and close a week later. If Burnham is the only contender, he could be the PM by July 17. If there is a contest, the winner should be in place by the time Parliament returns from its summer break on September 1.

Burnham was a popular mayor of Manchester, overseeing a period of rapid regeneration and has pledged to repeat his signature brand of "Manchesterism" on a national scale. Many Labour members hope Burnham's people skills and charisma can connect with the public more than the stolid, managerial Starmer could ever do. But his policies in many areas are unknown and untested. Some Labour lawmakers want to see a party election contest where he would face public debate and scrutiny.

Burnham is expected to make a speech next week outlining some of his economic plans. Former Armed Forces Minister Al Carns, who quit this month to protest what he saw as inadequate defense spending, said "we need to have a clear and concise discussion about what this country wants to be." He has suggested he might run for leadership but told broadcaster ITV that "I'm not ready to make a decision on this in any way, shape or form."

Others have suggested Darren Jones, a senior Cabinet minister and Starmer ally, should run, though he has yet to comment. **AP**

People cool off at Trocadero Fountain next to the Eiffel Tower. REUTERS

40 drown in France as people in Europe seek relief from heatwave

Sudip Kar-Gupta & Emma Pinedo
Paris, Madrid, June 23

FORTY PEOPLE have drowned in France over recent days as they sought to cool down to escape record heat, the PM said on Tuesday, as a heatwave swept across much of Europe.

Britain, Italy, Switzerland and Spain were also sweltering in extreme heat, with record temperatures in some regions disrupting schools and transport networks. Europe is warming at more than twice the global average, according to the World Meteorological Organization, making such prolonged heat episodes increasingly likely.

Meteo France said temperatures of up to 43 C expected in some parts of western France. The country has just recorded its hottest afternoon and night since records began in 1947. Fifty-four departments are under red alert in what forecasters said was unprecedented.

Across France, people have been jumping into canals and rivers to cool off, but French Sports Minister Marina Ferrari warned against swimming in unauthorized or dangerous areas. French PM Sebastien Lecornu said: "A sad scourge when it comes to drownings, as the latest figures just reported to us show 40 deaths since June 18, most of them young people."

Europe's heatwave is driven by a weather pattern known as an Omega block — shape of the Greek letter — with a bulge of hot air in the middle and cooler air either side, allowing temperatures to build day after day. **REUTERS**

Kanishka bombing deadliest attack in Canada's history, says PM Carney

Press Trust of India
Ottawa, June 23

CANADIAN PM Mark Carney on Tuesday described the 1985 Air India Flight 182 Kanishka bombing 41 years ago as the "deadliest attack in our country's history", saying that Canada stands against violent extremism in all its forms.

The explosion on the Montreal-New Delhi Air India 'Kanishka' flight killed all 329 people on board, most of them Canadians of Indian descent.

"The bombing of Air India Flight 182 claimed 329 innocent lives, including 268 Canadians. It remains the deadliest terrorist attack in Canada's history," the PM said in a statement.

"On this National Day of Remembrance for Victims of Terrorism, we honour the victims of Flight 182 and all those who have lost their lives to acts of terrorism and violent extremism," he said.

Carney said that the "legacy of Air India Flight 182 demands remembrance, but also vigilance." "Canada's government is confronting and condemning violent extremism in all its forms, with new legislation to defend the safety and security of Canadians, strengthen our national security institutions, and disrupt terrorist financing. We are supporting frontline community-based intervention programmes and providing security agencies with stronger tools."

Pentagon seeks $80 billion from Congress to pay for Iran war

Associated Press
Washington, June 23

THE PENTAGON has told senators it needs roughly $80 billion, mostly to cover the cost of the US war against Iran, adding to what is already a sizable military spending boost being sought by President Donald Trump.

The White House Office of Management and Budget has yet to make a formal request to Congress. But Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth has been making the rounds on Capitol Hill, including Monday evening. A top deputy defense secretary told senators about the Iran funding request last week, according to two people familiar with the situation.

The Wall Street Journal first reported on the developments.

The push for billions of dollars in Iran war funding comes at a fraught political moment. Lawmakers are skeptical of the deal The White House has requested $1.5 trillion for the Pentagon, a nearly 50% increase over current fiscal year's funding levels.

As Vance leads negotiations with Iran, Trump creates disruptions in his path

The New York Times

AS VICE President J D Vance entered the fifth hour of negotiations with Iranian leaders over the weekend, President Donald Trump weighed in with an ill-timed threat to start bombing again.

If Iranians closed the Strait of Hormuz, Trump told a *Fox News* reporter, the negotiators talking to Vance would never make it back to their country — in fact, they would have no country to return to at all.

For Vance, this was the latest example of his increasingly tricky role as the frontman in the US negotiations with Iran, as Trump repeatedly creates disruptions in his path.

On Monday, Vance said the first round of talks had laid "a successful foundation" for peace. But now, Vance will have to find a way to end a war that he opposed at the start, while navigating his boss's whims and an adversary that has proved itself, at least in part, immune to Trump's threats.

Vice President J D Vance in Switzerland. AP

"What we told the Iranians yesterday is when you guys engage in what us millennials might call trash talk, you can't expect the president of the United States not to respond and not to correct the record," he said Monday at a news conference. "So when they say things that aren't true, the president is going to respond to it."

Both sides have signed an MoU to end hostilities and are now trying to strike a lasting nuclear deal in 60 days. But for Vance, the presumptive favourite for the 2028 Republican nomination, the situation remains politically precarious.

"If it works out, I'm going to take the credit," Trump said of the peace deal last week. "If it doesn't work out, I'm blaming JD." Vance has said the President was joking, but Trump has never shied away from deflecting blame onto others — and how Vance handles future of the negotiations will factor into Republicans' performance in the midterm elections and his future as a potential Trump successor.

Karim Sadjadpour, a senior fellow at the Carnegie Endowment for International Peace, said Vance was in a risky spot. He could get credit for ending an unpopular war, Sadjadpour said. Or he may end up being "viewed as the architect of an American humiliation and a deal that concedes billions of dollars to a committed US adversary."

Making the situation even more difficult, the V-P must depend on the cooperation of Iran's Revolutionary Guard commanders. "That's not an auspicious position for any American politician, let alone an aspiring president," Sadjadpour said.

And even as Americans are clamoring for Trump administration to stop the fighting and bring down energy costs, Sadjadpour argued Americans seem to care more about how wars end. He pointed out that President Joe Biden nose-dived in the polls after the withdrawal of American forces from Afghanistan, during which 13 US service members were killed. "Americans dislike wars, but they dislike defeats even more," he said.

Almost immediately after Vance left Switzerland, the foundation he outlined for a possible longer-term deal started showing cracks. Vance said Iran had agreed to invite IAEA into the country, but Iran said they had made "no new commitments."

Vance also described a potential funding scheme in which Qatar would unfreeze assets for Iranians to use to buy US soy, corn and wheat. Hours later, Trump repeated that idea in the Oval Office and said food for the Iranians was "going to be bought exclusively through the US from our farmers." Iranian officials rejected that idea.

Afghan Taliban hold first, closed-door discussions with EU on deportations

Associated Press
Brussels, June 23

A DELEGATION from the Afghan Taliban met Tuesday with European Union staff in Brussels for closed-door talks that focused on diplomatic services and the "dignified returns" of Afghans to the war-ravaged nation, a Taliban official said.

Afghans make up one of the largest groups of migrants seeking asylum in the EU, but a growing number of governments in the 27-nation bloc want to speed up and increase deportations for those whose claims are rejected or who commit crimes in their host countries. Calling the visit "historic", Abdul Qahar Balkhi, a spokesperson for the Taliban Ministry of Foreign Affairs, said talks focused on "trust-building measures," the Taliban's diplomatic presence in the EU and a "dignified return process."

The Commission said it co-chaired the meet with Sweden and that representatives from 15 of the EU's 27 nations participated. Belgian Foreign Minister Maxime Prévot, "Making a meeting possible in the framework of our host-state policy does not amount to recognition..."

• MATCHMAKERS SAY EMPLOYEES AT SK HYNIX, SAMSUNG ARE BEING RANKED ALONGSIDE DOCTORS, LAWYERS DUE TO HEFTY BONUSES LINKED TO AI EXPANSION

In South Korea, a partner at chipmaking giants is new 'A+' catch

Heekyong Yang, Hyunjoo Jin & Heejung Jung
Seoul, June 23

THE GLOBAL AI boom has turned South Korean chipmaking giants SK Hynix and Samsung Electronics into stock market darlings. It has also thrust their employees into the top tier of the country's highly competitive marriage market.

South Korean matchmaking firms say people working at the firms are now being ranked alongside doctors, lawyers and people from other traditionally elite professions as hefty bonuses linked to the global AI boom create a new class of affluent employees.

Career consultants say job seekers are increasingly going after roles at Samsung and SK Hynix, including high school students, while some cram schools have started courses to help applicants prepare for job interviews at the chip giants.

"If SK Hynix and Samsung Electronics employees used to be classified as B+ or A-grade candidates, today they are closer to A+," said Son Donggyu, chief executive of matchmaking agency Bien Aller.

"Traditionally, A+ candidates would include doctors, lawyers, other highly paid professionals or people from exceptionally wealthy families," Son said. Samsung and SK Hynix employees are in line for generous bonuses as the global AI boom fuels demand for the firms' memory chip products, driving share prices and profits to record highs. SK Hynix revised its bonus structure last year and last month, Samsung struck a pay deal with its union that included performance bonuses of around $416,000 for some chip employees.

Students at Korea University in Seoul. Consultants say job seekers are increasingly going after roles in these companies. REUTERS

"People still prefer traditional professions such as doctors, lawyers and dentists," matchmaking consultant Lee Sung-mi of agency SUNOO said. "But recently, when we introduce someone working at SK Hynix, the reaction is often 'Wow, people like that are here too?'"

"Many of my friends are envious of me," said Jung Sung-chan, 19, a student at Pyeongtaek Meister High School, who got a job offer from Samsung Electronics as a chip facility engineer. "Honestly, even if you go to university first, it is hard to find a job these days. So, I think that might be one of the reasons why this place is becoming more popular recently," he said.

"The competition (to get into Samsung and SK Hynix) has become intense," said Park Jun-young, a former Samsung Electronics employee who now works as a career consultant for university students. "It is almost beginning to resemble the college entrance race itself."

Growing interest from students in a semiconductor engineering degree that Korea University first launched with SK Hynix in 2021 drove the program's admission score to a historic high this academic year, according to data analysed by Jongro Academy. **REUTERS**

• BRIEFLY

THAILAND

Over 5K trapped in Myanmar scam centres

More than 5,300 people are still trapped in online scam centres near Myanmar's Thai border, a human rights group said, over one year after thousands were freed. The Civil Society Network for Human Trafficking Victim Assistance estimates that the people trapped include around 1,600 Chinese nationals, some 200 Burmese, 20 Thais as well as citizens from the Philippines, Taiwan, Malaysia, Brazil, Russia, Kenya, Uganda, Rwanda, and Zimbabwe. **REUTERS**

NEPAL

Nepal's former finance minister held over graft

Nepal's former finance minister Bishnu Prasad Paudel was arrested late on Monday on charges of money laundering, police said, as the country's Gen Z-backed government steps up a crackdown on alleged corruption under previous administrations. Paudel was a key figure in the former K P Sharma Oli government. Police spokesperson Abi Narayan Kafle said Paudel was being brought to Kathmandu and would be handed over to Department of Money Laundering Investigation. **REUTERS**

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Happening today

• **BANGLADESH PM** Tarique Rahman will begin an official visit to China. During the visit, until June 26, Dhaka and Beijing are likely to discuss the Teesta river plan. New Delhi will be keeping a close watch on any announcement on the project.

• **THE BOMBAY HC** is scheduled to hear State of Goa's concluding arguments in its appeal against Tehelka founder editor Tarun Tejpal's acquittal in a rape case by a trial court in 2021.

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Land bought by MP CM's family: Opp Cong seeks his resignation, independent probe

Express News Service
New Delhi, Bhopal, June 23

THE CONGRESS on Tuesday demanded Madhya Pradesh Chief Minister Mohan Yadav's resignation, citing *The Indian Express* investigation on land purchases linked to his family and associated real estate firms. The party also sought a public explanation from the CM and an "independent inquiry" into the issue.

The Indian Express reported on Tuesday that after Yadav took oath as the CM on December 13, 2023, his family and their real estate companies had bought at least 137 plots in

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

EXPRESS investigation

His govt mapped Ujjain's infra push, Madhya Pradesh CM Mohan Yadav, family bought land in prime areas

SINCE HE BECAME MINISTER IN 2021, FAMILY PURCHASES ADD UP TO 253 ACRES

• WHO OWNS HOW MUCH

Don't link CM to extended family

The *Express* report dated June 23

THE EDITORIAL PAGE
IN UJJAIN, A FAMILIAR PLOT, A DISTURBING ABDICATION
PAGE 10

Business as Usual
By EP UNNY

SHIVRAJ HOLDS REVIEW MEETING

Rainfall 43% deficit so far, kharif crops likely to be hit: Govt

Agri ministry flags 111 districts as 'high priority', prepares contingency plans

Harikishan Sharma & Amitabh Sinha
New Delhi, June 23

WITH INDIA staring at a fairly weak monsoon season this year and kharif crops likely to be impacted, the Agriculture Ministry has formulated contingency plans for districts likely to be most affected due to low rainfall, and identified 111 districts with irrigation coverage of 25 per cent or less as 'high priority' needing intervention, Agriculture Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan said on Tuesday.

After chairing a review meeting, held over video conference, with state agriculture ministers, senior officials and district collectors, Chouhan said that 315 districts across the country were likely to be affected due to low monsoon rainfall.

"Of these (315 districts), 111 districts are of high priority, where the irrigation coverage is less than 25 per cent; 76 districts are of medium priority, where 25-50 per cent irrigation is available; 128 districts are of low

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

Agriculture Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan chairs a review meeting at Krishi Bhawan in New Delhi, Tuesday. X/@CHOUHANSHIVRAJ

For farmers, *bajra* crop of choice: Short maturity, low water, fertiliser need

Harish Damodaran
Rewari, Alwar, Dausa, June 23

"I HOPE the monsoon arrives by this month-end. I can sow bajra even it comes by July 15. The problem will be if it's delayed beyond that," says Ramsingh Meena.

The 52-year-old from Jalalpura village in Baijupara tehsil of Rajasthan's Dausa district grows *bajra* or pearl millet on his entire 50-bigha (31 acres) land: "This is the best crop in

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

E. EXPLAINED

Gloomy forecast

The first half of the monsoon (June-July) was supposed to be slightly better this season. But so far, June has been drier than expected. With El Nino gaining in strength, the outlook for the subsequent months is not very bright. June accounts for 19% of the monsoon rains, July contributes 32%.

EXPRESS special

6 yrs before SIT probe, audit firm flagged lack of 'systemic record' of Ram temple donations

Had sought SOP for each level of transaction to fix accountability

Shyamlal Yadav
Ayodhya, June 23

WITHIN MONTHS of the formation of the Shri Ram Janmabhoomi Teerth Kshetra, an audit firm had found its management to be "highly unprofessional" and noted that there was no "systemic record" of donations.

Six years later, the recommendation of the private audit firm that a "Systematic Operating Process (SOP)" be drafted for efficient management is yet to be implemented, even as the temple committee is now facing allegations of misappropriation of donations. A Special Investigation Team submitted its preliminary findings to the Uttar Pradesh government on Tuesday.

In its report submitted in November 2020, the audit firm suggested the "Need to devise SOP of trust for each level of transaction, data management, staff and other resources" to fix responsibility and accountability.

It also noted the unavailability of "systematic record for financial reporting" and said: "(The) Layer of management at the execution level is not defined and highly unprofessional... It will be difficult to control the information and establish fair practice in the present scenario."

A senior official at the firm was contacted, but could not be reached for comment. *The Indian Express* also sent questions to the firm's accountant, Chandan Rai, as well as the trust's

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

India, US start trade talks

Union Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal with United States Trade Representative Jamieson Greer and US Ambassador to India Sergio Gor in New Delhi, Tuesday. ANI EXPLAINED, PAGE 12

2 HELD, ROLE OF 2 PUNJAB POLICE OFFICERS UNDER SCRUTINY

Rs 10 lakh paid to tailor forensic report: Gurgaon police on clip Mann called fake

CM points finger at 'some wrong elements' in Akal Takht, AAP at BJP-ruled Haryana

Varinder Bhatia
Chandigarh, June 23

AMID A raging row in Punjab over an "objectionable" video clip purportedly featuring Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann who has told the Sri Akal Takht that the footage was fake and manipulated, police in Gurgaon have arrested two men following a complaint from a forensic expert that two senior officers of Punjab Police allegedly paid him Rs 10 lakh to tailor a forensic report on the video clip.

The Gurgaon police FIR, which mentions two Punjab officials, names two individuals who have been arrested — Arun Mahendru from Sirsa and

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

Punjab CM Bhagwant Mann has maintained that an actor was used in the clip to defame him

THE BIG PICTURE

VIA LIPULEKH: AT 17,000 FT, A TRADE DOOR OPENS INTO CHINA PAGE 9

Lucknow fire: 10 years ago, building escaped demolition as owner claimed he wasn't heard

Demolition notice issued again: LDA Vice-Chairman

Maulshree Seth
Lucknow, June 23

AN APPLICATION submitted a decade ago by the owner of the Aliganj building that caught fire on Monday, killing 15 people, led to the revocation of a demolition order issued over unauthorised construction, *The Indian Express* has learnt. The owner, in the application, claimed he had not been given an opportunity to present his case before the demolition decision was taken.

Sources told *The Indian Express* that the order withdrawing the demolition proceedings was passed "by the same officer" who had originally ordered the demolition.

Speaking to *The Indian Express*, Lucknow Development Authority (LDA) Vice-Chairman Prathmesh Kumar said a 15-day demolition notice has been issued. He said the officer who had issued a demolition notice a decade ago but later revoked it would also face action, and that the LDA has recommended to the state government that appropriate disciplinary proceedings be initiated against him.

The three-storey commercial building had a pet shop and

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

Police officers and forensic experts at the building where 15 people were killed in a fire, in Lucknow, Tuesday. VISHAL SRIVASTAV

HC upholds decision to restrain use of New Indian Express outside permitted territories

Express News Service
Mumbai, June 23

A TWO-JUDGE division bench of the Bombay High Court last week upheld a decision of a single judge that restrained the Express Publications (Madurai) Pvt. Ltd (EPML) from using the title The New Indian Express outside the states of Tamil Nadu, Karnataka, Kerala, Odisha and Andhra Pradesh and specified Union Territories. This prohibition emanates from a Memorandum of Settlement signed between EPML and The Indian Express (P) Limited in 1995 which became a decree of the Madras High Court.

The division bench of Justice Bharati H Dangre and Justice Manjusha A Deshpande held there was "no perversity or patent error" in the November 13, 2025 order of Justice Riyaz I Chagla.

The bench of Justice Dangre and Justice Deshpande, by a judgement pronounced on June 15, 2026, dismissed an interim application in the appeal filed by Express Publications (Madurai) Pvt. Ltd against the November 2025 decision by the bench of Justice Chagla, which had passed the order on an interim application in a commercial intellectual property rights suit by

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

Pune businessman's son was pushed off cliff by fiancee, her friend; both held for murder: Police

Sushant Kulkarni
Pune, June 23

A 25-YEAR-OLD belonging to a prominent real-estate family, who was earlier suspected to have fallen to his death at the Lohagad Fort near Pune while taking a photograph, was killed by his 20-year-old fiancee and her friend, police said.

Five days after Ketan Agarwal's death, the Pune Rural Police Tuesday arrested Siya Praveen Goyal and Chetan Babulal Chaudhary, 22, on the charge of killing Agarwal by pushing him off the cliff. The two had confessed to killing Agarwal, police said, and are probing if it was their fourth attempt to kill the 25-year-old.

Agarwal, the son of real-estate businessman Vishal Agarwal and a director in the family-run firm, was killed on June 18 morning while on a visit to Lohagad Fort, about 50 km from Pune, to celebrate Goyal's birthday that falls on June 19.

The two got engaged in February and were to have a destination wedding in Rajasthan

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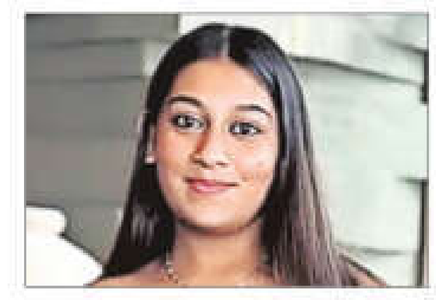

Ketan Agarwal and Siya Praveen Goyal got engaged in February

• ANDHRA PRADESH IT MINISTER NARA LOKESH SAYS TDP'S SUPPORT TO PM 'UNCONDITIONAL', REJECTS SUGGESTIONS BJP ALLIES ARE AT A DISADVANTAGE IN NDA

'Parties like TMC, AAP that lose ideology after coming to power face trouble'

Express News Service
New Delhi, June 23

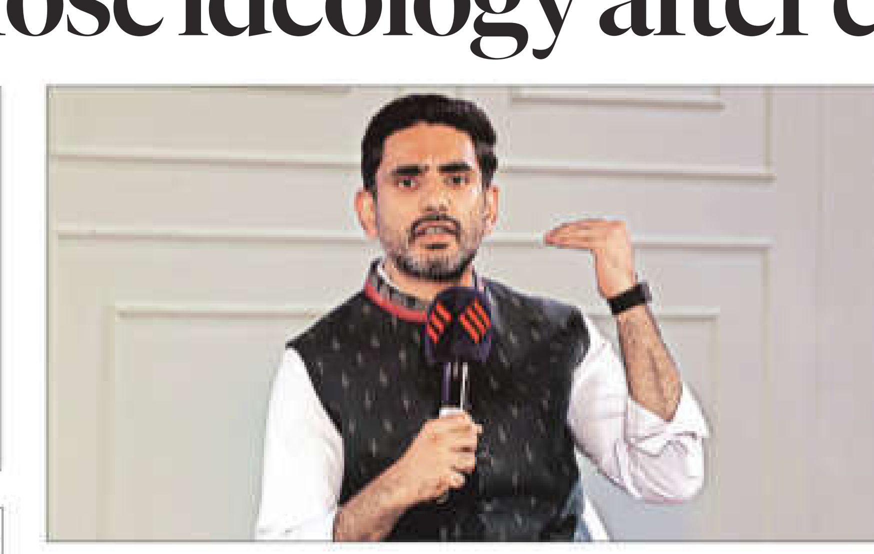
THE REGIONAL parties that lose their ideological moorings after years in power inevitably run into trouble, Andhra Pradesh IT Minister and Telugu Desam Party (TDP) national working president Nara Lokesh said, citing the challenges being faced by parties such as the Trinamool Congress (TMC) and the Aam Aadmi Party (AAP).

PAGE 1 anchor

Speaking at the Express Adda in Delhi on Monday, Lokesh, the son of Andhra Pradesh Chief Minister and TDP president N Chandrababu Naidu, said the TDP has endured political ups and downs because it remained rooted in its ideology and cadre despite facing both victories and defeats over the years.

Referring to TMC leader Abhishek Banerjee, Lokesh said he was going through a difficult phase and suggested that the TMC had become "complacent" after spending more than a decade at the helm of the West Bengal government. He claimed that both the Mamata Banerjee-led TMC and the Arvind Kejriwal-led AAP had drifted away from the principles on which they were founded.

"When I look at what is happening around me, the message is loud and clear that we stand for our ideology, as a regional party, we should stand for our workers and we have to double down on it. Parties which have lost their ideologies because of winning elections and coming to power multiple times have faced challenges," Lokesh said. He was in conversation with Vandita Mishra, National Opinion Editor, *The Indian Express*.


Andhra Minister Nara Lokesh at the Express Adda, Monday. RENUKA PURI

The TDP is a key ally of the BJP in both Andhra Pradesh and at the Centre.

Lokesh rejected suggestions that regional parties were at a disadvantage within the BJP-led NDA, insisting that the alliance provided enough space for partners to express their views and shape policies. "Our support to NDA has always been unconditional. Our leader and the TDP believe that India needs stable leadership," he said, adding that differences on policy matters were discussed within the NDA.

"I absolutely disagree with that narrative. Because whenever we wanted to voice an opinion, the doors were always open. Whenever we wanted reforms to come in certain sectors, our opinion was always heard. And things were changed," he said.

Lokesh cited the Waqf amendment Bill as an example, saying the TDP had raised concerns that eventually led to wider consultations on it. He also referred to discussions on the delimitation issue, saying the party had closely studied the proposal before taking up its concerns within the ruling coalition.

The question of the TDP's place in the NDA resurfaced when Anant Goenka, Executive Director, The Indian Express Group, referred to reports of a meeting involving CM Naidu, a corporate leader and a former Vice-President in Mumbai. Asked what had transpired during that meeting, Lokesh dismissed speculation that it had any political significance.

"I don't know why this story keeps repeating. And it's always as if the TDP has to prove itself that we are in NDA. Someone writes TDP is upset, someone says TDP is going to go away. There was never such conversation, because all the doors are open," the TDP leader said.

"About the rumour, I met Modi ji. I told him the context in which I met the person and the conversations I have had

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

[FROM PAGE 1 | FULL REPORTS ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM]

Rainfall

priority, where relatively better irrigation is available through dams and other means. The bulk of these districts are in 12 states — Madhya Pradesh, Maharashtra, Gujarat, Uttar Pradesh, Rajasthan, Karnataka, Bihar, Jharkhand, Telangana, Andhra Pradesh, Odisha and Tamil Nadu," Chouhan said, addressing a press conference after the meeting.

He said a detailed discussion was held with the state agriculture ministers and district collectors, and they were urged to intensify preparations at the local level. "We are facing potential conditions for a weak monsoon due to El Niño — an impact that is already becoming visible, as the monsoon is currently significantly delayed. Overall, rainfall has been 43 per cent below normal so far. Weather forecasts indicate that conditions are likely to remain weak during the week of July 2nd," Chouhan said.

The India Meteorological Department (IMD) has said that the country as a whole was expected to receive rains that were only 90 per cent of the long period average during the monsoon season. If that turns out to be the case, it would be the driest monsoon season in India in over a decade. As of now, the situation is looking even more grim.

For June, IMD had predicted 92 per cent rainfall. But with just one week remaining in the month, the shortfall in rainfall over the country as a whole is more than 42 per cent. Of the 36 States and Union Territories, as many as 26 have a deficiency of 20 per cent or more, as on Tuesday. Nine of these have a deficiency of more than 60 per cent.

June was predicted to be one of the better months in this monsoon season, with the latter months expected to be more impacted by the El Nino phenomenon. But the progress of the monsoon remained stalled for a week after June 15. It began progressing northwards only on Monday.

Chouhan said the monsoon situation implied a potential impact on the kharif crops. He said that an "El Niño Monitoring Cell" and a "Crop Weather Watch Group" have been constituted in Delhi to continuously analyse the progress of the monsoon, crop sowing, crop conditions, input supplies, and market signals.

States have also been instructed to set up their own control rooms and designate a nodal officer to coordinate with the Centre.

MP CM

Ujjain, adding up to 168 acres, for Rs 45 crore, in zones benefiting from infrastructure projects.

Most of these plots are either close to new road projects announced in and around Ujjain, or in areas demarcated for change of land use from agriculture to residential or commercial in the Ujjain Master Plan 2035, raising questions of propriety and conflict of interest.

While the Ujjain Master Plan 2035 was released in May 2023, months before Yadav became the CM, he has been involved in the city's tourism and infrastructure development for decades — as the chairperson of the Ujjain Development Authority during 2004-2010, as head of MP Tourism Development Corporation (MPTDC) during 2011-13, and as MLA from Ujjain (south) since 2013. Even before Yadav became CM, the family owned at least 108 plots measuring 179 acres in and around Ujjain, of which at least 85 acres were purchased during 2021-2023 when Yadav was education minister.

Questioning the Centre's inaction, AICC general secretary (organisation) K C Venugopal said in a post on X: "PM Modi, why have ED-CBI not knocked on the doors of MP CM Mohan Yadav? Is a 253 acre mega land scam not grounds enough to chase him and punish him for his crimes? A regime that is hyperactive to misuse investigative agencies to hound Opposition leaders to settle political scores, or to coerce them into joining their alliance, is now in deep slumber while their own chosen lieutenants loot public wealth... Be it the Ujjain Land Scam, or the shocking loot of donation funds from the Ram Temple in Ayodhya, or the massive corruption done by Assam CM and his family -- the list is endless."

In Bhopal, State Congress leaders called for Yadav's resignation. Addressing a press conference, Madhya Pradesh Congress president Jitu Patwari alleged that the BJP government had become synonymous with corruption and questioned the rapid expansion of land holdings linked to the CM's family.

"BJP is involved in the alleged theft of Ram Temple donations, and the party is also involved in the matter of Mahakal land," Patwari alleged.

"On December 13, 2023, Mohan Yadav became the CM. Between 2021 and 2023, close relatives of his family allegedly came to possess around 253 acres of land spread across nearly 194 plots. That means the landholdings increased massively between 2021 and the time he became CM on December 13, 2023. How did this happen?" Patwari said.

Umang Singhar, Congress's Leader of Opposition in the Assembly, said the CM should resign immediately. "This is one of the biggest land scams in Madhya Pradesh. The Master Plan was not redesigned for the development of Ujjain but to benefit the real-estate interests of the CM's family," he alleged.

Reacting to Patwari's press conference on Tuesday, State BJP spokesperson Hitesh Bajpai said: "All the charges made by the State Congress chief are baseless and hypothetical. They are trying to malign the image of our CM... Whatever details are being shown about the property, that has already been declared, either in Income Tax returns or election affidavit. There is nothing new in this."

Meanwhile, SP chief Akhilesh Yadav came out in defence of the Madhya Pradesh CM. "The BJP has hatched a conspiracy to defame Mohan Yadav. If these are the allegations against him... then the Uttar Pradesh CM has taken 300-600 acres of land... This is not a new thing that he (Mohan Yadav) has bought land. He used to be in the real estate business... These allegations are being made because the BJP is looking for a way to change three CMs. You cannot buy land without registration, so the government knew when the registrations were done," he said, claiming the BJP wanted to change the CMs of MP, Rajasthan and UP.

Adda

with the person. The PM laughed and said, 'One, no one told me. If anyone tells me, I will check. I will call you, make you sit in that chair and ask you that question. But just because there is rumour, you shouldn't stop meeting people. You are a politician, go and meet everyone.' That is the frankness with which you can have a conversation in this NDA dispensation. Our support to the PM is unconditional and it will continue to be unconditional because we believe he is the right leader at the right place at the right time. India needs political stability, strong leadership to take us forward," Lokesh said.

To a supplementary question on whether he had met both the former V-P and the corporate leader, he said he had met only one person.

Lokesh also weighed in on education reforms against the backdrop of the NEET leak row, arguing that the country's examination system needs to become more flexible and student-friendly. "Should further reforms happen in testing? Absolutely. Andhra has moved to completely computer-based testing. I believe exams should not happen only once a year. When our children are aspiring for higher education, one bad day could destroy their entire career or a year," he said.

The TDP leader also said he has studied examination systems in India and abroad to understand shortcomings and possible reforms. "It was very important for me to know what went wrong, including in the CBSE. If you look at the computer-based examination system, from a minister's perspective it looks good. But when the results came in, it was a double-edged sword. So I have to know what went wrong. What are the corrections required. There is nothing called a perfect system. We have to improvise as we go along," he said.

On social media regulation, Lokesh said governments, parents and technology platforms were increasingly recognising the need for ensuring safeguards for children online. "We have already held consultations with all the platforms. Even they say that children below the age of 13 are not allowed. But kids find ways of getting on the platform. Platforms want it, parents want it. We need safeguards. Age-appropriate content is very, very important," he said, adding that the Andhra government was working with Union IT Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw on the possibility of creating a national framework.

The conversation ended on a personal note, with Lokesh reflecting on the lessons he has learnt from public life. He described his 2023 padyatra across Andhra Pradesh as the most important political experience of his career so far. "Padyatra was very important for me to understand Bharat. In the previous Chandrababu Naidu cabinet, I was a minister. So when an MLA would come and explain to me about an issue, my ability to connect with that issue would be limited. Now my ability to relate to that issue exists 100 per cent," he said. "Stanford (from where he did his MBA) was great for business, but padyatra was great for politics. I got the IQ from Stanford and EQ from padyatra."

Asked what was the one lesson he had learnt from his father's "mistakes", Lokesh replied: "Spend more time with your children."

On what he had learnt from Congress leader Rahul Gandhi, Lokesh said: "One thing I appreciate about Rahul Gandhi is that he walked. I have done a padyatra and so I know it. But you can't just walk, your learnings have to be imbibed."

New Indian Express

plaintiff The Indian Express (P) Ltd.

Challenging the order, EPML filed an appeal before a two-judge bench.

Senior Advocate Darius Khambata, Advocates Arun Mohan, Abhinav Chandrachud and others instructed by Advocate Poorvi Kamani for The Indian Express (P) Ltd argued that it was the "absolute owner" of the registered titles and what was conferred on EPML was permitted use.

The lawyers submitted that the MoS which formed a part of the decree restricted the publication by EPML of the newspaper with the title New Indian Express to five states and specified UTs along with other restrictions. They also said the defendant "shall not directly or indirectly use or adopt any of the said titles in any way whatsoever or any title similar to or resembling thereto," except for the permitted use in the MoS.

They submitted that "though the parties had perfectly understood the terms of settlement," EPML attempted to hold an event in Mumbai called the New Indian Express-Mumbai Dialogues in September 2024, which was in breach of the settlement terms and the decree of the Madras High Court.

Senior Advocate Zal Andhyarujina, for EPML, argued that the settlement between the parties nowhere restrained it from promoting its publication outside the five states referred to in the MoS.

Andhyarujina claimed "acquiescence" by the plaintiff "when advertisements were issued by each of the parties in each other's publications".

However, the judgment observed, "The appellant being party to the MoS and supplemental MoS and the same being based on consent, definitely cannot claim ignorance of the rights that are conveyed on it and the rights that are continued by the Indian Express Group."

"We, therefore, do not find a plea of acquiescence or delay to be sustainable and rather we have noted that when IPAB (Intellectual Property Appellate Board) called upon the appellant to scrupulously follow the restrictions without the slightest violation, it still continued with its ventures, on an assumption that it was entitled to do so," the bench said.

The judgment said "Indian Express Group never acknowledged the conduct of the events for promotion though as far as advertisements are concerned, since there was a Joint Advertisement Agreement (JAA) which was executed by the parties recording consensual terms but even it was terminated with effect from January 20, 2011 and therefore, it cannot be definitely construed as open ended or permanent consent conferred on the appellant for pan-India use."

The Indian Express is accepted as a well known mark of the Indian Express Group and "it always intended to protect its "well known mark" across classes of goods and services and across the whole of India," the judgment observed. It was further observed that the event sought to be conducted by EPML with independent sponsors is a revenue generation event and offered sufficient justification for being objected by the owner of the title *Indian Express*.

Audit firm

general secretary, Champat Rai, but they did not respond.

The trust's website (https://srjbtkshetra.org/) makes no mention of any SOP, and no Internal Audit reports are available on it.

The Shri Ram Janmabhoomi Teerth Kshetra trust was formed on February 5, 2020, following the Supreme Court verdict clearing the way for the construction of the Ram temple at Ayodhya. Since then, it is estimated to have received around Rs 3,500 crore as donations in cash alone, besides other forms such as jewellery.

Sources in the trust told *The Indian Express* that in November 2020, a top official of the Trust requested the said audit firm trust to advise on 'Internal Audit and Risk Management'.

The audit firm analysed the systems of fund management and data management at the temple, highlighted several shortcomings, outlined possible risk implications, and recommended corrective measures. An SOP, the firm said, "will ensure organised culture and process at all levels, to be adhered to by all executives", while warning that "unprofessional staff and data management will lead to dubious information and reporting and misleading tendency to fellow staff and management".

The report further stated: "(The) Layer of management at the execution level is not defined and highly unprofessional... systematic record (of donations) for financial reporting is not available... No second and third check is available at any point of transaction and data entry... Accountability needs to be fixed in a structured organization tree. Coordination in between the related work flow of a transaction is a must for data integrity and effective management."

With recent allegations that jewellery as well as cash donated at the Ram temple were unaccounted for, the management of the trust is facing heat. A source associated with the trust says "the present mess" could have been avoided "if the trust management had properly addressed the concerns raised by the audit firm".

In fact, the audit firm had also addressed concerns regarding the mismanagement of donations such as jewellery, and recommended that "in-kind transaction entry with proper stock register... be maintained".

The absence of a proper HR department despite the thousands employed by the Teerth Kshetra trust had also been remarked upon by the audit firm, as well as the "requirement of qualified staff for periodic bank reconciliation and accounting data entry and MIS (Management Information System)".

On data management, the report said: "No record found for the IT management company confirming their sensitive data management service, server, data security and data theft vulnerability... No sorts of internal control available to validate, monitor and verify data entry and database of the IT service provider and their own internal mechanism of controlling and maintaining the integrity and security of information and reports."

Lucknow

clinic in the basement, ground and first floors, while the second floor, which bore the brunt of the blaze, housed Head Hopper Studios, a company involved in 3D art production and game development. Most of the victims worked there.

Officials said the 1,992 sq ft plot in Sector D of the Aliganj Scheme was originally allotted under the LDA's hire-purchase scheme through a lottery on July 11, 1980. Following execution of the agreement in November 1980, possession of the property was handed over to the allottee.

The property was later registered in the names of the allottee and his wife through a sale deed in 2005. On January 19, 2013, the couple sold the property to Virendra Pratap Shukla and Surendra Pratap Shukla, after which the LDA carried out mutation in their favour on August 7, 2014. Virendra is among those arrested.

Senior officials said approval for a residential building plan was granted on August 20, 2014, under the authority's self-certification scheme, under which the building owner submitted an affidavit, along with the building plan, to use it as a "residential building".

However, in 2016, the LDA found that it was being used for commercial purposes and construction beyond residential use was carried out, and registered a case against Virendra.

Sources said following this finding, the building was issued a "demolition notice for the unpermitted portion" on May 10, 2016. However, within two months, the notice was revoked citing a reason that the "owner had made an appeal that he was not heard before giving such notice". Records show that the demolition order was set aside on July 5, 2016.

Officials said the LDA is looking into all records since the notice was revoked and has summoned engineers and officials who were in charge at that time, inquiring why no action was taken despite the fact that the building continued its "commercial use" on a "residential permit". LDA V-C Kumar confirmed that the building approval was for "residential" use.

According to a senior LDA official, "Prima facie, we came to know that the demolition order was withdrawn on the basis of the owner's representation that he was not heard before the order was passed. The order was revoked by the same officer who had issued the notice in the first place. The circumstances under which the order was revoked are now part of the inquiry."

Asked why no action was taken even though the building did not have a No Objection Certificate (NOC) and lacked fire-safety measures, a senior official told *The Indian Express* that the building owner cited a "technical ground" — that the building was 12 metres tall (ground plus three floors), which, as per building bye-laws, did not require a fire NOC.

The official added that the building was recorded in LDA records as residential. The owner did not approach the local fire station or the Chief Fire Officer's office for clearance in the 13 years since the premises began being used for commercial activity, the official added.

The officials said the Indira Nagar fire station officer, along with officials from the power department and LDA engineers, who were suspended, were found guilty of ignoring a building being used for commercial activity that was not properly reflected in official records, and for failing to initiate any audit of the premises.

Video clip

Ankit from Jind.

Gurgaon ACP (Crime) Naveen Sharma told reporters: "The accused are currently in police custody and their interrogation is on. Ankit works at NIA as a cyber expert on an ad hoc contract basis. They were given Rs 10 lakh by officers of a neighbouring state, out of which Rs 2.5 lakh was deposited in a personal account. What the investigation has shown so far is that they were asked to make a fake AI-generated video report of a viral video allegedly involving the CM of our neighbouring state. Who Bade Sahab (the senior officers) are and their role is being investigated. We will make them join the probe."

The Sri Akal Takht, the highest temporal seat of the Sikhs, declared the video clip "authentic" and described Mann as "Guru dokhi" (anti-Guru) and "panth virodhi" (anti-panth). Mann, however, said the person in the video was not him but an actor used to defame him.

Following the Gurgaon police claim Tuesday, *The Indian Express* reached out to the office of Chief Minister Mann for comment but there was no response.

Meanwhile, Mann, addressing a rally in Bathinda Tuesday, said, "Sri Akal Takht Sahib is sacred for every Sikh and is considered the highest temporal seat of the community. It is a highly revered place from where every Sikh derives divine peace and power. However, some wrong elements have taken control of this sacred institution and are taking decisions without realising that it is our sacred place. I bowed before Sri Akal Takht Sahib because it is supreme for every Punjabi in general and Sikhs in particular. However, some people are trying to misuse it for their vested interests."

Sri Akal Takht Sahib's media advisor Jaskaran Singh said, "Haryana Police should investigate the matter with complete seriousness and expose every individual involved in this conspiracy, while also ensuring strict punishment for them."

In a statement, Aman Arora, Punjab president of the ruling AAP, said, "Haryana is governed by the BJP, the Haryana Police is under its control, and the entire administration answers to it. They can do whatever they want, initiate any inquiry they choose and make any allegation they wish. If the BJP is genuinely interested in uncovering the truth, why is it not investigating who created this video, who acted in it, who financed it, and who was responsible for circulating it?"

"The entire Punjab knows that the person seen in the video was not CM Bhagwant Singh Mann. Had there been any intention to secure a favourable forensic report, it could have been done through any laboratory in Punjab, where law and order is under our government. The fact that this was not done clearly shows that the objective was to obtain an impartial assessment of the video," Arora said.

Gurgaon police registered a case on a complaint from forensic expert Jaspreet Singh who alleged he was told by two officers of Punjab Police to tailor the report. One of the officers, he said, was of DIG rank and the other was an SP.

In a press release, Gurgaon police said, "The complainant, a professional dealing in digital forensics, cyber investigations and electronic evidence analysis, alleged that he was approached by individuals posing as senior officials of the Punjab government. He was instructed to draft a forensic report that aligned with a predetermined conclusion: specifically, to deny the identity of the person seen in the viral video and falsify all associated allegations."

"The complainant stated he was put in touch with multiple individuals to procure these reports under the names of allegedly fake or suspicious cyber and forensic entities. He was offered a hefty financial incentive, and the drafted reports were subjected to repeated modifications to steer them toward a specific narrative. As per the complaint, Rs 10 lakh in cash was allegedly provided to the complainant, while other individuals involved in preparing the reports were paid through various channels. When the complainant later verified the facts and raised doubts regarding the credibility of the associated agencies and their reports, he was allegedly threatened and pressured to keep the matter under wraps," Gurgaon police said.

It said "based on technical analysis, digital evidence, financial trails, and preliminary findings, a case was registered" and a special team, under the supervision of the DCP (Crime), "apprehended the accused".

Police said they were "interrogating the arrested duo to identify other individuals involved in fabricating the reports, verify the legitimacy of the agencies involved, and thoroughly trace the money trail", and added that the probe "will also focus on identifying the end beneficiaries of the conspiracy and scientifically analysing the electronic devices and documents used to tamper with the evidence".

Sources said that "in a video-recorded statement to Gurgaon police, Jaspreet Singh claimed that he fabricated a forensic report under duress and did not know that it would be misused to counter the Sri Akal Takht Sahib. He himself, being a Sikh, gave a written complaint to police that corroborated the sequence of events".

In his statement to Gurgaon police, Jaspreet claimed that he engaged two cyber experts, Ankit and Arun, and that under continuous WhatsApp supervision of the officer he said was a Punjab Police SP, the draft reports were repeatedly edited until they conformed to the expectations of the two police officers.

Detailing the sequence of events, sources said that on the night of June 15, the officer, who Jaspreet said was a DIG, checked into a room at a hotel in Gurgaon at 9.40 pm. Around an hour later, the second officer, who he said was an SP, reached the same hotel and checked into another room.

Jaspreet then came to the hotel carrying a bag. He went directly to the SP's room and spent about 40 minutes there. Following this, both men proceeded to the DIG's room for a 15-minute discussion. Jaspreet left the hotel to spend the night at a guest house in Gurgaon, sources said.

On June 16, Jaspreet returned to the hotel around 8.30 am. By 9.45 am, the two officers and Jaspreet were having breakfast together in the hotel's restaurant. During breakfast, the DIG, sources said, directed Jaspreet to procure two separate cyber lab reports from different individuals/labs claiming the video was AI-generated.

When Jaspreet cautioned the officers that any resulting report would be a "concocted" version, the DIG assured him he would be paid and put the SP in charge of the logistics to get the report that very day, the sources said.

Gurgaon police, sources said, found that Jaspreet, while leaving the hotel, was handed Rs 10 lakh cash by security personnel of the DIG officer.

Police investigation, sources said, showed that of Rs 10 lakh he received, Jaspreet paid Rs 7.5 lakh towards an installment and deposited the remaining Rs 2.5 lakh in his personal bank account. He subsequently paid Rs 50,000 to Ankit via an online transaction, while Arun was still to receive his share.

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Bajra

kharif (monsoon). It matures in 85-90 days, giving us time to plant mustard (in October) or wheat (in November) during the *rabi* (winter-spring) season".

Short-duration and suitability to fit into the mustard-wheat crop cycle isn't the only reason, though. For Meena, *bajra* not only yields an average 40 *mann* (16 quintals; one mann=40 kg) of grain per acre, but it also provides *kadbi* (dry fodder) which is 1.5 times of grain, i.e. 24 quintals per acre.

Meena and Ramraj Patel, a 14-bigha (8.7 acres) farmer from Nandri village in Dausa's Sikrai tehsil, have already sown bajra on a third of their holdings. They did it on June 9 and June 14, following western disturbances-induced showers in the preceding days. "Farmers in south Haryana and Rajasthan mostly sow *bajra* from end-May through June, with the pre-monsoon showers. The monsoon rains come after sowing and germination happens. Some farmers, in the absence of pre-monsoon showers, give one pre-sowing irrigation. Even with rainfall deficiency, they may have to irrigate just two more times — at 30 days and 60 days after sowing," notes Satyender Singh, CEO (Seeds) at Crystal Crop Protection Ltd.

A maximum requirement of three irrigations — compared to at least five-six for cotton (a 160-day crop), four-five for wheat (130-140 days) and two-three for mustard (120-130 days) — has made *bajra* the first-choice crop for farmers across Rajasthan, southern Haryana and neighbouring parts of UP. This is especially so in what increasingly appears to be an El Niño-influenced deficient monsoon year.

"*Bajra* needs very little irrigation. Its requirement of fertilisers (20 kg of di-ammonium phosphate and one bag or 45 kg of urea) and agro-chemicals (0.5 kg of Atrazine 50% wettable powder herbicide) per acre is also low. And it gives fodder that is of better quality than tuda (chopped wheat straw)," points out Bansi Lal, a 55-year-old farmer from Balawas village in Bawal tehsil of Haryana's Rewari district, who has sown *bajra* on 5.5 out of his total 10 acres.

Interestingly, despite being a largely rainfed crop — more so, in the Jodhpur-Jaisalmer belt of western Rajasthan — bajra has an estimated 18,000-tonnes commercial hybrid seeds market worth roughly Rs 720 crore at an average farmgate price of Rs 400 per kg. The top two companies — Corteva Agriscience ('Pioneer' brand) and Crystal Crop Protection ('Proagro') — have a 50% combined share of that, with Tata Rallis ('Dhaanya'), Nath Bio-Genes, Seed-Works International, JK Agri Genetics and Hytech Seed India being the other major players.

"Farmers traditionally grew bajra only for fodder and grain for self-consumption. But with the higher yields from hybrids, it has emerged as a commercial crop. Bajra grain is even mixed with maize for use as poultry feed," states Satyender Singh. His company's 'Proagro 9001', which is planted on some 1.6 million hectares, and Corteva's 'Pioneer 86M94' are among the popular hybrids.

Bansi Lal pegs the production cost of *bajra* at Rs 19,000-20,000 per acre. At 16 quintals yield and Rs 2,000/quintal price, the farmer would net Rs 12,000-13,000 per acre.

"That's decent, as it excludes the value of fodder," according to Naresh Goyal, one of India's largest *bajra* seeds wholesaler. His Alwar (Rajasthan)-based firm, Rahul Enterprises, does an annual turnover of Rs 50 crore from about 200 tonnes of *bajra*, 400 tonnes of wheat, 30 tonnes of onion and 10 tonnes of mustard seeds.

Pune death

later this year, for which a palace and two special flights for guests had been booked. Police are also probing the circumstances behind the cancellation of a pre-wedding shoot in Bali, Indonesia, earlier this month.

Goyal called up Agarwal's family telling them he had slipped while they were trekking at the fort, falling off a 350-ft cliff into a gorge while trying to click photographs. His body was recovered, and a case of accidental death registered.

Superintendent of Police, Pune Rural, Sandeep Singh Gill said that while probing the death, they got several leads as well as inputs from Agarwal's family that led them to suspect foul play. "The death was also suspicious as Agarwal was a regular trekker... We probed the information we had received and cross-referenced it with technical leads. We found that relations between Goyal and Agarwal had soured, and they had been fighting."

Gill said Goyal was in a relationship with Chaudhary for over a year, and didn't want to get married to Agarwal. "That is why she conspired with Chaudhary," the SP said, adding that the latter was already at the fort and followed Goyal and Agarwal to the top of the cliff. "Goyal and Chaudhary then pushed Agarwal off the cliff. After establishing the sequence of events, we detained and questioned the two. They confessed to the murder and were subsequently arrested," Gill said.

ABDUCTED NEAR A METRO STATION IN SOUTH DELHI'S MEHRAULI

'Papa...save me': 10-yr-old sleeping on footpath raped, killed; cab driver held

Police inspect the site where the accused attacked them and was injured in return fire. EXPRESS

Body dumped near a stretch on the Faridabad–Gurgaon Road

Express News Service
New Delhi, June 23

A 10-YEAR-OLD girl, who was sleeping with her family members on a footpath near a Metro Station in South Delhi's Mehrauli area, was allegedly abducted on Monday shortly after 4 am by a cab driver, raped, strangled and later dumped near the Gurgaon–Faridabad border, said police.

The accused was arrested within hours following a probe, aided by CCTV footage, vehicle registration checks and GPS tracking, said officers. The 10-year-old was living with her family on the pavement near a traffic intersection, as per officers.The family from Bihar had come to Delhi four months ago in search of work but the family members were forced to sleep on the roadside in the absence of a steady income.

With help from a local woman, the girl had been enrolled at a nearby government school. The night before the crime, according to the girl's father, the family ate and slept on the pavement.

He told police he woke at 4.15 am to his daughter's screams — "Papa... save me". He said he grabbed a stick. But by that time, the assailant had put the child into a vehicle and driven off, said police. He chased the car, and raised an alarm. But he could not stop the vehicle. Police said the vehicle — a white Wagon R with a commercial plate — was traced using CCTV and registration details. By 11 am on Monday, the accused, identified as Bashu Kumar Singh, was taken into custody while dropping a passenger in West Delhi's Vikaspuri, officers said.

He initially denied involvement in the incident but later admitted committing the crime, police said, leading officers to the location where he had dumped the body near a forested stretch on the Faridabad–Gurgaon Road.

Forensic teams recovered the girl's body on Monday evening. Officers said the victim had ligature marks on her neck consistent with strangulation and multiple facial injuries indicating blunt force trauma.

The police said the accused struck her with stones and a brick. Samples were retrieved from the vehicle and were being sent for forensic testing to corroborate the assault allegations.

During a court appearance on Tuesday, the accused was remanded to two days police custody. Police said the suspect allegedly attempted to snatch a service revolver from an escorting officer and fired at the party while being taken to the crime scene. He was injured in the leg when police returned fire. He was subsequently admitted to hospital and a separate case for assault on a police officer has been registered.

Deputy Commissioner of Police (South) Anant Mittal confirmed the arrest and said the probe is continuing to establish the sequence of events, motive and any possible accomplices. "We are examining CCTV, vehicle movement data, mobile call records and forensic evidence. Action will be taken swiftly," he said.

The girl's father described her as caring and ambitious, the eldest who looked after her younger siblings and dreamed of education. The police said they will provide legal and social support as the case proceeds.

Accused attacked cops in Bihar, was involved in attempt to murder cases: Police

Express News Service
New Delhi, June 23

BASHU KUMAR (29), accused of kidnapping, raping and killing a 10-year-old in South Delhi's Mehrauli area, has prior criminal cases, including two attempt-to-murder cases, filed against him.

He also allegedly attacked a police officer in Bihar's Khagaria district, said police.

Even as five cases were filed against him in 2015, 2017, 2018 and 2022, he had been working for ride-hailing firms in Delhi for several years, officers said.

During questioning, the accused showed no remorse for allegedly raping and killing the girl.

According to police, Kumar has been living in the Capital and driving cabs in Delhi-NCR for 10 years.

"He is violent in nature and loses his temper quickly. He has shown no remorse for his actions and has repeatedly changed his statements. At present, he was staying in a rented accommodation with his brother in Gurgaon," a police source said.

"During questioning, he said he intended to drop the girl near a Metro station in South Delhi after the assault, but when he saw policemen with her parents, he drove her to Gurgaon-Faridabad Road, where he allegedly assaulted her again and then killed her. He later changed this statement," the source added.

According to the source, police were still verifying facts and the sequence of events.

During questioning, the accused showed no remorse for allegedly abducting, raping and killing the girl, said police.

Sources said he showed no remorse during questioning. In fact, on Monday after the alleged attack, he picked up a passenger in South Delhi and dropped them in West Delhi's Vikaspuri before being caught by a police team led by station house officer Inspector Ritesh Kumar.

On how he was able to drive for online aggregators without apparent police verification, a senior officer said investigators are checking records with the ride-hailing firms.

The cab was registered with two online aggregators.

Police have also questioned the vehicle's owner about the verification of the accused.

After his arrest on Monday, according to police, Kumar did not admit to the crime for several hours but later broke down in the evening, following which the girl's body was recovered. Police are now trying to determine whether he was previously involved in any crimes in Delhi-National Capital Region (NCR).

The accused was arrested on Monday following a probe, aided by CCTV footage, vehicle registration checks and GPS tracking, said officers.

CM orders graft probe against two health dept officials in Rs 350-crore fraud case

New Delhi: Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta has directed a corruption inquiry against two senior officials of the Health Department in connection with a Rs 350-crore fraud case involving the procurement of medicines and medical equipment for government hospitals in the Capital, officials said on Tuesday.

This comes against the backdrop of the Anti-Corruption Branch arresting Central Procurement Agency (CPA) in-charge Dr Vinod Kumar Ranga on June 18 as part of its ongoing probe into the procurement practices.

As per government sources, Gupta has sought permission for an investigation under Section 17A of the Prevention of Corruption Act, 1988, into allegations against former Director General of Health Services (DGHS) Dr Vatsala Aggarwal and Deputy Controller of Accounts Neeraj Chopra. The complaints relate to their alleged role in procurement decisions taken through the CPA, the nodal body responsible for purchasing medicines and medical supplies for public hospitals in the Capital.

Gupta said that she has directed officials to ensure a time-bound investigation. ENS

Rs 10 lakh medical cover in new scheme for construction workers

Express News Service
New Delhi, June 23

A RS 10 lakh health cover, 10 lakh beneficiaries, and Rs 200 crore to be spent annually— these are the key details of the 'Delhi Building and Construction Workers Health Scheme' approved by the Delhi Cabinet on Tuesday.

The scheme, which is aimed at strengthening social security for construction workers, extends health protection to around 2.70 lakh registered workers and their families, an official said. According to officials, it is expected to cover nearly 10 lakh beneficiaries in the city in total.

Under this scheme, registered construction workers and their eligible family members including spouses, children, and parents will receive free and quality healthcare services through empanelled hospitals and mobile health units.

Each registered worker will be entitled to treatment of up to Rs 2 lakh at empanelled hospitals, while the limit for a family will be up to Rs 10 lakh, an official said.

As per Chief Minister Rekha Gupta, the government expects to spend approximately Rs 200 crore annually on the scheme. Highlighting the necessity of the scheme, Gupta said construction workers are the foundation of Delhi's development and strengthening their social security remains a key priority of the government.

"They are routinely exposed to stone-cutting dust, chemicals, excessive noise, heavy machinery, general dust and physically demanding working conditions. As a result, they are vulnerable to silicosis (a lung disease), respiratory ailments, skin disorders and other serious health problems. A comprehensive health protection scheme for this section had long been lacking, and the present initiative has been designed to address that gap," she said.

Further, officials said that the entire treatment process will be cashless.

भारत निर्वाचन आयोग
Election Commission of India

विशेष गहन पुनरीक्षण (SIR-2026), हरियाणा

CHIEF ELECTORAL OFFICER, HARYANA

मतदाता द्वारा ऑनलाइन भरे गए

गणना प्रपत्र (Enumeration Form)

के संबंध में बीएलओ हेतु निर्देश

निर्वाचन आयोग के निर्देशानुसार यदि किसी मतदाता द्वारा ECINET/ निर्धारित पोर्टल के माध्यम से ऑनलाइन गणना प्रपत्र भरा जाता है, तो संबंधित बूथ लेवल अधिकारी (BLO) निम्नलिखित कार्यवाही सुनिश्चित करें।

1 ऑनलाइन प्राप्त प्रपत्रों की नियमित समीक्षा करें
पोर्टल पर उपलब्ध ऑनलाइन भरे गए प्रपत्रों की प्रतिदिन जांच करें तथा गणना प्रपत्र की हार्ड कॉपी वापिस एकत्रित करने की आवश्यकता नहीं है।

2 घर–घर सत्यापन अवश्य करें
ऑनलाइन प्रपत्र प्राप्त होने के बाद भी संबंधित मतदाता के पते पर जाकर विवरण का भौतिक सत्यापन करें।

3 मतदाता की पहचान का सत्यापन करें
नाम, आयु, लिंग, पता एवं अन्य विवरणों का उपलब्ध दस्तावेजों के आधार पर मिलान करें।

4 संलग्न दस्तावेजों की जांच करें
अपलोड किए गए दस्तावेज स्पष्ट एवं वैध हैं या नहीं, इसकी पुष्टि करें।

5 परिवार के सभी पात्र सदस्यों का सत्यापन करें
यह सुनिश्चित करें कि कोई पात्र मतदाता सूची से छूट न जाए तथा कोई अपात्र व्यक्ति शामिल न हो।

6 अनुपस्थित (Absent), स्थानांतरित (Shifted), मृत (Dead) एवं डुप्लीकेट (Duplicate) प्रविष्टियों की जांच करें
सत्यापन के दौरान यदि ऐसी कोई स्थिति पाई जाती है तो निर्धारित प्रक्रिया के अनुसार रिपोर्ट करें।

7 त्रुटियों की पहचान एंव रिपोर्टिंग करें
ऑनलाइन प्रपत्र में किसी की त्रुटि, अपूर्ण जानकारी अथवा दस्तावेजों में विसंगति पाए जाने पर BLO स्वयं BLO App के माध्यम से त्रुटियों का सत्यापन करने उपरांत अपडेट करें।

8 सत्यापन की स्थिति पोर्टल पर अद्यतन करें
निर्धारित समय सीमा के भीतर सत्यापन रिपोर्ट एवं आवश्यक टिप्पणियां ऑनलाइन दर्ज करें।

9 मतदाता को आवश्यक मार्गदर्शन प्रदान करें
यदि किसी अतिरिक्त दस्तावेज अथवा जानकारी की आवश्यकता हो तो मतदाता को सूचित करें।

10 गोपनीयता बनाए रखें
मतदाता की व्यक्तिगत जानकारी का उपयोग केवल निर्वाचन कार्य हेतु करें तथा उसकी गोपनीयता सुनिश्चित करें।

विशेष ध्यान दें
- ऑनलाइन गणना प्रपत्र भरना सत्यापन प्रक्रिया का विकल्प नहीं है।
- प्रत्येक ऑनलाइन प्रपत्र का भौतिक सत्यापन अनिवार्य है।
- सभी सत्यापन कार्य निर्धारित समय–सीमा के भीतर पूर्ण किए जाएं।
- मतदाता सूची की शुद्धता एवं पारदर्शिता सुनिश्चित करना BLO की प्रमुख जिम्मेदारी है।

आपका सही सत्यापन शुद्ध एवं त्रुटिरहित मतदाता सूची की गारंटी है।

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- Stenos
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44 old flyovers to be repaired in 3 yrs to ensure safe rides

Gayathri Mani
New Delhi, June 23

OUT OF the more than 100 flyovers in Delhi, 85 are more than a decade old – some even date back to the 1990s.

Following directions issued by a city court, 44 flyovers that are more than 15 years old will now be put through structural audits to assess their health and fitness, officials said.

Public Works Department (PWD) Minister Parvesh Sahib Singh said, "Public safety cannot wait for a crisis. As Delhi continues to grow, the safety and reliability of our infrastructure become even more critical. Many of our flyovers have been serving citizens for more than 15 years and carry lakhs of commuters every day. By initiating a comprehensive structural audit of 44 such flyovers, we are taking a proactive and scientific approach to assess their condition, identify any potential concerns at an early stage, and plan timely interventions wherever required."

Through this initiative, we are reinforcing our commitment to preventive maintenance, transparency, and world-class urban infrastructure standards for the people of Delhi. "Structural audits of flyovers should be conducted every five years," said a senior PWD official. "The PWD has identified 44 flyover corridors that require repair and rehabilitation," the official said. A consultant will be appointed to carry out structural audits.

"Following that, repair and rehabilitation works will be undertaken to ensure the safety of both the flyovers and the commuters who use them. Regular repairs also ensure smooth, pothole-free and bump-free travel," the official said.

• Ageing flyovers

Repair work ongoing.

YEAR OF MAKE	FLYOVER
1982	Ring Road intersection IP estate
1990	RUB Nagia Park Shakti Nagar
2003	Sarai Kale Khan flyover
2006	Lajpat Nagar to Sriniwaspuri
2008	DND flyover, Wazirabad

Given the large number of flyovers, the repairs will be carried out in phases. "If all of them are repaired at the same time, the city and its traffic will come to a standstill," the official said. The oldest structures will be repaired first, in particular those that were constructed before 2000, as they require immediate attention, the official said. "The auditing and repairs process will be completed over the next three years. Seven to eight flyover stretches will be repaired and rehabilitated every year," the official said.

Among the flyovers that will be taken up for repairs this year includes the one at Ring Road intersection at IP Estate, which was opened to traffic in 1982 and RUB under Nagia Park Shakti Nagar constructed in 1990.

Shadipur in West Delhi, the first modern flyover in the city, which was opened to traffic in February 1971, Zakhira flyover, which too was built in the 1970s will also be repaired. Further, Naraina Flyover, Raja Garden, Seelampur, Peeragarhi, IIT, and Modi Mill flyovers, as well as the Barapullah Nullah culvert are also likely to be repaired, officials said. The periodic repair, rehabilitation, and maintenance of reinforced cement concrete (RCC) structures is critical to ensure the safety, functionality and longevity of essential transportation systems. These structures are subjected to continuous stress from heavy traffic, weather conditions and environmental factors, and inevitably experience wear and deterioration over time, officials said. If not addressed in time, such degradation can compromise the structural integrity of flyovers, leading to potential hazards, higher maintenance costs, and disruption of public services.

Around 21 flyovers across the city, including the ones at Nehru Nagar, ISBT (Yudhishthir Setu), Sarita Vihar, Vikas Marg, Mukundpur, Karampura, Ashram Chowk, Najafgarh Drain (10 Nos. Bridge), Africa Avenue, Moti Bagh, Savitri Cinema, Tilak Nagar District Centre, Tilak Nagar Metro Station, Punjabi Bagh, Mayapuri, Andrews Ganj, Nehru Place, and Gokulpuri were repaired during 2024-25. The rehabilitation process typically involves a comprehensive assessment of the structure's condition to identify problems such as cracks, corrosion, spalling, and weakened joints.

ZIP FILE USED TO COMPROMISE DEVICES OF THOSE TARGETED, SAY POLICE

'Boss scam': New modus operandi in Rs 7.8-cr fraud linked to Naresh Gujral

Alok Singh
New Delhi, June 23

"YOUR COMPANY account is going to be closed. Please verify your account...". As this WhatsApp message, accompanied by a link to a ZIP file, pops up, an accountant working for a high-profile firm — gripped by a sense of urgency — immediately clicks on the link and unknowingly compromises the device. This is how alleged fraudsters gain access to the WhatsApp account, and go on to impersonate the company owner. The accountant is then instructed from the fake account to make immediate payments to some mule accounts, said police. Investigating agencies have termed this as the "Boss Scam" or CEO impersonation fraud.

This was the alleged modus operandi used to dupe former Member of Parliament Naresh Gujral, son of former Prime Minister I K Gujral. The alleged fraud resulted in the transfer of Rs 7.8 crore through four separate transactions. On Monday, the Intelligence Fusion and Strategic Operations (IFSO) unit of the Delhi Police achieved its first breakthrough in the case with the arrest of a 40-year-old mule account holder from Amritsar. Officers said the fraud operated through two separate chains: one involving those who allegedly deceived Gujral and his company's employee, and another responsible for routing and laundering the stolen funds through mule accounts. The arrested individual was part of the second layer of the operation, which involved 35 bank accounts spread across the country. Investigators found that the stolen money was initially distributed among four first-layer accounts — two in Maharashtra and one each in Telangana and Andhra Pradesh.

According to police sources, the IFSO unit, which is probing the case, found that the scammers had initially sent the malicious message to one of the company's directors. Perceiving it as urgent, the director forwarded it to the accountant for further action. As soon as the accountant clicked on the ZIP file, his WhatsApp account was allegedly compromised. The alleged fraudsters then gained control of the account, altered Naresh Gujral's contact details on WhatsApp, and began sending messages impersonating him. They instructed the accountant to transfer funds through Real-Time Gross Settlement (RTGS), a system used for urgent, high-value bank transactions. Sources said the scammers are targeting high-ranking officials and corporate executives by sending malicious ZIP archives through email or WhatsApp under the guise of urgent regulatory compliance requirements. In some cases, they impersonate officials from the Reserve Bank of India (RBI). The messages typically create a false sense of urgency by providing only a short time window for compliance.

Once the malicious file is executed, malware infects the executive's Windows device and active WhatsApp Web sessions. This enables the scammers to communicate with subordinate employees while posing as senior executives and to orchestrate fraudulent financial transfers.

Police sources said that after APK-based malware links, ZIP files have emerged as another major tool being used to target high-profile companies. The compressed ZIP archive typically contains a malicious executable (.exe) file along with a dynamic link library (.dll) file. Similar cases have been reported across the country.

Officers said over 100 such complaints have been reported in cities nationwide. The scammers have primarily targeted company owners, CEOs, and senior executives. During the investigation, police found indications that many of these "Boss Scam" operations are being run from Cambodia, among other Southeast Asian countries. Recently, the Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre (I4C) has also raised concern regarding the "Boss Scam" or CEO impersonation fraud.

• 7 STEPS OF FRAUD

1. **HACKER sends WhatsApp message:** Claims company account is being closed. Message contains malicious .zip file link
2. **EMPLOYEE downloads, opens .zip file:** File has executable file (.exe), which installs malware, and a dynamic link library (.dll), which supports malicious code
3. **MALWARE is activated:** .exe and .dll execute on device
4. **DEVICE is compromised:** Hacker gains access to phone, including WhatsApp account and contact list. Starts tracking conversations, identifies company hierarchy
5. **IMPERSONATES account:** Uses owner's WhatsApp identity and profile picture (DP), sends messages to employee posing as owner. Employee assumes instructions are from the boss
6. **FRAUDULENT financial instructions sent:** Employee is directed to transfer company funds to another account
7. **INSTRUCTIONS are followed, fraud is completed:** Once unauthorised transfer is carried out, financial loss occurs

Crackdown on power theft underway in high-loss areas

Express News Service
New Delhi, June 23

IN A crackdown on electricity theft in West Delhi's Kamruddin Nagar —a high-loss pocket — authorities were able to prevent stealing of more than million units of power, with losses at the targeted locations reducing by around 34,000 units a day, Power Minister Ashish Sood said on Tuesday. The government said the drive would now be extended to other high-loss pockets of Delhi.

The move assumes significance as Kamruddin Nagar, which falls under the Mundka division, had recorded aggregate technical and commercial losses of 56.4%, according to the Delhi government, which translated into an annual financial loss of around Rs 24.4 crore. In a statement, the Power Minister's office said illegal commercial and industrial units were the main source of theft, allegedly drawing power through unauthorised connections from overhead lines. According to sources, the highest estimated losses in BSES Rajdhani Power Ltd (BRPL's) areas are in Khyala Village, where power theft is pegged at around Rs 30.6 crore annually. This is followed by Kamruddin Nagar in Mundka, Jharoda Kalan and Dhichaon Kalan in Najafgarh, and Tughlakabad village, with each of these areas accounting for significant losses.

Under BSES Yamuna Power Limited jurisdiction, Krishna Nagar and Gandhi Nagar are the biggest power theft-prone pockets, with estimated losses of around Rs 4.97 crore, followed by New Seelampur-Ghonda (Rs 3.57 crore).

'Risk to life...': Residents flag plaster falling off ceilings at DDA's first luxury apartment complex

Devansh Mittal
New Delhi, June 23

MUKESH NARWAL (34) had just finished dinner with his family and stood up from the dining table in his living room on June 6 when a portion of the roof fell off. "My two children – aged nine months and three years — were playing under the table. They were not injured... but dust fell on them," said the IT professional, a resident of Golf View Condos in West Delhi's Dwarka, the Delhi Development Authority's (DDA) first luxury apartment complex in the Capital.

Days later, a similar incident happened at another flat in the residential complex. Last week, around 6:30 pm, Mohinder Singh's mother and his son were at their home while he was away at work. A chunk of ceiling fell off on the dining table. "It was a close shave. Thankfully, no one was sitting at the table at that time, or else... ," recalled Singh (53).

Golf View Condos boasts 11 towers, housing 1,130 luxury flats — 14 penthouses, 170 super high-income group (HIG) flats and 946 HIG flats. It overlooks the DDA's newly constructed 18-hole Golf Course. The DDA had earlier said that the highest bid during the auctions in 2023 for the HIG flats went up to Rs 3 crore, up to Rs 4.5 crore for super HIG flats and Rs 5.76 crore for penthouses. All flats have been sold by DDA and around 500 families are currently living in the complex.

Mohinder Singh's flat after the damage; (above) Golf View Condos. AMIT MEHRA

The Golf View Condos Residents' Welfare Association in a letter on June 18 flagged the two incidents to DDA's chief engineer. "While no one was seriously injured, the incidents left residents fearful and posed a risk to life and property," the letter read. It also said that the concrete cover had deteriorated in several places of the residential complex, exposing reinforcement bars that were "heavily corroded and rusted".

Seeking an urgent inspection, the RWA asked the DDA to conduct a comprehensive structural audit of the complex through an independent agency, identify the cause of deterioration and draw up a rehabilitation plan.

In response to the recent incidents, a DDA spokesperson told The Indian Express, "Two instances of plaster spalling from the ceiling of flats were reported. Out of these, one case has already been attended to... repair with proper anti-rust coating of reinforcement has been done, while the other is currently under repair."

Residents have alleged that they had raised similar instances of corrosion, rust stains, cracking and concrete spalling as early as 2024 but repairs undertaken by the DDA were limited to superficial patchwork and cosmetic treatment.

Sharing his grievance, Rishish Jha, a homeowner and the vice-president of the RWA, said, "A beam in my flat's balcony that suffered concrete spalling due to severe reinforcement corrosion was repaired, yet the concrete has spalled again within just one year. This recurrence raises serious concerns about the adequacy of the repair methodology and the underlying structural durability of the member."

Earlier, a case filed by multiple homeowners with Real Estate Regulatory Authority (RERA) — alleging substandard construction — did not go in their favour. Several residents had complained against alleged uneven flooring, plaster defects, water seepage, hollow tiles, faulty plumbing, inadequate electrical wiring, and incomplete common facilities in the housing complex. They also alleged a delay in the allocation of flats.

On February 11, the real estate watchdog had dismissed a batch of complaints, stating that they "lack sufficient merit and credible substantiation". It had said that the identified defects were largely finishing-related issues and that such minor issues do not amount to structural defects or render the flats uninhabitable. While dismissing the complaints, however, RERA directed the DDA to honour its five-year defect liability obligation under the RERA Act and rectify any defects at its own cost, brought to its notice within 30 days. It also directed the appointment of a nodal officer, not below the rank of chief engineer, to handle grievances of the allottees.

Even as residents have claimed that a nodal officer has not been appointed yet, the DDA spokesperson said the Chief Engineer, Zone, is the nodal officer for grievance redressal for Golf View Condos (GVC).

"The Nodal officer, along with the Executive Engineer concerned, is regularly monitoring GVC and addressing issues raised from time to time. Also, issues raised in RERA including water pipeline leakage have already been addressed. Proper register for complaint and defect is being maintained and reviewed," the spokesperson added.

'WHO GUIDELINES MISSED ON MORE THAN 99% DAYS'

Pollution spikes this year turned transit and construction hubs into 'red zones', reveals study

Sophiya Mathew
New Delhi, June 23

WITH THE upcoming monsoon expected to improve air quality conditions in the Capital, a new analysis by think tank EnviroCatalysts shows that Delhi's pollution levels presented a contrasting trend during the first half of 2026.

The study released on Tuesday analysed air quality data from January 1 to June 20 with the corresponding period in 2025. It found out that while nitrogen dioxide (NO_2) and ground-level ozone concentrations decreased this year, fine particulate matter (PM2.5) remained persistently elevated, accompanied by increasingly intense winter pollution episodes.

During peak regional pollution events in mid-January, Anand Vihar recorded a peak hourly PM2.5 concentration of 876 µg/m³, followed by RK Puram (792 µg/m³), Ashok Vihar (768 µg/m³) and Mundka (738 µg/m³). "..neighbourhoods bordered by high-density transit corridors and commercial construction became severe 'red zones'," the study noted. Red zones refer to pollution hotspots. In comparison, stations at the Cantonment area, IMD Lodhi Road and JNU consistently recorded relatively lower pollution levels.

According to the study, average PM2.5 concentrations fell marginally by 2.2%, from 90 micrograms per cubic metre (µg/m³) in 2025 to 88 µg/m³ in 2026. However, severe pollution episodes continued during winter. The highest hourly PM2.5 concentration recorded this year reached 484 µg/m³ on January 18, exceeding last year's peak of 450 µg/m³.

Pollutants primarily associated with vehicular emissions showed improvement. Average nitrogen dioxide (NO_2) concentrations declined by 9.4%, from 48 µg/m³ in 2025 to 44 µg/m³ in 2026. Ground-level ozone levels also fell by 20%, averaging 35 µg/m³.

Despite these gains, the report noted that Delhi continued to miss the much stricter air quality guidelines prescribed by the WHO on the majority of days. "Delhi failed the daily safety criteria of the World Health Organization (WHO) an astonishing 99.5% of the time for PM2.5, 99.4% for PM10, and 83.4% for NO_2, showing cleaner seasonal gases have done little to change the baseline hazard to public health," the study noted.

• Findings

- PM2.5 average declined 2.2%, from 90 to 88 µ g/m³
- PM2.5 standard exceedance days fell from 64.4% to 58.2%
- Peak hourly PM2.5 rose to 484 µ g/m³ during winter
- PM10 levels remained virtually unchanged at about 205 µ g/m³
- PM10 exceeded national standards nearly 90% of the time
- NO_2 levels fell 9.4%, from 48 to 44 micrograms per cubic meter
- Ground-level ozone declined 20%
- Anand Vihar recorded the highest hourly PM2.5 concentration

• IMMENSELY PROUD, SAYS FATHER KAILASH GAHLOT

'Focus important': How CUET topper, daughter of ex-minister, prepared for exam

Vidheesha Kuntamalla
New Delhi, June 23

WHEN DEVINA Gahlot (17) opened her Common University Entrance Test (CUET-UG) 2026 scorecard on Tuesday afternoon, the first thing that caught her attention was a string of perfect scores. The next was disbelief.

The daughter of former Delhi Transport Minister and Bijwasan MLA Kailash Gahlot, Devina emerged as the top scorer in this year's CUET-UG, a nationwide examination taken by lakhs of students seeking admission to undergraduate programmes.

"I checked my application number a couple of times just to be sure...," she said, recalling the moment she realised she had secured the highest aggregate National Testing Agency (NTA) score in the country — 1232.19 — across five subjects. "I was not able to believe my eyes." Her subjects were Economics, English, Fine Arts, Political Science and Psychology. She secured 100 percentile in Economics, Political Science and Psychology, and 99.9 percentile in the remaining two subjects.

For Devina, the achievement is the culmination of years of academic discipline. "Since childhood, I've always been at the top of my class," she said. However, she describes the transition from school examinations to CUET as "unexpectedly challenging". "My board exams ended very late in April, and I barely had a month to prepare for CUET. At the beginning, it was a little overwhelming because there wasn't a clear way to understand exactly what to study and how to study," she said.

The biggest adjustment, she added, was moving from descriptive board examinations to an application-based entrance test. "When you study for school, you're used to writing long answers. CUET is much more conceptual and application-based. Once I understood that difference, the journey became easier."

Devina with her father Kailash Gahlot. EXPRESS

Unlike many high-scoring candidates, Devina did not enrol in a coaching institute. Instead, she said, she relied on NCERT textbooks and previous years' question papers. "I just read my books thoroughly and attempted previous papers. That's all I did."

Devina was among candidates affected by a technical issue that delayed an examination session by the NTA in one of her papers "All I would say is that you have to keep your calm and be prepared for anything that happens," she said. "We just have to not lose our focus." she said. "For me, what worked was consistency. Instead of studying very long hours every day, I studied consistently. Everyone has good days and bad days. What matters is showing up every day." she added.

An avid reader and writer, she hopes to pursue English Honours at Delhi University's St Stephen's College or Hindu College and eventually explore journalism and creative writing. "I write articles sometimes. I'm very much into reading. Maybe even journalism...," she said.

Her father, Kailash Gahlot, said the family is proud not only of the achievement but also of the path she wishes to pursue. "As a father, I am immensely proud of Devina's achievement. Securing All India Rank 1 in CUET is the result of her hard work, discipline and dedication over the years. She has always been a sincere and studious child, and this success reflects the effort she has put into her academics," he said. He added, "What makes me even happier is that she wants to pursue journalism and creative writing, a field that plays a vital role in society. It is her passion, and I completely support her decision."

For Devina, the support of her family proved crucial. "They never put any pressure on me to secure any rank or any college," she said. "All they wanted was for me to give my full potential."

As congratulatory messages continued pouring in through the day, the teenager admitted she was still processing the result. "I've just been so overwhelmed and not able to process it completely," she said.

DELHI CONFIDENTIAL

Field Visit

BEFORE IT sets off to consult stakeholders in Goa and Uttar Pradesh in the second week of July, the Joint Committee of Parliament on 'One Nation One Election', headed by BJP MP P P Chaudhary, is likely to make a field visit to the Delhi Assembly on July 1. The committee is expected to interact with Speaker Vijender Gupta, Chief Minister Rekha Gupta and other stakeholders. A meeting with Delhi Lieutenant Governor Taranjit Sandhu could also be on the cards, it is learnt.

Under Watch

WHILE THE buzz around defection of Samajwadi Party MPs to the NDA camp stands settled for now as speculated by SBSP chief Om Prakash Rajbhar, the Congress and SP circles in UP are still trying to find out which of their MPs can jump ship. While Congress leaders are speculating who from the SP can be targeted by the BJP, the same is being done by the SP leaders to identify vulnerable Congress MPs. Names of some MPs from both parties, mainly who had come from some other party, are doing the rounds.

Not On Board

EVEN AS INDIA bloc parties collect signatures on the letter being sent to Chief Justice of India Surya Kant on alleged electoral irregularities, sources said that it would be "optimistic" to hope that Congress's estranged ally DMK would come on board now. While most INDIA bloc parties have signed the letter digitally, the DMK, it is learnt, has refused to sign it. The letter is likely to be submitted to the CJI in the coming days.

16TH BRICS NSAs' MEETING

India welcomes Iran-US deal with 'cautious optimism', says Doval

Hold high banner of multilateralism, says Wang Yi; tense standoff between Iran and the UAE

Divya A
New Delhi, June 23

Prime Minister Narendra Modi and NSA Ajit Doval (extreme right) with the top security officials of BRICS countries, in New Delhi on Tuesday. ANI

NATIONAL SECURITY Advisor (NSA) Ajit Doval said on Tuesday that India welcomes the Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) between the United States and Iran with "cautious optimism" and is hopeful it will help energy security.

Speaking at the 16th BRICS NSAs' meeting in New Delhi, Doval said, "India welcomes the MoU reached between the US and Iran. We have got cautious optimism, and we hope that it will work. It will help energy security. The opening of the Strait of Hormuz is a very welcome development."

Chinese Foreign Minister Wang Yi, Russian Security Council Secretary Sergei Shoigu and Iran's Deputy Secretary of the Supreme National Security Council Ghadir Nezamipour were among the BRICS countries' representatives who attended the meeting.

The group of top national security officials also called on Prime Minister Narendra Modi. "In a changing global landscape, BRICS has a vital role in deepening security cooperation and addressing shared challenges, from terrorism and cyber security to emerging technologies," PM Modi posted on X.

The National Security Advisers and heads of delegation from BRICS member countries exchanged views on security challenges confronting the world. "In the non-traditional realm, they deliberated on challenges related to energy security, food security, supply chain security, emerging technologies utilized by terrorist networks, cyber security and climate-induced instability," said a statement by MEA at the conclusion of the meeting.

"We are meeting at a very tumultuous time. The world is beleaguered by military conflicts and complex security problems. It is facing geopolitical uncertainties, economic strains and disruptive technology," Doval said.

"Not only that the threats are compounding, but the instruments and institutional mechanisms are increasingly finding themselves to be inadequate to resolve or mitigate these conflicts. Multilateralism is on the decline," Doval said.

Meanwhile, tensions erupted between the delegates of Iran and the United Arab Emirates as Iranian officials formally accused the UAE of direct involvement in military strikes against Iran during the operations by the US and Israel. The heated exchange mirrored tensions seen earlier at the BRICS Foreign Ministers' meeting in May.

Later, in a post on X, the Iranian Embassy in India stated that Nezamipour rejected allegations previously leveled against Tehran by the UAE representative. "Dr. Ghadir Nezamipour... rejected the allegations made against the Islamic Republic of Iran by the representative of the United Arab Emirates," the Embassy wrote.

Referring to recent developments in the region, he wrote: "The entire world witnessed that the United States and the Zionist regime were the initiators of the aggression and the crisis in the Strait of Hormuz. Part of these attacks were launched from bases located on the territory of the United Arab Emirates. Nevertheless, instead of condemning these hostile actions, the UAE directly participated in the aggression and allowed its territory to be used as a platform for attacks against Iran's civilian infrastructure, schools, and hospitals."

At the meeting, China's Foreign Minister Wang Yi called on BRICS countries to jointly respond to global challenges, from Ebola to AI, and strengthen cooperation on strategic mineral resources, according to a statement from his ministry. The Chinese diplomat said the group should "hold high ☒the banner of multilateralism" and firmly oppose unilateralism and protectionism.

NSA Doval asserted that "non-traditional threats" have advanced against conventional responses. "Non-traditional threats have transcended national borders and have developed defeat systems against conventional responses. Innovative disruptive technologies, more camouflaged variants of terrorism, cyber threats, in a world are getting increasingly digitised," he said.

"We are here from different continents, from different areas, and it's a grouping where we bring with us very diverse experiences. We have got a very special role to play in this world, which appears to be in turmoil, a world which appears to be changing, a world in which the instruments of conflict resolution are probably getting blunted," he added.

Govt tightens FCRA norms for NGOs getting foreign funds, revises penalties

Express News Service
New Delhi, June 23

Most significant changes are in the religious category for which the Home Ministry has listed activities that are allowed "excluding proselytisation"

THE HOME ministry has tightened the FCRA framework for NGOs and other associations, revising compounding penalties and rewriting the rules to make registrations purpose-specific, while expressly excluding proselytisation from several religious categories, according to gazette notifications issued on Monday.

The amended rules say registration certificates must now specify the exact purpose or purposes and the States or Union Territories where an association will operate. Applicants will have to choose their activities only from a pre-defined schedule, and existing associations have been given one year to file an intimation in the new Form FC-6F saying which purpose and geography they want to retain.

The schedule lays out permitted activities under religious, cultural, economic, educational and social heads. In the religious category, it includes "construction, renovation, and maintenance of temples, mosques, churches, gurudwaras, monasteries, synagogues, and other places of worship," along with preservation of scriptures, dharamshalas, langars and religious education. The religious category is one with the most significant changes, allowing the said activities "excluding proselytisation". The same exclusion appears in items on documentation and revival of indigenous and tribal faith practices, and on religious education, moral instruction, satsangs, discourses and meditation retreats.

One entry says support is allowed for "the study, documentation, and preservation of religious philosophy, theology and religious history (excluding proselytisation)," while another permits "conduct of religious education, moral instruction, satsangs, discourses, and meditation retreats (excluding proselytisation)". A third religious category on indigenous and tribal faith practices also carries the same rider: "documentation, preservation, and revival of indigenous and tribal faith practices, rituals and systems of worship (excluding proselytisation)".

FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

'Policies being forced upon us', say leaders as Ladakh sees shutdown

Naveed Iqbal
Srinagar, June 23

LADAKH OBSERVED a complete shutdown on Tuesday in response to a call by the Leh Apex Body and the Kargil Democratic Alliance — powerful socio-political bodies representing the two regions that make up the Union Territory.

On Saturday, representatives of both organisations had jointly announced the shutdown following a disagreement with the Union Ministry of Home Affairs over a document that recorded the "minutes of the meeting" when representatives of the groups met ministry officials on May 22.

On Tuesday, both Leh and Kargil towns, along with other areas of the Union Territory, shut down businesses to mark the protest. While the Leh administration had denied permission to the Ladakh Buddhist Association to host a "peaceful demonstration" in Leh, the Apex Body co-chairman Cherring Dorjay Lakrook had told *The Indian Express* the stir would go ahead.

Kargil Democratic Alliance (KDA) co-chairman Sajjad Kargili highlighted that the protest also marks Ladakh's resentment against policies being announced by Lieutenant Governor V K Saxena, such as the recently announced liquor policy that allows for the retail sale of hard liquor and expanding liquor outlets in the region.

"Through this protest, the people of Ladakh have also reinforced the message that we do not endorse the policies being forced upon us," Kargili said. He also stated that they had presented their case through a draft of demands and now they have received a proposal from the government on which "there is understanding that we will discuss this further", he said.

Modi gets call from Qatar's Amir after 12 Indians are killed in blast

Press Trust of India
New Delhi, June 23

PRIME MINISTER Narendra Modi on Tuesday received a phone call from the Amir of Qatar, Sheikh Tamim bin Hamad Al Thani, who expressed grief over the death of Indian nationals in a tragic accident at Ras Laffan Industrial City in that country.

Twelve Indians were among 13 killed in an explosion at an LNG facility Sunday night.

"I thank His Highness the Amir of Qatar for his phone call and condolences on the loss of lives of Indian nationals in the tragic accident at Ras Laffan Industrial City in Qatar," Modi said in a post on X.

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Bids are invited from reputed and experienced Agencies for **"Detailed Design, Construction, Testing and Commissioning of Light House Museum at National Maritime Heritage Complex at Lothal Gujarat through EPC mode"**
The Project requirements, Eligibility criteria, Selection process, etc. are included in the Tender Document, which shall be available for download from the website: **www.etenders.gov.in** from **20.06.2026 onwards.**
Prebid Meeting is on 30.06.2026 at 11:00 AM (Online), as mentioned in Vol 1 of tender document.
The last date for submission of the **Technical Bid and Financial Bid (online only) is 22.07.2026 up to 04:00 PM.**
Chief General Manager/Projects
IPRCL/Lothal

International Institute for Population Sciences
(Deemed to be University)
An Autonomous Organization of Ministry of Health & Family Welfare, Govt. of India
Govandi Station Road, Deonar, Mumbai - 400088.
Contact Details: Tel: 91-22-42372468
Email: admission@iipsindia.ac.in Website: www.iipsindia.ac.in
ADMISSION ANNOUNCEMENT – ACADEMIC YEAR 2026-2027
The International Institute for Population Sciences (IIPS), an autonomous organization established in 1956 under the Ministry of Health & Family Welfare, Government of India, invites applications for admission to the following programmes for the Academic Year 2026-2027.
• M.A/M.Sc. in Population Studies [Monthly Fellowship ₹ 5,000/-]*
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• Ph.D. in Population Studies [GoI-IIPS, UGC-JRF fellowship etc.]
• Part-time Ph.D. in Population Studies
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Last date to submit application online: 30-06-2026 (11.00 AM).
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Notice for surrender of certificate of registration as a Depository Participant pursuant to transfer of depository business to M/S Canara Bank Securities Limited.
This is to bring to the notice of general public that Canara Bank (eSyndicate) registered with SEBI as a Depository Participant under Securities and Exchange Board of India (Depositories and Participants) Regulations, 2018 bearing SEBI Registration No.: IN-DP-CDSL-398-2007 with CDSL DP ID (13050600) has ceased to function as a Depository Participant of M/s Central Depository Services (India) Limited (CDSL) pursuant to the transfer of depository business from Canara Bank(eSyndicate) to M/s Canara Bank Securities Limited (CBSL). The notices were already dispatched on 22.05.2026 to all our demat account holders informing about the transfer of depository business. Further, we are in the process of surrendering the certificate of registration granted to us by SEBI. Henceforth, Canara Bank (eSyndicate) shall not carry on any activity as a depository participant of CDSL.
In case any Client of Canara Bank (eSyndicate) has any grievance or dispute; he/she/it may report the same in writing to M/s Canara Bank Securities Limited (CBSL).
For and on behalf of Canara Bank (eSyndicate)
Sd/-
Authorised Signatory

EXPRESS Careers

NAAC GRADE A+
For The Position of VICE-CHANCELLOR of GUJARAT UNIVERSITY, Ahmedabad-380009
The Education Department,Government of Gujarat, has **constituted a search committee to recommend a panel of names for the post of Vice Chancellor, Gujarat University, Ahmedabad** as per the provision of the Gujarat Public Universities Act 2023.The Person applying for the post is expected to possess the highest level of competence, integrity, morals and institutional commitment.
Eligibility Criteria:
(I) He/She should be an eminent academician having Ph.D. Degree with a minimum of ten years of experience as a professor, or;
(ii) A distinguished academician having Ph.D. Degree with a minimum of ten years of academic/educational administrative experience in a University, reputed academic or administrative or research institute or organisation.
He/she will hold the office for a period of five years from the date on which he/she takes charge of his/her office or till he/she attains the age of sixty-five years, whichever is earlier.
The Search Committee reserves the right to consider a person of eminence outside the list of applications/nominations. In accordance with the procedure evolved by the committee, nominees would be short-listed based on agreed parameters and as per the provision of Gujarat Public Universities Act, 2023 and UGC Notifications from time to time.
The candidate should apply in the prescribed format for the post of Vice-Chancellor which is available on website www.gujaratuniversity.ac.in. The scanned soft copy of the application along with the latest passport size photograph pasted on it and duly signed should be emailed to vcsearch@gujaratuniversity.ac.in or the hard copy of Application/Nomination in the prescribed format should be submitted in a sealed envelope clearly marked "Application/ Nomination for the Post of Vice-Chancellor" addressed to **The Chairman, Search Committee, c/o. The Registrar (I/c.), Gujarat University, Navrangpura, Ahmedabad-380009 on or before: 13/07/2026 (Monday), up to 6.00 p.m.**
Place: Ahmedabad
Date: 23-06-2026
REGISTRAR (I/C)

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Weekend Traffic Court
WITH THE ASSISTANCE OF THE DELHI TRAFFIC POLICE, WEEKEND COURTS ARE BEING STARTED IN ALL DISTRICT COURTS FROM 05.07.2026. IT WILL BE HELD FROM 10:00 AM TO 04:00 PM ON THE SECOND SATURDAY OF EVERY MONTH AND EVERY SUNDAY.
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◆ Only compoundable traffic Notices/Challans of all private and commercial vehicles will be included in these courts, with a limit of maximum 20 Notices/Challans per vehicle.
◆ The Website for downloading Notices/Challans will go live on 25.06.2026 at 10:00 AM.
To download a challan, visit the Website https://traffic.delhipolice.gov.in/evecourtddc or scan the QR code.
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Padma Awards 2026: Honouring Excellence

(Clockwise from top right) PM Narendra Modi, Lok Sabha Speaker Om Birla, Home Minister Amit Shah and Union Minister Piyush Goyal look on as the wife of JMM patriarch and tribal leader Shibu Soren receives the Padma Bhushan (posthumous) from President Droupadi Murmu on Tuesday. Singer Alka Yagnik (Padma Bhushan); Director of IIT Madras, Prof. Veezhinathan Kamakoti (Padma Shri); tennis legend Dr Vijay Amritraj (Padma Bhushan); cricketer Rohit Sharma (Padma Shri); and actor Mammootty (Padma Bhushan) also received their honours at the ceremony held at Rashtrapati Bhavan. Actor Satish Shah was awarded Padma Shri posthumously. ANI & PTI

Day after 'replacing' Mamata as TMC chief, rebel MLAs move EC

Ravik Bhattacharya
Kolkata, June 23

A DAY after removing Mamata Banerjee as the Trinamool Congress (TMC) chairperson and appointing their own national working committee of the party, the party's rebel MLAs on Tuesday moved the Election Commission (EC) to likely lay claim to the party name and symbol.

This move came amid the ongoing tug of war between the rebels and the party led by Banerjee, whom they removed as chairperson at a special session on Monday. In response, Banerjee has sent the EC a list of members who comprise the TMC's actual national working committee, including her as the chairperson, heir apparent Abhishek Banerjee as the national general secretary and the party's Lok Sabha leader, Derek O Brien and Dola Sen as joint secretaries, Subhashish Chakraborty as treasurer, and Sovondeb Chatterjee as the leader in the Assembly.

The rebel MLAs' decision to replace her as the TMC chairperson has pushed Banerjee — already battling a breakaway group of Lok Sabha MPs who have aligned with the NDA and the resignation of three Rajya Sabha MPs — into a corner. With the rebel camp looking at the EC for recognition as the real TMC, Banerjee's letter to the poll body is a counter as she

The former CM is left with a shrinking band of loyalists. FILE

fights to hold on to the party she founded in 1998.

For the moment, the former Chief Minister, whom the rebels want to remain in an advisory role, is left with a shrinking band of loyalists — Kalyan Banerjee, Madan Mitra, Mohua Moitra, Sougata Roy, Nadimul Haq, and Kunal Ghosh are part of the new committee — and is slowly losing options both in Bengal and Delhi. The rebels are likely preparing the ground to stake claim to the party name and symbol of "*jora ghash phool* (twin flowers with grass)". In addition to this, the TMC's bank accounts, with Rs 440 crore in them, have been frozen following a complaint by the rebels, who have demanded an audit.

In retaliation, the TMC has expelled several rebel MLAs and former ministers in the rebel faction, including Roy; MLAs Javed Khan, Firhad Hakim, Rathin Ghosh, Biplab Mitra, and Sabina Yeasmin; and former ministers Aroop Biswas and Snehashis Chakraborty, who are all part of their 30-member national working committee.

However, the rebels are not perturbed by their expulsions, confident they have the numbers on their side. Apart from more than 60 MLAs, more than 40 councillors from different civic bodies attended the special session. "We are the real Trinamool Congress. We have a Leader of the Opposition (LoP) as per our choice, the choice of more than two-thirds in the Assembly. Obviously, we have a claim on the symbol. If it is challenged, we will show our majority. Apart from the MLAs. we have support from the elected councillors and leaders from different parts of the state," said a senior MLA with the rebel bloc.

The loyalists publicly claimed they were confident about retaining the party symbol and access to the bank accounts, with sources close to Mamata Banerjee saying they were waiting for the rebels to move the EC. The party will then challenge the rebels in the polling body and move court on the issue. Chattopadhyay has already filed a case against the Assembly Speaker in the Calcutta High Court for recognising Ritabrata as the Assembly LoP.

FULL REPORT ON
WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

Will UBT legislators revolt now? Meet the 4 who skipped key meet

Vallabh Ozarkar
Mumbai, June 23

AS THE Shiv Sena (UBT) emerges from the exit of six MPs, who joined the Eknath Shinde-led Shiv Sena on Monday, the absence of four legislators from the meeting called by party chief Uddhav Thackeray in Mumbai on Monday has yet again raised eyebrows. Sena (UBT) leaders, however, claimed the absence was not unusual and the absentees had explained their stands separately for skipping the meeting at Shivalay, the party's legislative office in Mumbai. The also said that legislators' absence from the meeting must not be linked to MPs shifting sides.

Those who skipped the meeting included MLAs Sanjay Potnis, Rahul Patil and Sanjay Derkar, and MLC Sunil Shinde.

Here is a look at who these legislators are.

Sanjay Potnis and Rahul Patil (right) are among the MLAs who skipped the meeting on Monday

Sanjay Potnis

Among the party's older faces in Mumbai who stood by Uddhav during the 2022 split, 70-year-old Potnis currently is the MLA from Kalina and said he could not attend Monday's meeting as he had some work.

Potnis first won the seat in 2014, defeating the Congress's Kripashankar Singh, who was seen to be an influential leader. He retained the seat in 2019 and 2024, making him one of the Sena (UBT)'s few three-term MLAs from Mumbai.

His absence drew attention because Mumbai currently is the Sena (UBT)'s strongest remaining political base after the split and Potnis is among the party's senior city legislators.

Rahul Patil

Patil, 50, currently represents the Parbhani seat in the Assembly and his absence did not go unnoticed as the district is in the limelight after Parbhani MP Sanjay Jadhav crossed over to the Shinde camp. Patil has represented Parbhani since 2014. In the 2024 Assembly elections, he defeated the BJP's Anand Bharose. The three-time MLA cited MLC election results as well as preparations for Uddhav's upcoming visit to the district as reasons for skipping the meeting.

Sunil Shinde

A former MLA from Worli, currently represented by Aaditya Thackeray, 63-year-old Shinde was among the senior party leaders from Mumbai who backed Uddhav during the split.

He currently represents the Mumbai Local Authorities constituency in the Council and cited commitments in his hometown as a reason for skipping the meeting.

Sanjay Derkar

A relatively newer face of the Sena (UBT), Derkar, 60, currently represents the Wani seat in the Assembly. In the 2024 elections, he defeated BJP sitting MLA Sanjivreddy Bodkurwar by over 15,000 votes, giving the Sena (UBT) an opening in Vidarbha.

EXPRESS special

BJP top brass pulls up Karnataka leaders for loss in MLC elections

Liz Mathew & Akram M
New Delhi, Bengaluru, June 23

THE BJP'S central leadership on Tuesday pulled up its Karnataka unit over cross-voting that marred its chances in last week's MLC elections, with national president Nitin Nabin seeking an explanation for what sources described as "indiscipline" within party ranks.

On Tuesday, Nabin met Karnataka BJP president B Y Vijayendra, Leader of Opposition in the Karnataka Assembly R Ashoka, and BJP national general secretary in-charge of Karnataka Radha Mohan Das Agarwal in Delhi.

Sources said Nabin questioned the leaders about the cross-voting and sought an explanation. The central leadership is now awaiting the report of the three-member committee headed by C T Ravi before deciding on further action. The panel is expected to submit its findings on June 25.

The meeting comes days after the BJP suffered an embarrassment in the June 13 polls to seven Council seats, where cross-voting by some of its MLAs

Sources said party president Nitin Nabin questioned the leaders about the cross-voting and sought an explanation. PTI

upset the party's calculations and triggered a blame game within the BJP-JD(S) alliance.

Following intervention from the BJP top leadership, the Karnataka BJP has decided against holding a Legislature Party meeting at Sri Dharmasthala Manjunatheshwara Temple. The meeting was planned to identify legislators suspected of cross-voting against the party.

Sources said there were plans to make BJP legislators swear before the temple deity in an attempt to identify those who had voted against the party line.

While those close to Vijayendra argued that it was the responsibility of the BJP Legislature Party leadership to ensure MLAs voted together in favour of the party's candidates, the Ashoka camp maintained that the state unit should have ensured ally JD(S) did not field a eighth candidate. However, a section of BJP leaders alleged that "some BJP leaders who had a grudge against Vijayendra had egged on and misled H D Kumaraswamy" into fielding an additional candidate.

The MLAs, sources said, were not persuaded by the leadership against cross-voting.

A senior Karnataka BJP leader said Kumaraswamy had been warned that his candidate stood little chance of winning. "There are some JD(S) MLAs who are ready to switch over to the Congress after D K Shivakumar took over (as Chief Minister)," the leader claimed.

"(The BJP central leadership in) Delhi is upset, and naturally so. Developments in Karnataka have come as a spoiler amid the party's recent gains nationally. Kumaraswamy claims his candidate was defeated deliberately, but there was no realistic chance of victory. Now he is blaming the BJP," the leader said.

Speaking to reporters in Delhi, Ashoka said while the proposal to hold the Legislature Party meeting in Dharmasthala had come on the advice of senior leaders, the state unit decided against using a temple for political purposes.

"We have decided to solve it at the party level," Ashoka said, adding that cross-voting was not unprecedented and had occurred on several occasions in the past.

He also targeted Shivakumar, accusing him of engineering defections during the election. "Using money power and muscle power is in his nature. We will discuss how to face him in the coming days. He has paid Rs 5 crore to Rs 10 crore to legislators," Ashoka alleged.

Both Ashoka and Vijayendra briefed Nabin about the cross-voting episode during their meeting. "Based on the information provided by us, he assured us that action would be taken against those responsible at the appropriate time," Ashoka said.

Not Guwahati, Japan PM to visit Delhi for annual summit

Express News Service
New Delhi, June 23

JAPANESE PRIME Minister Sanae Takaichi is set to visit India from July 1-3, her first visit to the country after assuming office in October 2025 for the annual India-Japan Summit.

While Guwahati was also considered as a possible venue for the visit, sources said Tuesday that due to "logistical issues", it has now been shifted to New Delhi.

"Given PM Takaichi's domestic commitments, the window between her proposed arrival in India and her departure is quite tight. In view of this and the additional logistical issues connected to a visit outside the Capital, the visit is likely to be held in New Delhi," the sources said. This would also accommodate certain programming elements which both sides are keen on in bid to boost bilateral ties, they said.

Assam CM Himanta Biswa Sarma said at a press conference Tuesday, "Foreign Secretary Vikram Misri informed our chief secretary last night that the Japanese PM's proposed visit to Assam will not be happening..."

THESE PARTIES, ALONG WITH THE BJP, CAME TO OCCUPY THE SPACE VACATED BY A DECLINING CONGRESS. BUT NOW, THEY MAY BE RUNNING OUT OF STEAM

The unravelling of regional parties: Why they are imploding, and what next

THE NEERJA CHOWDHURY COLUMN

WEEKLY INSIGHT INTO WHAT'S CHANGING IN NATIONAL POLITICS – AND WHY

WITH THE sudden implosion of a regional party such as the Trinamool Congress (TMC) within weeks of its defeat in West Bengal and a second split set to take place in the Shiv Sena (UBT), the signal has gone out that the sands are shifting rapidly and, in time, other regional parties could also be headed the same way.

It is the speed with which the parties are unravelling and the scale on which the splits are taking place that have taken many by surprise. The 80-MLA-strong TMC broke up in the West Bengal Assembly within weeks of its defeat and this was followed by 20 of the 28 Lok Sabha MPs of the party announcing both their bloc's merger with a little-known party called the Nationalist Citizens Party of India (NCPI) and support for the BJP-led NDA in Parliament. And on Monday, the rebel MLAs replaced Banerjee herself as the TMC chairperson, setting the stage for a court battle over who constitutes the real party.

It is hardly a secret that after its defeat in the Lok Sabha in April, the BJP would like to move towards acquiring a two-thirds majority in Parliament. It would allow it to pass the Constitutional amendment Bill seeking to advance the reservation of 33% seats for women in an expanded Lok Sabha and state Assemblies and facilitate delimitation of constituencies.

The BJP sees women's support and delimitation as critical to its efforts to retain power in 2029. It saw the advantage that the redrawing of constituencies gave it in the recent elections in Assam. So, it lost no time in going for the kill as soon as the TMC was routed in Bengal, as well as in Tamil Nadu and Maharashtra, to shore up its numbers in Parliament.

From all accounts, it is reworking the delimitation Bill to address some of the reservations of the DMK. Using both the carrot and the stick, the BJP would like to bring the DMK's 22 Lok Sabha MPs on board. Many feel that the DMK — already miffed with the Congress for dumping it and siding with actor Vijay's TVK — may agree to go along with the "reworked" Delimitation Bill, either by abstaining or providing issue-based support to the ruling party. If that happens. the BJP will have lined up an additional 48 Lok Sabha MPs — 20 TMC rebels, 22 from the DMK, six from the Shiv Sena (UBT) who are all set to join the Eknath Shinde-led Shiv Sena — to the NDA tally of 293 and will be just 19 short of the two-thirds mark of 360 (the current strength of the Lok Sabha is 540).

It is important to look at the reasons why parties such as the TMC are suddenly coming apart at the seams. FILE

Dominance of 'careerists'

While the BJP knows what it is about, it is important to look at the reasons why parties such as the TMC and the Sena (UBT) are suddenly coming apart at the seams. Some of these so-called rebels may fear action by the Indian "ICE": Income Tax, CBI, and Enforcement Directorate. Yet, others know they may not get elected in 2029 on their parent party's ticket and there are reports that the BJP has assured them tickets in 2029. And yet others feel — and the rebel Sena (UBT) MPs have expressed this openly — they will get funds for the development of their constituencies if they side with the ruling party. Most importantly, many feel it is going to be a long haul for the Opposition and that it is better to be on the BJP's side, given its near-invincible position today.

While the older politicians cut their teeth in politics through student movements and espousing social causes, the younger breed in the TMC, for instance, is made up of careerists. Yesterday, it was a good career move to join the TMC; today, it makes more sense to support the NDA. Many of the under-50s have seen the TMC in power and may not have an appetite for a role in the Opposition. "Today, it takes courage just to be in the Opposition," an Opposition leader said stoically.

Recent events have changed the idea of what constitutes a mandate in Indian democracy. The "aaya Ram, gaya Ram" phenomenon — a Hindi phrase that was coined to refer to serial turncoats in the late 1960s — is not new. In 1980, when Indira Gandhi returned to power, Haryana CM Bhajan Lal, who headed a Janata Party government, shifted the entire Legislature Party to the Congress and became a Congress CM overnight.

A new legitimacy is now being frequently granted to the acquisition of a majority by breaking parties. Forget the moral compasses that existed in the years gone by; gone also are the fig leaves that once existed.

The 'Abhishek phenomenon'

Recent events have shown that the regional parties may well be running out of steam. They, along with the BJP, had come to occupy some of the space vacated by a Congress in decline and it spawned a coalition era from 1990 onwards.

The state satraps who built their empires — be it Mulayam Singh Yadav, Lalu Prasad, Nitish Kumar, Mamata, K Chandrashekar Rao, H D Deve Gowda, or M K Stalin (though the Dravidian parties have been better anchored ideologically) — passed on the baton to a member of their family rather than to a trusted colleague. With big money involved, a leader tends to trust a son, a daughter, or a wife more than a colleague. Leaders also feel the need for emotional support, for the top is a lonely place and the higher you go the lonelier it gets.

But now a reaction seems to be setting in, maybe not against the dynastic principle, but against how dynasts function. That can be summed up as the "Abhishek phenomenon".

There had obviously been a simmering discontent in the TMC against the leadership of Mamata's nephew and heir apparent Abhishek Banerjee, who had been given unfettered control of the party. The BJP was able to fish in the TMC's troubled waters because of the intensity of that sentiment, which Mamata was not able to either gauge and defuse, or chose to ignore. The recent spate of splits comes as a warning to other parties — to reflect and course correct.

(Neerja Chowdhury, Contributing Editor, The Indian Express, has covered the last 11 Lok Sabha elections. She is the author of How Prime Ministers Decide.)

Union Home Minister Amit Shah launched four new initiatives of NAFED on Tuesday

Shah: NAFED to share 1% profit for education of farmers' children

Express News Service
New Delhi, June 23

UNION HOME Minister Amit Shah Tuesday launched four new initiatives of National Agricultural Cooperative Marketing Federation of India Ltd (NAFED), and announced that it will earmark 1% of its profits for higher education scholarships and career development of children from farmer families.

Among the four new initiatives are Nafex.in, an agri e-auction platform; Drishti, an inventory management system; the NAFED's Enterprise Resource Planning (ERP) Solution; NAFED Kalyan, a scholarship for farmers' children.

Shah said output of pulses and oilseeds had risen in recent years, but self-sufficiency remained elusive as minimum support prices were not reaching growers. "There is a need to get rid of middlemen. Time has come for both NAFED and NCCF to procure pulses and oilseeds directly from farmers to ensure benefits reach them."

Shah has set a two-year deadline, saying farmers would be able to sell directly to the two cooperatives and receive payment without intermediaries. India imports 6-7 million tonnes of pulses and 15-16 million tonnes of edible oils annually to bridge domestic shortfalls.

Army initiates procurement of 3 target systems for aerial warfare

Amrita Nayak Dutta
New Delhi, June 23

MONTHS AFTER procuring a range of unmanned aerial vehicles (UAVs) and air defence (AD) missiles to bolster its combat capabilities, the Army has now initiated the acquisition of three target systems designed to simulate drone swarms, helicopters and missile-like threats, signalling a renewed focus on preparing troops for evolving aerial warfare.

Over the past year, the Army has made significant purchases of drones and air defence missiles, among other modern platforms, many of which were through the emergency route to fill identified capability gaps.

Earlier this month, the Army initiated the procurement for intermediate target system (rocket), basic target system (swarm drones) and basic target system (multirotor helicopter) which will be used to train the troops to counter a range of aerial threats. Three requests for information (RFIs) have been issued to gather details from vendors regarding the three systems. In the RFIs, the Army stated that the air threat is rapidly evolving beyond just manned 4th- and 5th-generation aircraft and smart bombs — to include cruise missiles and unmanned aerial systems.

Thereby, it stated that crews/detachments of units and students undergoing courses at training institutes to counter evolving air threats need to be empowered by providing them with suitable targets. According to the three RFIs, the intermediate target system (rocket) will provide an intermediate-level target for the firing of infrared-based air defence missiles; the basic target system (multirotor helicopter) will provide a basic unit-level target to depict a slow-moving helicopter target for the firing of air defence weapons; and separately, the basic target system (swarm drones) would provide a system for the firing of air defence weapons and directed energy weapons authorised to Army Air Defence units.

EXPRESS special

FB Live & a shooting: Youth's killing in police encounter shakes Bihar

Himanshu Harsh
Bilauti (Bhojpur), June 23

IN A half-constructed, single-storey house in one corner of Bilauti village in Bihar's Ara, Kashinath Tiwari sits on a cot. Around him, there's intense activity — vehicles lining both sides of the narrow road leading to the house from the Ara-Buxar highway bring a steady stream of politicians and civil servants — but former police constable driver Kashinath Tiwari remains seated, his silence cutting through the chatter.

On June 17, Kashinath's 28-year-old son, Bharat Bhushan Tiwari, who was known to take up local issues, was killed in a police encounter after a two-day standoff that was live-streamed to his 1.6 lakh Facebook subscribers. Since then, politicians across party lines have flocked to the family home, even as the encounter itself becomes a subject of intense scrutiny. "On the day of the encounter, I left home around 6 am to go to the police station to talk with the SHO, but they kept me there under supervision till evening. I was at the police station when my grandson came and told me what happened," Kashinath said.

For their part, police maintain that Tiwari was armed and "mentally unsound", leading them to shoot him in self-defence after attempts to bring him in peacefully failed. But the Tiwari family and villagers have alleged he was fatally shot after agreeing to surrender, citing a Facebook Live video that purportedly shows him throwing down his gun. They described him as a social worker, claiming his criticism of delays in rehabilitating last year's Bhojpur flood victims had pitted him against local officials. Bhojpur SP Raj said an FIR has been registered, legal action has been initiated, and a judicial inquiry has been ordered. The police have yet to receive the post-mortem report.

Chief Minister Samrat Choudhary, too, ordered an inquiry, while Bihar Education Minister Mithilesh Tiwari called it an "unfortunate incident". "The boy also displayed inappropriate behaviour on social media. However, police should have investigated his criminal background first. Even if an encounter was necessary, it should have been a 'half encounter' instead of a full one," he said.

Competing versions

The third of four children of a police constable driver and a homemaker, Tiwari was a BSc graduate who once dreamt of joining the police force. In a press release Tuesday, the office of the Bhojpur SP said they first visited the house after receiving

Bharat Bhushan Tiwari, 28, in a Facebook Live on June 28

reports that Tiwari was moving around armed and behaving erratically. "When officers visited his residence, they found that the individual seen in widely circulated videos was 'mentally unsound'," it read. "The process to send him to a mental hospital had been initiated, and police and medical teams were attempting to take him into safe custody. We appeal to the public not to circulate misleading videos related to the case."

By Wednesday morning, the situation had turned into an armed confrontation, with Tiwari sustaining bullet injuries in an encounter in a nearby field. He was taken first to Shahpur Referral Hospital, then to Ara and finally to PMCH, where he died during treatment. Police later claimed he continued firing intermittently, forcing them to retaliate in self-defence. A pistol, a magazine, two live cartridges and two spent shells were recovered, the Bhojpur SP said.

Family members and eyewitnesses dispute these claims and insist Tiwari had surrendered. Surrounded by relatives in one of the back rooms of the house, Asha Devi claimed her son was killed "because of the issues he raised". "Police arrived at 6 am on June 16, a day before the encounter. They asked for Bharat, searched rooms and threatened to kill us all. Bharat, who had bought a pistol for self-protection, emerged looking agitated, pointed the weapon at them, and asked them to leave," Asha said, adding that the personnel allegedly returned at midnight. "Bharat, who was sleeping on the roof, told them off for sneaking up in the darkness and asked them to return in the day. The next day, the local police and Bhojpur STF returned at 9 am with bulletproof jackets and surrounded the area," she claimed.

Police told Tiwari that his demands would be met, the family said. "They asked him to go with them to show what issues needed to be resolved," Tiwari's younger brother Chandan said. "He was taken to the field and shot. We tried to follow them but were stopped. We thought he would be arrested under the Arms Act... we never imagined he would be shot dead so coldly."

The videos

Tiwari's Facebook Live has now become the focal point of contradicting claims. During the livestream, Tiwari referred to himself as a "krantikari (revolutionary)". Videos purportedly showed him lying on a cot with a pistol, while now suspended SHO Rajesh Malakar, family members and police personnel attempted to calm him. "These people want to prove me mad. When Bhagat Singh was fighting for society and the country, he too was declared mad," he's heard saying. Seconds later, he purportedly fired toward a distant police van, saying: "*Rukiye, inko abhi hum apna pagalpan dikhate hain* (Wait, I'll show them madness)". In his last video on June 17, ostensibly shot minutes before he was killed, Tiwari's heard saying he is "willing to lay down his weapon if authorities addressed his concerns". The video, shot on a kuchha road between open fields, shows a group of cops standing in front of police vehicles.

The issue has become a political flashpoint, with voices not only from the Opposition but also within the ruling establishment questioning the police action.

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LUCKNOW FIRE, A DAY AFTER

Young lives cut short by the tragedy: 'He said he's hiding in the bathroom'

The Indian Express speaks to families, friends on the lives and final moments of some of those killed in the blaze that broke out in a commercial building

ADITYA SRIVASTAVA, 24
SITAPUR, UTTAR PRADESH

JOINED Head Hoppers Studio as a junior artist 4 months ago. Aditya, friends said, was someone who would always show up when needed. Even before his family arrived, several friends rushed to the spot and were with his mother and sister at the mortuary. "He liked by everyone," a friend said.

Family members of Sanyam Vijj in Kanpur on Tuesday. PTI

SURAJ SINGH, 27
KANPUR, UTTAR PRADESH

THE ELDEST among three children, Suraj was family's breadwinner after his father died 3 years ago. His mother and younger brother were on a trip to Rishikesh, at the time of the incident. Around 9.30 pm Monday officials contacted his cousin. His mother rushed to Lucknow, only to perform her son's last rites.

ABDUL REHMAN, 24
LUCKNOW, UTTAR PRADESH

WORKED IN the firm's art production and game development unit for 3 years. Abdul was the sole breadwinner of his family after his father got paralysed. "We called him multiple times but he didn't answer. We rushed to Aliganj to find his office in flames. We then went to the medical college," Salman, his friend, said.

ARTISTS, DESIGNERS, game developers: 15 young lives were cut short in the Lucknow fire that gutted a three-story building on Monday. Most of the victims worked at Head Hopper Studios, a company involved in 3D art production and game development. Some of them made panicked calls to their families before the phone lines went dead. *The Indian Express* speaks to eight families to piece together the lives that were lost. Most of the victims worked at Head Hopper Studios, a company involved in 3D art production and game development. Some of them made panicked calls to their families before the phone lines went dead. —**MAULSHREE SETH & MANISH SAHU**

SUKHMANI SINGH, 23
LUCKNOW, UTTAR PRADESH

WORKED AS a game designer at the company; joined in 2022. His father, Prabhjot Singh, had said his son called him around 2 pm, pleading for help. "'Papa *mujhe bacha lo* (Papa, save me)', he cried. He told us there was no space to get out." His brother, Saheban, said Sukhmani had trained at the same institute in 2019 and had later joined the company as a designer.

NEELESH KUMAR, 28
LUCKNOW, UTTAR PRADESH

ARTIST AT Head Hoppers Studio, joined around three years ago. He was engaged to Anamika. "We knew about the fire, but we did not take it seriously because there was no indication that Neelesh's workplace was in the same building," said his brother Abhishek. "In the evening, we received a call from the mortuary, informing us about his death."

JAINIL CHAKRABORTY, 27
KOTMA, MADHYA PRADESH

WORKED AT Head Hoppers Studio as a 3D character artist since 2023. His father, Jayant Chakraborty, said Jainil used to live in Lucknow with his aunt. He studied at a Kendriya Vidyalaya in MP and then went to MAAC, Pune, to study graphic design. They were handed over his body Tuesday and left Lucknow via train.

BHAVISYA, 20
SONIPAT, HARYANA

Bhavisya joined the firm a few weeks ago. "Bhavisya called his father in panic after fire broke out... the call got disconnected, and then his phone was unreachable," said Anuradha, his relative. "At his father's request, I went to the site to check. By then, he had already left for Lucknow," she said.

MOHAMMAD SHAJAHAN, 19
BARABANKI, UTTAR PRADESH

JOINED HEAD Hoppers Studio about a year ago. Originally from Barabanki, Shajahan and his family moved to Lucknow a few years ago. His father, Md Imran, worked in Dubai as a driver. "He called his family after the fire, pleading for help. Shajahan told his father he and others were in a bathroom to escape the flames, smoke," said Shakeel Siddiqui, his cousin.

SANYAM VIJ, 19, KANPUR, UP

SANYAM WORKED as a 3D artist at the firm he joined with his close friend, and victim, Suraj. Sanyam's father died around 15 years ago. Sanyam had been living in Lucknow for 3 years. He was expected home Tuesday for his grandmother's funeral rites. Sanyam's last rites were performed Tuesday.

ANAMIKA SAMANTA, 27
KOLKATA, WEST BENGAL

ARTIST AT Head Hoppers Studio, joined around 3 years ago. She and Neelesh were engaged. Anamika's younger brother, Akash, recalled the family's trip to Lucknow to meet Neelesh's family. "My sister had told our parents about Neelesh some time ago. I went to Lucknow with my parents, and we visited Neelesh's home," he said.

More than 100 coaching centres face action; SIT begins probe

Express News Service
Lucknow, June 23

A DAY after the tragic fire at a coaching centre in Lucknow's Aliganj, the Uttar Pradesh government has launched a statewide inspection crackdown against coaching institutes flouting building safety norms, even as the SIT began its probe into the incident on Tuesday.

Inspections were carried out at coaching centres and institutes across major cities, including Lucknow, Kanpur, Prayagraj, Varanasi, Gorakhpur, Agra and Meerut, with more than 100 institutes facing action for allegedly violating safety and building norms.

Acting on Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath's directions, joint teams comprising officials from the administration, police, fire services, development authorities and electrical safety departments carried out inspections across various districts on Tuesday. The inspections focused on fire-fighting equipment, emergency exits, structural safety of buildings and compliance with regulatory requirements. Authorities also checked whether institutes were operating with valid registrations and permits.

One of the biggest crackdowns was reported from Kanpur's coaching hub, Kakadeo, where more than 30 coaching institutes were sealed by teams of the Kanpur Development Authority and fire department. Officials reportedly found several serious violations, including the use of basements — approved only for parking — as classrooms accommodating large numbers of students. In many cases, fire safety clearances were either absent or no longer valid. Similar action was reported from Mirzapur, where around a dozen institutions were sealed.

Meanwhile, the SIT on Tuesday started its probe, conducting a detailed inspection of the gutted building and interacting with injured victims undergoing treatment at the KGMU hospital. The two-member SIT, constituted on the directions of the CM, comprises Additional Chief Secretary (Tourism and Culture) Amrit Abhijat and ADG (Lucknow Zone) Praveen Kumar. The team spent over an hour examining different sections of the building. Officials said the team documented the site extensively through photos and examined aspects related to the origin and spread of the fire.

IDFC First Bank fraud case: CBI arrests 2nd Haryana IAS officer

Sukhbir Siwach
Chandigarh, June 23

THE CBI has arrested IAS officer Pankaj Agarwal in connection with the alleged siphoning off of over Rs 60 crore from accounts of the Haryana School Shiksha Pariyojna Parishad (HSSPP) and the Haryana State Agriculture Marketing Board (HSAMB) maintained with the IDFC First Bank, officials said on Tuesday.

A special CBI court remanded Agarwal in two-day custody of the CBI. The 2000-batch Haryana cadre officer, who served as principal secretary in the education and agriculture ministries when the alleged misappropriation took place, was arrested on Monday after it emerged that accounts were opened at the bank's Sector 32 branch in Chandigarh in violation of norms and funds were transferred in them beyond prescribed limits, leading to a loss of Rs 60.54 crore to the exchequer.

The case is part of the CBI probe into embezzlement of Rs 657 crore from the accounts of the Haryana government (Rs 504 crore) and Chandigarh administration (Rs 153 crore) maintained at IDFC First Bank. The agency said it has collected incriminating evidence against Agarwal — who is the second IAS officer, after Ram Kumar Singh (2012-batch) — to be arrested in the case.

Agarwal, however, is not new to controversies. The Opposition Congress, led by former chief minister Bhupinder Singh Hooda, had questioned his credentials as the Returning Officer in the Rajya Sabha polls in March this year, describing it as "dubious" while submitting a representation against him to the Governor. Agarwal, however, had maintained that he acted strictly in accordance with the Election Commission's rules and instructions.

In April this year, after the names of several senior officers surfaced in the IDFC First Bank scam, they were shifted from important assignments and posted to relatively insignificant departments. Agarwal, who had been handling major portfolios such as irrigation and mines, was transferred as principal secretary in the architecture department in April. The Haryana government had in May granted the CBI permission to probe the alleged role of several senior IAS officers, including Agarwal, in the IDFC First Bank fraud case.

LOHAGAD FORT MURDER

'Treated her like family': Grief, disbelief at Ketan Agarwal's Pune house

Sushant Kulkarni & Shubham Kurale
Pune, June 23

FIVE DAYS after 26-year-old Ketan Agarwal's death at Lohagad Fort was initially believed to be an accident, his family is grappling with grief and disbelief following police revelations that the incident was allegedly a planned murder.

Ketan, a resident of Lodha Belmondo township in Gahunje, died on June 18 after falling into a 350-foot-deep valley while visiting Lohagad Fort near Lonavala. Police was initially informed that he had slipped while clicking photos near the edge of the fort. However, it was learnt on Monday that the case was "not accidental", and police have arrested two accused.

Ketan's father Vishal Agarwal said that the family had trusted the accused and never imagined such an outcome. "My son got engaged in February this year to Siya Pravinkumar Goyal. On June 18, she insisted that Ketan join her for a trek in Lohagad ahead of her birthday celebrations. He left home around 8.20 am. By 10.45 am, we received a call informing us that he had fallen into the valley... By the time we reached, his body was recovered by rescue teams."

"At that time, we did not suspect foul play. However, when police brought back Ketan's body, we expected that Siya would be in grief after losing her life partner, but she did not react. I suspected something was suspicious... Later, details started emerging during the police probe which completely changed our understanding of what had happened," he said.

Police said it was revealed during the probe that Siya was allegedly in a relationship with another accused, Chetan Babulal Chaudhary, and the duo had

Ketan's father Vishal Agarwal at their residence in Pune. EXPRESS

conspired to kill Ketan. "Even on June 14, Siya had forced Ketan to join her on a trek to Lohagad. She allegedly tried to push him downhill, but Ketan managed to balance himself by holding onto a bush. She immediately hugged him and claimed there was a snake nearby, and that was why she had pushed him... I believe it was her first attempt to kill Ketan, but it was foiled."

Referring to police findings, Agarwal said, "We never imagined something like this would happen. We had known Siya's family for nearly 35-40 years, and had complete faith in them. Losing a 26-year-old son in such circumstances is devastating. There are no words to describe what we are going through." Demanding a comprehensive probe into the case, the bereaved father said, "Police have arrested two accused, but I feel the probe should examine every possible angle. If other members of Siya's family are involved, their role should also come to light."

Ketan's mother Rakhi Agarwal, meanwhile, said, "We treated Siya like our family. She visited our home several times and was accepted as daughter-in-law by everyone in our joint family. We never doubted her intentions. We want strict action against those responsible."

24 Marathwada colleges barred from BSc admissions

Pallavi Smart
Mumbai, June 23

SWAMI RAMANAND Teerth Marathwada University in Maharashtra's Nanded has barred admissions to first-year BSc courses in 24 affiliated colleges due to "lack of labs and faculty members" required to run the programme. The action was taken after an Academic and Administrative Audit (AAA) of affiliated colleges.

The university authorities said that admissions to the first year of the BSc courses have been suspended for academic year 2026-27, giving these colleges another year to make the required arrangements and resume admissions from the next, as their affiliation continues. They are also allowed to admit students to non-BSc courses.

Authorities also said that the decision was taken to ensure that no compromise is made on the quality of higher education. The circular issued by the university stated: "During the AAA inspection, undergraduate colleges offering the BSc programme were found to have received an 'F' grade. In addition, some colleges did not submit proposals for the AAA Online inspection..." As many as 162 colleges affiliated to the university offer the BSc programme.

Gujarat AAP MLA, wife get 7-yr jail for assaulting forest officials

Aditi Raja
Vadodara, June 23

In a setback for AAP, a court in Gujarat's Narmada district on Tuesday sentenced AAP MLA Chaitar Vasava, his wife, and seven others to seven years in jail in a 2023 case related to the alleged assault and extortion of forest officials.

Additional Sessions Judge A V Hirpara also imposed a fine of Rs 25,000 on Chaitar. "At present, all the accused have been ordered to be kept in judicial custody at the Rajpipla sub-jail.

In addition, the accused have filed an application seeking transfer to a jail in another district, as their presence in Narmada could disturb law and order," Prosecutor Vandana Bhatt said.

"One of the four convicted women is pregnant and another has a newborn child. Therefore, her lawyer has submitted an application requesting that the child be allowed to stay with its mother in jail," she added.

Bhatt also said the accused had previously been released on a one-year probation in the case.

However, since they allegedly committed offences again, she said, "taking all circumstances into consideration, the court has imposed the present sentence". Chaitar, who is the party's working president in the state. Chaitar has emerged as one of the party's most influential tribal leaders since its 2022 Assembly election breakthrough.

His win from the Dediapada constituency in the 2022 elections handed the AAP a foothold in the tribal heartland of south Gujarat. His political identity has been built largely on championing tribal land rights.

The conviction comes at a politically sensitive moment for the AAP in Gujarat, which is riding on Chaitar Vasava's popularity among tribal voters. The party recently scripted one of its biggest local body successes in the state, wresting control of the Narmada District Panchayat from the BJP and winning key taluka panchayats across the tribal belt.

This case dates back to October 30, 2023, when Chaitar allegedly summoned five forest department officials to his Dediapada house after they had directed villagers, to clear encroachments on forest land.

UTTARAKHAND

Three-day gurdwara standoff ends, Nihang Sikhs group leaves

Aiswarya Raj
Dehradun, June 23

AFTER A three-day standoff between a group of Nihang Sikhs and the management of a gurdwara in Uttarakhand's Rudraprayag, during which they occupied the rooftop of the building, the group has left the premises, the District Magistrate said Tuesday.

Rudraprayag District Magistrate Vishal Mishra said that the matter was resolved after the last of the agitators came down from the gurdwara's roof on Tuesday evening after mediation by some Nihang Sikh leaders from Paonta Sahib.

A group of seven men had occupied the Nagarasu gurdwara's roof after a scuffle with the gurdwara management Saturday. They had allegedly sought the release of four Nihang Sikh devotees who were accused of assaulting a group of locals in Karnaprayag.

The Nihang Sikh group occupied the top floor of the gurdwara and started pelting stones and vandalising the building.

Nihang Sikhs with a police officer after ending their standoff at Nagrasu Gurdwara in Rudraprayag, Tuesday. PTI

Asked if action would be taken against the group for their alleged acts of vandalism and intimidation, the District Magistrate said an inquiry is underway. "They left the premises and set off two hours ago. Since it was an altercation between the two factions, they mediated and resolved it amongst themselves," he said.

Delhi Gurdwara Management Committee president Harmeet Singh Kalka said they spoke to the head of the group in Punjab. "The senior leaders have assured us they would hold talks to resolve the matter," he said.

A delegation led by Kalka met Uttarakhand CM Pushkar Singh Dhami to raise concerns about the arrest of Nihang Sikhs in Karnaprayag, claiming the action against them was one-sided and had stoked resentment among the Sikh community.

SP Niharika Tomar said the matter was resolved after a delegation from Punjab and Paonta Sahib visited the gurdwara.

SALUTE THE SOLDIER

BORDER SECURITY FORCE

HEAD CONSTABLE BHOLA DUTT, 153 BN BSF, 22.11.1948 – 24.06.1999

Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawan Head Constable Bhola Dutt on his Balidan Diwas. On this day, he sustained grievous injuries while fighting with militants in Dhamkund area, Jammu and later succumbed to his injuries.

CONSTABLE BRIJENDRA SINGH, 161 BN BSF, 14.07.1964 – 24.06.1992

Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawan Constable Brijendra Singh on his Balidan Diwas. On this day, he sustained fatal injuries in a grenade blast in Pampore area, J&K and succumbed to his injuries at 92 base hospital, Srinagar.

LANCE NAIK SHYAM LAL, PPMG, 58 BN BSF, 15.04.1965 – 24.06.1997

CONSTABLE SHERDIL KHAN, PMG, 58 BN BSF, 10.04.1974 – 24.06.1997

Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawans Lance Naik Shyam Lal and Constable Sherdil Khan on their Balidan Diwas. On this day, they sustained fatal bullet injuries while fighting militants in Balmat Kot area, J&K. they fought bravely and made ultimate sacrifice in the line of duty. Their sacrifice and gallant action have been aptly recognized by GOI by awarding Lance Naik Shyam Lal with PPMG (Posthumously) and Constable Sherdil Khan with PMG (Posthumously).

CONSTABLE MOHD SAFI KHAN, 1 BN BSF, 22.03.1971 – 24.06.2000

Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawan Constable Mohd Safi Khan on his Balidan Diwas. On 23rd June 2000, he sustained grievous bullet injuries during a counter terror operation in Riyal area, J&K and succumbed to his injuries on 24th June 2000.

CENTRAL RESERVE POLICE FORCE

Veer Balidani Sub Inspector Saheb Shukla, 29 Bn, 16-01-1967 To 24-06-2017

DG and all Ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to Sub Inspector Saheb Shukla of 29 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice while bravely countering an ambush by terrorists near Pantha Chowk, Srinagar, Jammu & Kashmir on 24 June 2017. #CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.

INDIAN RAILWAY CATERING AND TOURISM CORPORATION LTD.
(A Government of India Enterprise - Navratna)
CIN : L74899DL1999GOI101707

NOTICE INVITING OPEN E-TENDER : CO/NIT/EL/2026/01

IRCTC invites open E-Tender for **Construction, Refurbishing, Operation, Maintenance & Transfer Back of Executive Lounge at Pune Railway station.** Last Date for submission of Tender is **06.07.2026 at 15:00 hrs.** and same shall be opened on **06.07.2026 at 15:15 hrs.**

For details visit **www.irctc.com** and **www.tenderwizard.com.** Document downloading and participation can only be done on **www.tenderwizard.com/ IRCTC.**

In case of any corrigendum/addendum issued on the above advertisement, it will be published only on IRCTC's website **www.irctc.com** and **www.tenderwizard.com/IRCTC**

IRCTC Ltd. 3rd Floor, Tower-D, World Trade Centre, Nauroji Nagar, New Delhi-110029

Office of The Superintending Engineer, Water Resources Circle, Kota

क्रमांकः SE/WRC/e-NIB-02/2026-27/626-68 दिनांकः 12/06/26

e-NIB No.- 02/2026-27

On behalf of the Governor of Rajasthan, e-Tenders are invited from eligible contractors for the work of "Repair and renovation of work of Dolia Minor Irrigation Project Tehsil Ladpura District Kota" (Est. cost Rs. 213.76 Lacs) for the period for 18 Months including Rainy season, from interested bidders from 15.06.2026 (9:30 Hr) to 06.07.2026 till 18:00 Hr Other particulars, Terms & conditions may be seen on the procurement **portal httpps://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in**, **http://sppp.rajasthan.gov.in**, **www.dipr.rajasthan.gov.in** & **www.waterrajasthan.gov.in**.
NIB cote: WRD2627A0106
UBN NO WRD 2627 WSOB00249.

Sd/-
(Mahendra Kumar)
Superintending Engineer Water Resources Circle, Kota

DIPR/C/10773/2026

KONKAN RAILWAY CORPORATION LIMITED
(A Government of India Undertaking)

TENDER NOTICE

On behalf of Konkan Railway Corporation Limited, Karwar Sr. Divisional Signal & Telecom Engineer, Karwar, Open tender is invites through Indian Railway E-Procurement System (IREPS) for "Replacement of Mechanical Lifting Barrier (MLB) with Electrical Lifting Barrier (ELB) at 15 Nos Level Crossing Gates (LC gate no - 32, 37, 48, 50, 54, 63, 64, 66B, 67, 74, 74B, 81, 82, 83 & 85) on Karwar Region of Konkan Railway" **Tender Notice No.: KR-KAWR-SG-ET-2026-05A, dated 24.06.2026. Cost of work**: Rs. 1,00,06,084/- (Including GST). **Last date & time for submission of bids**: 15.07.2026 up to 15:30 Hrs. For further details contact Office of Sr Divisional Signal & Telecom Engineer, Konkan Railway Corporation Ltd., Shirwad, Karwar-581306 (Karnataka State). For details visit website: **www.ireps.gov.in**

NORTHERN RAILWAY

TENDER NOTICE (Through e-tendering)

Name of work with its location: Provision of Railnet at balanced Railway stations /Depot/Offices Outside Delhi Area of Delhi Division & balance work of Provision of Railnet at way side and junction stations in outside Delhi area of Delhi Division. **App. Cost of the work (₹)** ₹ 3,35,31,777.44/-only, **Earnest Money Deposit (₹)** ₹ 6,70,600.00/-only. **Address of the office:** Senior Divisional Signal & Telecom Engineer-C, Northern Railway, 3rd Floor, Annexe-1, DRM office, New Delhi-110055. **Date & Time for upload the tender /closing of tender**: Tender uploading / closing date & time- 15/07/2026 up to 15.00 hrs. **Website particular & notice board location where complete details of the tender can be seen etc.:** See the Northern Railway website www.ireps.gov.in& Notice board at S&T branch, 3rd Floor, DRM office, State Entry Road, New Delhi-110055.
Tender No. 558-Sig-16-Tele-OT-1040 Dated: 23/06/2026 2160/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

UTTAR PRADESH EXPRESSWAYS INDUSTRIAL DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY (UPEIDA)
5th Floor, A Block, PICUP Bhawan, Vibhuti Khand, Gomti Nagar, Lucknow-226010, Ph.: 0522-4004523/4004527, Email: upeida2@gmail.com, Web: https://upeida.up.gov.in

NOTICE INVITING TENDER

UPEIDA has invited online Technical and Financial Proposals through e-tender portal viz. https://etender.up.nic.in for selection of contractors for development of following 6 Lane (Expandable to 8) Greenfield, Access Controlled Expressways in the state of Uttar Pradesh on EPC Basis:-

Name of Project	Date of publication	Tender ID
(i) Jhansi Link Expressway Project (Package-I)	15.06.2026	2026_UPEID_1160869_1
(ii) Jhansi Link Expressway Project (Package-II)	15.06.2026	2026_UPEID_1160883_1
(iii) Jewar Link Expressway Project (Package-I)	22.06.2026	2026_UPEID_1162898_1
(iv) Jewar Link Expressway Project (Package-II)	22.06.2026	2026_UPEID_1162922_1

RFP of aforesaid tenders can be downloaded by interested contractors from aforesaid E-Tender Portal. All further notices, corrigenda and clarifications etc., if any, shall be posted on the aforesaid e-tender portal only.
Contact Mob. Nos.: 9415034883, 7318548201, 9415527175, 9415088198, 7355102441
Addl. Chief Executive Officer, UPEIDA

NAGAR NIGAM, GORAKHPUR

E-Tender Notice

Name of the Work	Earnest Money Deposit (Rs.)	Tender fee with GST @ 18%
Selection of a bidder for operation and maintenance of a 250 TPD municipal solid waste management plant at Suthni for Gorakhpur Municipal Corporation (GMC)	Rs. 21,60,000/- (Twenty-one lakhs sixty thousand only)	Rs. 11,800/- (including GST)

Time Schedule for Bidding

S.N.	Description	Date
1	Start date of Tender document download	29.06.2026
2	Pre-bid meeting	10.07.2026 12:00 PM onwards
3	Last date of Online submission of proposal	27.07.2026 05:00 PM
4	Opening of Technical proposal	28.07.2026 12:00 PM
5	Opening of financial proposal	Will be communicated.

1. Other details can be seen on website http://etender.up.nic.in (for view, download and bidding).
2. Subsequent corrigendum, if required, shall appear in these websites.
3. Municipal Commissioner, Gorakhpur reserves the right to reject any or all the tenders without assigning any reasons
4. Contractor who wants to participate in bid must register themselves on http://etender.up.nic.in
5. For any other queries, please contact Additional Municipal Commissioner-III, Nagar Nigam Gorakhpur. Also, for any further queries, and pre-bid queries, the bidders are advised to send an **email to: nnggkpsbm@gmail.com** and Cc to **nagarnigamgkp@gmail.com**

Additional Municipal Commissioner-III Nagar Nigam, Gorakhpur
Municipal Commissioner Nagar Nigam, Gorakhpur

युनाइटेड इंडिया इंश्योरेन्स कंपनी लिमिटेड
UNITED INDIA INSURANCE COMPANY LTD.
(A Govt of India Undertaking)
Regd. & Head Office: 24, Whites Road, Chennai - 600 014.

E-TENDER NOTICE

United India Insurance Company Limited a Public Sector Insurance Company invites Bids for **REQUEST FOR PROPOSAL-FOR PROCUREMENT OF IND AS SYSTEM SOLUTION, HARDWARE AND ENGAGEMENT OF IMPLEMENTATION PARTNER.** Please visit our website **https://uiic.co.in/web/tenders-rfp and https://uiic.enivida.com** for details.

IRDAI Regn. No. 545
CIN: U93090TN1938GOI000108

E-mail:- seruraljaipur@gmail.com/sejprur.pwd@rajasthan.gov.in

कार्यालय अधीक्षण अभियन्ता, सार्वजनिक निर्माण विभाग, ग्रामीण वृत-जयपुर
पी.डब्ल्यू.डी. कैम्पस, जैकब रोड, जयपुर क्लब के सामने, जयपुर
फोन :- 0141-2223527

कमांक 1675-82 दिनांक:- 11/6/26

निविदा सूचना संख्या-04/2026-27

जयपुर जिले मे 04 कार्य के निर्माण कार्यों हेतु इच्छुक निविदादाताओं द्वारा दिनांक 06.07.2026 सायं 06.00 बजे तक निविदाएं आमन्त्रित की जाती हैं। निविदा से संबन्धित अन्य विवरण राज्य की उपापन पोर्टल ((http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in, http://sppp.rajasthan.gov.in एवं विभागीय वेबसाईट http://pwd. rajasthan.gov.in. पर देखे जा सकते हैं। उपापन की अनुमानित लागत रुपए 1260.30 लाख है।
PWD2627WSOB04907, PWD2627WSOB04916
PWD2627WSOB04918, PWD2627WLOB04922

हस्ता./-
अधीक्षण अभियन्ता
सा.नि.वि. ग्रामीण वृत-जयपुर

DIPR/C/10707/2026

BHAGALPUR SMART CITY LIMITED
(A Govt. of Bihar Undertaking)
CIN- U93090BR2016SGC033046
Govt. of Bihar

Notice Inviting E-Tender

Work Descriptions: Request for Proposal (RFP) for Construction of New Swimming Pool in Existing Swimming Pool Campus, Sandy's Compound, Bhagalpur.
Estimated Cost: Rs. 59,60,761/- (Fifty-Nine Lakh Sixty Thousand Seven Hundred Sixty-One) only inclusive of all taxes and GST.
Tender Processing Fee: As per e-proc norms https://www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in
Tender Documents Fee: Rs. 10,000/- (Ten thousand) only.
Earnest Money Deposit: Rs. 1,19,215/- (One Lakh Nineteen Thousand Two Hundred Fifteen) only.

Tender Schedule:

Sr. No.	Activity	Date and Time
1	Bid Submission Due Date https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in/	13-07-2026, 11:00 PM
2	Bid Open Date https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in/	14-07-2026, 02:30 PM
3	Submission end date of hard copy/ Physical documents mentioned in RFP. Address: Managing Director-Cum-CEO, Bhagalpur Smart City Limited, 4th Floor, Bhagalpur Smart City Building, Police Line Campus, Opp. Main Gate of Sandy's Compound, Bhagalpur-812001	14-07-2026, 01:00 PM
4	Prebid Meeting Start Date. Venue Details: Conference Hall, Bhagalpur Smart City Limited.	03-07-2026 12:30 PM
5	Prebid Meeting End Date.	03-07-2026 02:00 PM
6	Prebid Query Submission end date and time. Email:info@smartcitybhagalpur.org	03-07-2026 10:00 AM

Note: NIT, RFP, Corrigendum (if any) etc. are also available on the official website http://www.smartcitybhagalpur.org for reference purposes only.
For further details please visit website **state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar**

PR- 006433 (B & C) 2026-27
नशे की मार, बर्बाद करे सुखी परिवार।
Managing Director cum CEO, Bhagalpur Smart City Limited.

Govt. of Bihar

OFFICE OF NAGAR PARISHAD BARBIGHA
SHORT TERM RE-TENDER INVITATION NOTICE
RE-NIT No: 05/2026-27

1. LETTER OF INVITATION (LOI) FOR BIDS REQUEST FOR PROPOSAL
Nagar Parishad BARBIGHA invites online proposals for Selection of Agencies for Providing Outsourced Manpower for Performing and Managing Day to Day Activities related to sanitation work for Nagar Parishad BARBIGHA;
Details of schedule for the bid are given below:-.

Sl.	Activity	Timeline & Address
1	Date of Published	22-06-2026
2	Website for submission of proposal	www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in/
3	Mode of Submission.	Online submission through eproc2 portal (www.eproc2.biphar.gov.in) and submission of Hard copies at the office of Nagar Parishad BARBIGHA at Scheduled date & time.
4	Start date and time for Submission of Technical & Financial proposal on www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in	01-07-2026 by 11:00 AM
5	Last date and time for Submission of Technical & Financial proposal on www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in	08-07-2026 by 03:00 PM
6	Last date and time for Submission of Hard Copies (*Not Mandatory, for office use only)	09-07-2026 by 04:00 PM Address- THE OFFICE OF EXECUTIVE OFFICER,NAGAR PARISHAD BARBIGHA
7	Date and time of opening of Technical Bids	10-07-2026 by 11:30 PM
8	Date of opening of financial bid Date and time of opening of Financial Proposal	To be informed later to technically qualified bidder.
9	Date of Pre Bid meeting	02-07-2026 by 11:00 AM to 03:00 PM Address- THE OFFICE OF EXECUTIVE OFFICER, NAGAR PARISHAD BARBIGHA
10	Method of Selection	**Least Cost Selection (LCS)**
11	Estimated Project cost	Rs **8,67,84,685.00** (Eight Crore Sixty Seven lacs Eighty Four Thousand Six Hundred Eighty Five Rupees Only).
12	Work Duration	24 Months
13	Cost of Bidding Document(Tender Fee)	Tender Fee Rs **10,000** (Non Refundable) to be paid through Online at www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in
14	EMD(2% of the estimated cost)	Rs **17,36,000.00** (Rupees Seventeen Lacks Thirty Six thousand Only only) (Refundable) paid through Online at www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in . No Bank guarantee for EMD is accepted.
15	Bid validity	120 days

RFP document shall be available on website: www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in
For Queries & Clarifications, send e-mail to: npbarbigha1976@gmail

Executive Officer
Nagar Parishad BARBIGHA

For further details please visit : **www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar**

PR. No. 006438 (B&C) 2026-27

नशामुक्त हो जाए बिहार, सुरक्षित रहे घर परिवार।

PATNA SMART CITY LIMITED
Address: 4th floor, ICCC Building, SSP Office Campus, North Gandhi Maidan Patna-800001,
Email: patna smart city.pscl@gmail.com, Website: smartpatna.co.in
Govt. of Bihar

EXPRESSION OF INTEREST

RFQ No: RFQ - 12/MD/PSCL/2026-27

Sealed Expression of Interest hereby invited by Patna Smart City Limited from eligible bidder for **Selection of Agency for Operation & Maintenance of GIG Workers AC Lounges under Patna Smart City Limited, Patna**, Latest by 17:00 hours on 11/07/2026. The detailed technical specifications uploaded on PSCL website www.smartpatna.co.in may be referred for details.

Managing Director
Patna Smart City Ltd.

This information is available on **www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar also**

PR. No. 006434 (B&C) 2026-27

नशामुक्त हो जाए बिहार, सुरक्षित रहे घर परिवार।

बिहार सरकार

मुजफ्फरपुर स्मार्ट सिटी लिमिटेड
E-mail ID-mmc-muz-bih-@nic-.in, muzaffarpur.ulb@gmail.com
C/o: Muzaffarpur Municipal Corporation,
MZP Municipality Muzaffarpur, Bihar-842001

सूचना

मुज़फ्फरपुर स्मार्ट सिटी लिमिटेड के अंतर्गत संविदा के आधार पर मुख्य वित्त पदाधिकारी (Chief Finance Officer - CFO) के एक पद पर नियुक्ति हेतु विज्ञापन संख्या–01/2026-27/MSCL, दिनांक 03.06.2026, जिसका प्रकाशन PR No-005043 (B&C) 26-27 के माध्यम से किया गया था, के संदर्भ में सूचित किया जाता है कि उक्त पद हेतु आवेदन प्रस्तुत करने की अंतिम तिथि को बढ़ाकर दिनांक 27.06.2026 तक कर दिया गया है।

विज्ञापन से संबंधित विस्तृत जानकारी, पात्रता, नियम एवं शर्तों के लिए कृपया मुज़फ्फरपुर नगर निगम की आधिकारिक वेबसाइट https://mymmc.org का अवलोकन करें।

अधिक जानकारी हेतु निम्नलिखित संपर्क सूत्र पर संपर्क किया जा सकता है :–
मोबाइल नंबर: **9973134529**

ऋतुराज प्रताप सिंह,
नगर आयुक्त–सह–प्रबंध निदेशक,
मुजफ्फरपुर स्मार्ट सिटी लिमिटेड

PR. No. 006367 (B&C) 2026-27

नशामुक्त हो जाए बिहार, सुरक्षित रहे घर परिवार।

बिहार सरकार

कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय
भवन निर्माण विभाग, भवन प्रमण्डल सीवान
राष्ट्रीय स्पर्द्धा ई– निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना

सिर्फ ई– निविदा पद्धति के अनुसार वेबसाईट (www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in) पर
ई–निविदा सूचना संख्याः–02/ET/BCD/SIWAN/2026-27
का शुद्धि पत्र

एतद् द्वारा सूचित किया जाता है कि इस कार्यालय के पत्रांक 971 दिनांक 20.05.2026 द्वारा आमंत्रित ई–निविदा सूचना संख्या– **02/ET/BCD/SIWAN/2026-2027** जिसका पी०आर० नम्बर– PR No: 003844 (BCD) 2026-27 है, के तिथियो को निम्नवत् संशोधित किया जाता है:–

कंडिका संख्या	कंडिका का विषय	पूर्व में निर्गत तिथि	नव संशोधित तिथि
3	निविदा कागजात प्राप्त करने (डाउन लोड करने) की अंतिम तिथि एवं समय	दिनांक 03.06.2026 से 25.06.2026 को 15.00 बजे तक।	दिनांक 08.07.2026 से 30.07.2026 2026 को 15.00 बजे तक।
4	निविदा जमा करने (अपलोड करने) की अंतिम तिथि एवं समय	दिनांक 25.06.2026 को 15:30 बजे तक।	दिनांक 30.07.2026 को 15:30 बजे तक।
6	प्री बीड़ मिटींग का तिथि एवं स्थान	1. दिनांक 10.06.2026 को 11:00 अधीक्षण अभियंता, भवन अंचल, छपरा का कार्यालय 2. दिनांक 17.06.2026 को 11:00 बजे मुख्य अभियंता, उत्तर उपभाग भवन निर्माण विभाग, बिहार पटना का कार्यालय।	1. दिनांक 16.07.2026 को 11:00 अधीक्षण अभियंता, भवन अंचल, छपरा का कार्यालय 2. दिनांक 23.07.2026 को 11:00 बजे मुख्य अभियंता, उत्तर उपभाग भवन निर्माण विभाग, बिहार पटना का कार्यालय।
7	तकनीकी बीड खोलने की तिथि एवं समय	दिनांक 27.06.2026 को 15:00 बजे केवल वेबसाईट	दिनांक 01.08.2026 को 15:00 बजे केवल वेबसाईट

उक्त के अलावे पूर्व में प्रकाशित निविदा की अन्य सभी कंडिकाएँ एवं शर्ते पूर्ववत रहेंगी।

कार्यपालक अभियंता
भवन प्रमंडल, सीवान

विस्तृत जानकारी **state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar** से प्राप्त की जा सकती है।
PR. No.006380 (BCD) 2026-27

नशे की मार, बर्बाद करे सुखी परिवार।

OFFICE OF SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER
Construction Circle (E/M),
U.P. JAL NIGAM (URBAN)
C-5, Jal Nigam Colony, Rajnagar, Ghaziabad (U.P.)
Email: seemgzb01@gmail.com

Letter No.: 395/Nivida/98
Date: 23.06.2026

E-TENDER NOTICE

U.P. Jal Nigam(Urban) invites E-bids for execution of:
"Comprehensive Operation and Maintenance of 13 Nos Sewerage Treatment Plant in Meerut including all labour and maintenance charges, Consumables charges, expenditure related to Laboratory sample test and relation with other department/ NGT including legal services etc for period of 12 months." are invited in two bid system on percentage basis from eligible, reputed and experienced bidder. E-bid documents will be available on U.P. Govt. e-procurement portal https://etender.up.nic.in and U.P.J.N. (Urban) website www.jn.upsdc. gov.in for download from dated 30.06.2026 from 05:00 PM. Pre-bid meeting will be held on dated 06.07.2026 at 02:00 PM in under signed office. E-bids can be submitted till 30.07.2026 up to 05:00 PM and technical bid shall be opened on 01.08.2026 at 03:00 PM in the office of undersigned in presence of contractor or their authorized representative. E-tender cost is Rs. 10000.00 + GST @ 18% for tender. Details are available on U.P. Govt. e-procurement portal http://etender.up.nic.in & U.P.J.N.(Urban) website www.jn.upsdc.gov.in.

कार्यालय परियोजना प्रबन्धक, यूनिट–8
कन्सट्रक्शन एण्ड डिजाइन सर्विसेज
उत्तर प्रदेश जल निगम (नगरीय)
(उ० प्र० सरकार का उपक्रम)
भवन सं. 55, अरूणा नगर, सुनहरी लाल पाठक पार्क के सामने, एटा–207001
Visit us at: www.cdsupjn.org
e-mail id: unit08_agra@rediffmail.com
e-mail id: etahunit08@gmail.com

L.No.- 496/M-13/88
Dated: 05.06.2026

ई–निविदा सूचना

उत्तर प्रदेश जल निगम, की ओर से अधोहस्ताक्षरी द्वारा जनपद एटा के तहसील एटा ग्राम नगला हरकिशनपुर में गो-संरक्षण केन्द्र का निर्माण कार्य अनुमानित लागत ₹ 123.71 लाख (जी.एस.टी.रहित एवं लेबर सेस सहित) हेतु सी. एण्ड डी. एस. के अन्तर्गत यथोचित श्रेणी में पंजीकृत ठेकेदारों से दिनांक 07.07.2026 के अपरान्ह 17:00 बजे तक ई-निविदा आमन्त्रित की जाती है। उक्त कार्य हेतु ई-निविदा प्रपत्र दिनांक 08.06.2026 से दिनांक 07.07.2026 के मध्य उत्तर प्रदेश सरकार की **e-procurement** वेबसाइट **https://etender.up.nic.in** से डाउनलोड किये जा सकते हैं तथा ई-निविदा दिनांक 08.07.2026 को 14:00 बजे परियोजना प्रबन्धक, यूनिट-08, सी. एण्ड डी.एस., उ. प्र. जल निगम (नगरीय), एटा में खोली जायेगी। ई-निविदा प्रपत्र का मूल्य **₹ 10,000.00 + GST (18%)** कुल **₹ 11,800.00** देय होगा।

ई-निविदा से सम्बन्धित विस्तृत विवरण विभाग की वेबसाइट **www.cdsupjn.org** एवं प्रोक्योरमेन्ट पोर्टल **https://etender.up.nic.in** पर उपलब्ध है। समस्त शुद्धि पत्र **(Corrigendum) https://etender.up.nic.in** पर ही अपलोड किये जायेंगे, **इनका पृथक से कोई प्रकाशन नहीं किया जायेगा**। निविदादाताओं को सलाह दी जाती है कि वे उक्त वेबसाईट का समय-समय पर अवलोकन करते रहें।

झारखण्ड सरकार
झारखण्ड फ्लाईंग इंस्टीट्यूट
मंत्रिमंडल सचिवालय एवं निगरानी विभाग के अंतर्गत पंजीकृत सोसाईटी
(नागर विमानन प्रभाग)
राजकीय हैंगर, बिरसा मुण्डा हवाई अड्डा रोड, हिनू, राँची–834002
E-mail-jfi.govtfly@gmail.com/jfi@jharkhandaviation.in, Website-www.jharkhandaviation.in

पत्रांक–Airbase-wifi, CCTV & Intercom System/68/2026/JFI-573/ राँची, दिनांक–22.06.2026

Short Term Request for Quotation

झारखण्ड फ्लाईंग इंस्टीट्यूट, राजकीय हैंगर, बिरसा मुण्डा एयरपोर्ट रोड, हिनू, राँची–834002 पर अधिष्ठापित Wi-fi, CCTV एवं Intercom System के AMC हेतु राँची जिला के अनुभवी स्थानीय निबंधित एजेंसियों के माध्यम से अतिअल्पकालीन निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है।

उपरोक्त वर्णित कार्यों के सम्पादनार्थ दर सीलबंद लिफाफा में (GST एवं PAN के साथ) दिनांक–01.07.2026 के अपराह्न 05:00 बजे तक अधोहस्ताक्षरी के कार्यालय (झारखण्ड फ्लाईंग इंस्टीट्यूट, राजकीय हैंगर, बिरसा मुण्डा एयरपोर्ट रोड, हिनू, राँची–834002) में समर्पित किया जा सकता है।

विश्वासभाजन
ह०/–
(कोषाध्यक्ष–सह–अवर सचिव)
झारखण्ड फ्लाईंग इंस्टीट्यूट, राँची।

PR 383054 Civil Aviation(26-27)D

AT 17,000 FT, A TRADE DOOR OPENS INTO CHINA

Via Lipulekh

For centuries, traders in Uttarakhand undertook a treacherous trek through the Lipulekh Pass, their ponies laden with goods that they sold in Tibet. With the Pass now set to reopen for trade after seven years, AISWARYA RAJ & photographer ABHINAV SAHA travel to Lipulekh, a cross-border route marked by geography, geopolitics

FOR MOST part of the year, Gunji stays still. The bright yellow merry-go-round at the army school stays frozen and the stunted grass struggles to rear its head. At 10,500 feet above sea level, life in the Uttarakhand village can be uncertain at the best of times. So Lakshmi Gunjyal learned early on to adapt.

"I tried everything to survive. I wanted to be a teacher, but when that didn't work out, I got back to the trade our ancestors did, bringing pashmina wool from Tibet. But then, they shut the border, so I started this homestay," says the 40-year-old, sitting in Gunji, one of the last villages in Uttarakhand's Pithoragarh district before the Lipulekh Pass winds its way into Tibet.

But now, she is hopeful. The Pass is set to reopen after seven years, opening the door to a cross-border trade that is buffeted by the vagaries of geography and geopolitics. The Pass has stayed shut since 2019, first due to the pandemic and later as India-China border skirmishes led to a chill in bilateral relations.

At the trijunction of India, Nepal, and China's Tibet Autonomous Region, the Lipulekh Pass loops its way through the snow-covered Himalayan ranges, reaching 17,000 feet at its highest point. The Pass has for centuries served as the gateway for pilgrims headed to Mount Kailash as part of the Mansarovar Yatra and Lake Manasarovar in Tibet. It's also a historical transit point for trade between India and the Taklakot market in Tibet.

The region is contested, with Nepal claiming Lipulekh and the larger region, including Kalapani and Limpiyadhura, based on the 1816 Treaty of Sugauli.

Which is why the Pass, and the announcement earlier this year to reopen it for business, holds immense strategic value despite the low trade volumes.

But for the people of Gunji, among the many sparsely populated villages downhill from the Pass, the reopening of the trade route is more sentimental — it's a recognition of the only way of life they have known.

Lipulekh Pass, 17,000 ft

For at least since the 17th century, people from these villages, and from towns downhill such as Dharchula, have trekked treacherous kilometres up to the Pass and through it, their ponies and mules laden with wares — jaggery, cereals, mill-made cotton and woollen — to be sold across the border. Once on the other side, they would pitch their tents at the Taklakot market in Tibet, stay there for six months, starting around June, as they sold their goods and collected wares to be sold in Indian markets.

As the winter sets in, they return to India, this time, their ponies heavier and laden with rock salt, borax, raw wool and woollen knits. Sometimes, even sheep, goats, and horses from Tibet would make the journey back with the Indian traders. With the winter months unforgiving in Gunji and nearby villages, the traders descend further into towns such as Dharchula and beyond, where they sell the wares sourced from Tibet.

The trade operates outside the logic of modern commerce and is a mix of cash, barter and credit.

Trade between the two regions was first suspended during the 1962 war with China, and reopened only in 1992. Since then, every diplomatic chill would be accompanied by uncertainty and fears that it would impact trade.

But as India and China worked to mend their relationship, in 2025, the government opened the route for the Mansarovar Yatra and earlier this year, announced the reopening of the Lipulekh Pass for trade.

Before 2019, when the Pass was last shut, pilgrims and traders would have to trek up 27 km from Gunji to reach the border post and onwards to the Pass, before crossing over to the other side. But with a new road coming up on the Indian side last year, vehicles can now reach up to touching distance of the Pass. The remaining 750 metres from the border post, and the few hundred metres through the Pass itself, will have to be covered on mules or horses.

A solitary milestone, with a board that says "Tibet 750 metres", marks the border post, beyond which movements are strictly monitored by the Indian Army. The silence is broken by icy cold winds and an occasional jeep that rumbles over gravel, filled with pilgrims and tourists headed towards a higher vantage point from where they can catch a glimpse of the Kailash Mountains.

Gunji, 10,500 ft

In Gunji, the Kali river cleaves through towering mountains and barren slopes. On one of the banks, a row of green and red tin roofs punctuates the bleak brown-grey desert around it. A modest police station that remains closed for six months a year, a few Army outposts, a primary health centre, and a dozen small homestays make up the most conspicuous landmarks in Gunji.

Gunji's status as the facilitator of the trans-Himalayan trade between India and China means it has a customs office that levies GST and maintains records of goods that cross the Pass. Gunji also has godowns for traders and a currency exchange centre, both of which will have to be spruced up before trade kicks off.

While a market was set up for Tibetan traders in Gunji, this never took off. In 1992, the government recorded seven traders, 43 in 1995, two in 2002, and none since then.

Sitting in her homestay, Lakshmi says growing up in these parts is tough. As a child, when the primary school in Gunji closed after the last teacher posted there left, she and her two siblings moved to Dharchula. She later went to college in Haldwani and got an MEd degree in Dehradun. But when Lakshmi got no teaching jobs, she returned to Gunji to take up the pashmina trade her father built in the '90s. Her earliest memory of Taklakot in Tibet was from when she was 10 — a barren land with a few tents, no toilets, and a row of stone and wooden houses. She says she realised early on that the wool — sourced from goats in Western Tibet — had a market in India.

Pointing to a tourist in a Kashmiri *pheran*, she says, "We bring wool from Tibet and sell it to wholesalers in Kashmir, who send it to the textile industry."

In exchange, she would take handmade carpets, blankets, jaggery, match boxes, sugar candy, and 'Made in India' clothes that were in demand in Tibet.

In 2018, she bought a tonne of pashmina, paying for it partly through cash (Rs 7 lakh); the rest through an informal arrangement of barter and credit, with a promise that she would pay back in goods the next season.

Lakshmi is quick with the math as she explains what it cost her to bring a tonne of pashmina across the Himalayas: 17 ponies, each carrying 60 kg from Lipulekh to Dharchula, hired for Rs 5,000 each; a 5 per cent GST, truck charges of Rs 35,000 from Dharchula to Tanakpur, from where they are received by wholesalers. In all, she says, she shelled out around Rs 9 lakh for the consignment, and made about Rs 20 lakh. "There are other expenses too — rent etc. In the end, I get a small profit, something to keep us afloat through the next six months before the trade starts," she says.

The closure of the border in 2019 forced Lakshmi to open a homestay in 2022. Her guests include pilgrims visiting Adi Kailash and Om Parvat in the district. She says that if trade gets unsustainable, she will be forced to move out of Gunji.

Her only daughter studies in a boarding school in Nainital. "She is not keen to do my business. Young people have a different life, and I would not want to impose this struggle on her," says Lakshmi.

But for now, Lakshmi is looking forward to the trip to Tibet. "It feels like home. Our own people call us Chinese, Tibetan and Nepali, and that is when it occurs to me that I feel more welcome in Tibet than in our own state," she says.

Dharchula, 3,000 ft

Around 78 km away from Gunji, in Dharchula, Daulat Singh Raipa has made several visits to the trade office in town to enquire about the resumption of trade.

While the Pass was scheduled to be opened for trade from June 1 to October 31, Raipa, the general secretary of the India-Tibet Trade Committee, has been told that it would open towards the end of June.

Recalling his first visit to Tibet in 1998, he says he followed in the steps of his father and grandfather. "We would take our goods on mules till the border and transfer these to animals on the other side. The road on the Tibetan side was not motorable, but when we went in June 2008, we were stunned by the transformation. Roads were being constructed, new buildings had come up, and we could get a vehicle a few kilometres down the Lipulekh Pass," says Raipa.

His wife Damayanti went a year later. "It was a cold desert. We trekked for five days, carrying our two toddlers on our backs and finally pitched a tent at Taklakot (in Tibet). We had carried *gur* (jaggery) and *misri* (sugar candy) with us, and brought back salt, carpets, and wool," she says, sitting on a midnight blue yak-wool carpet that the family brought from across the border on one of their many trips.

Now, with the Pass open, the family has bought goods, including cosmetics, jaggery, sugar candy, carpets, and jackets, worth Rs 5 lakh, which are stocked up in a godown in Dharchula and which they will carry across to Tibet. "Seven years is a long time. What if fashion trends have changed, our cosmetics have gone out of fashion there, or they have stopped being reliant on the jaggery we bring?" says Raipa, who got his permit on June 23.

He is excited to meet their friends from Tibet. Since 2020, when several Chinese apps were banned in India, the traders have had no contact with their Tibetan counterparts. "They have a fondness for us because the Dalai Lama lives here. Though there is a ban on carrying the Dalai Lama's photos, many of them secretly do so and share them with us," says Raipa.

Dharchula, with a population of 58,413, is where people from villages such as Gunji, Garbyang, and Nabi move to during the winter months. The town sits on the border with Nepal, the two countries connected by a bridge over the river Kali.

Once heavily reliant on trade, the 1962 war hit the region hard. "This is not an agrarian economy. A few crops like buckwheat are grown once a year, so when an entire village was out of work, they had to find ways to sustain themselves. Many traders went to Bajhang in Nepal to do business, others moved to the plains to pursue education. The vacuum was filled by Nepali traders from bordering villages," says Krishna Garbyal, a Dharchula resident.

The high-point of the trade in recent times was in 2004, when imports from Tibet stood at Rs 14 crore and exports at Rs 38 lakh. However, by the time the border closed in 2019, the trade had begun to fray. Tibetan salt had been displaced by cheaper alternatives from the Indian plains, borax had lost its market, Chinese-made goods had become widely available elsewhere in India, and the appreciation of the yuan made purchases in Tibet more expensive. In 2019, the last year of border trade, imports stood at a mere Rs 1.9 crore and exports at Rs 1.25 crore.

In recent years, Dharchula has become a pitstop for devotees and tourists headed to Om Parvat and Adi Kailash, leading to a number of homestays and small hotels further crowding the town. According to the district administration, the town recorded 36,000 visitors in 2025 and, as of June 2026, has already seen 46,130.

After the nearby Garbyang village sent two bureaucrats to the Uttarakhand cadre, several young people have left for the plains of Uttarakhand to try their hand at competitive exams. Many people here send their children to boarding schools in Nainital and Udham Singh Nagar.

But for now, the town is brimming with traders from nearby villages who are making the rounds of the town's sub-district magistrate's office to find out about the border reopening.

The Ministry of External Affairs has issued 300 permits for this year. So far, the district administration has received applications from 90 traders and helpers.

The permit, an orange passport-like booklet with a stiff cover, will be issued soon, says Sub-District Magistrate Ashish Joshi. "The Intelligence Bureau is conducting background checks, after which the passes will be issued," he says.

At a retail store in Dharchula that sells everything from T-shirts to caps and dry fruits, dozens of cartons filled with biscuits, candies, chips, rice, and grains line the shop floor — ration that Archana Garbyal (40) and her husband Jagdish Singh (45) hope will see them through during their six-month-long stay at Taklakot.

While Archana handles the customers trickling in, Jagdish seals the boxes. Though the permits are yet to reach them, the couple have begun stocking up on goods to be sold in Tibet, reached out to porters and arranged mules for transportation.

Over the last six months, the couple have scoured markets in Delhi and around, looking for goods they can trade in Tibet. "I spent 15 days in Delhi, hunting for a needle in Azad market and Karol Bagh, bought antiques near Jama Masjid, and wood articles from Saharanpur. I have in the past even travelled to Siliguri, bought blankets from Panipat and Ludhiana," says Archana.

Jagdish's father, Rajender Singh, 80, first went to Tibet in 1960. He came back with borax, salt, and Tibetan goats. Over time, the products changed extensively, says Jagdish. "Earlier, we would supply salt to Kumaon and Garhwal, but before the war, the cheap Sambhar salt appeared in Garhwal, reducing the demand for salt from Tibet," he says.

Archana says there have been changes on the other side, too. "Last time we went, things were very different in Tibet. They have increased Chinese presence now — there are nightclubs and a completely different way of life," she says.

But when he goes back, Jagdish will hope at least one thing remains constant — the Tibetan love for the jaggery he and the other Indian traders will take with them. "It's scary... feels like we are crossing over for the first time," he says, as he seals another box of their ration.

• Lipulekh Pass trade route: From 17th century to now

1638–1678 CE
Trade records between Pithoragarh's Rang community or Bhotias and Tibetans date back to the times of Raja Baz Bahadur of Kumaon's Chand dynasty

1904
The British sign a treaty with Tibet to open free-access trade marts in Western Tibet, such as Gartok, close to the Lipulekh Pass corridor

1954
In April, India signs the Panchsheel Agreement with China, allowing the entry of traders and their family members through the Lipulekh Pass with local government-issued certificates

1962
Following the outbreak of the India-China war in October 1962, the Pass is closed and the trade route is sealed off for the very first time

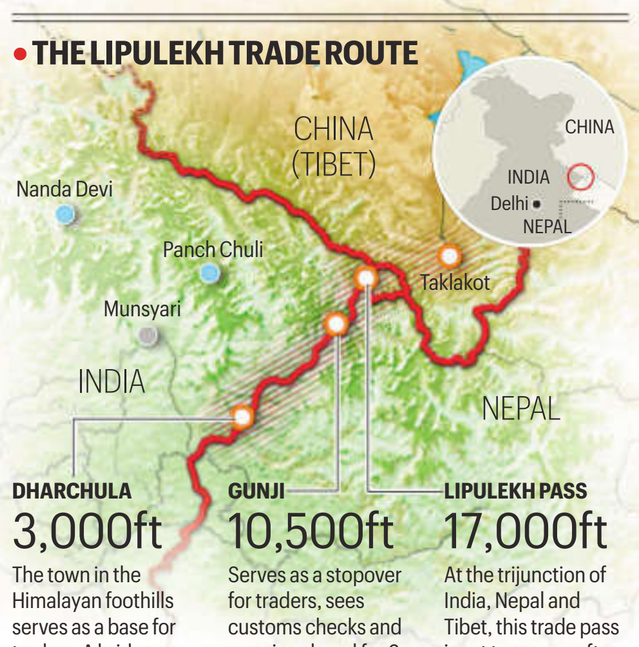
1992
Lipulekh Pass route is reopened for regulated trade with China, following an agreement signed in late 1991

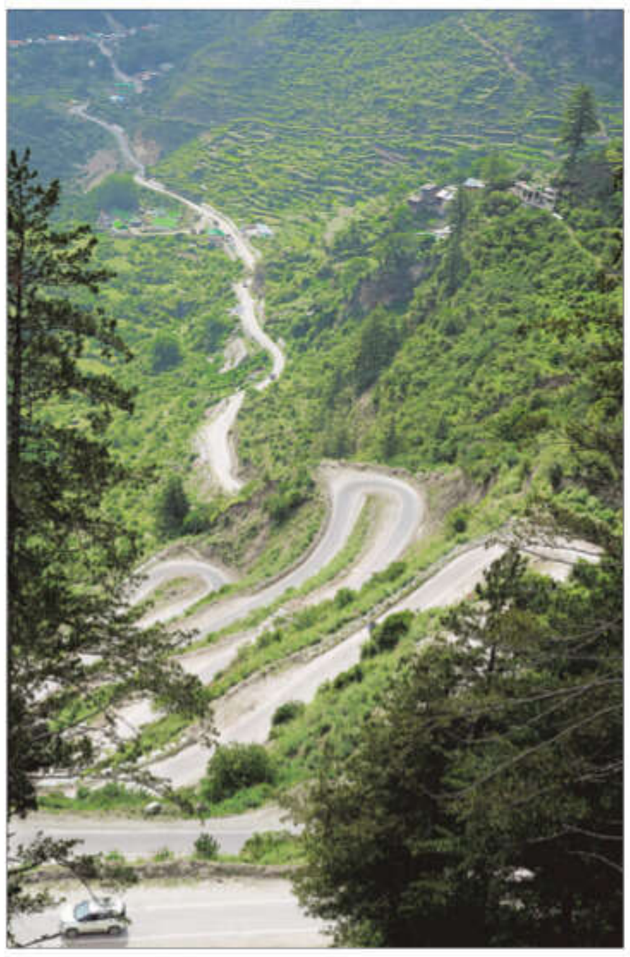
2008
Trade is disrupted for a year due to Beijing Olympics

2019
The Pass is closed again, first due to the pandemic and later as India-China skirmishes lead to a chill in relations

2026
The Pass, earlier set to open from June 1 to October 31, will see a delayed opening this June end

• THE LIPULEKH TRADE ROUTE





(From top to bottom) Jagdish Singh with his parents and daughter at Dharchula; the road from Dharchula winds its way up to Gunji; a trade permit issued in 1961

● WEB EXCLUSIVE
'Lucknow fire to exam leaks: Young Indians are trapped in a broken system.' — *By Kaushik Das Gupta*
Log on to www.indianexpress.com

● WORDLY WISE
Good people do not need laws to tell them to act responsibly, while bad people will find a way around the laws.
— *Plato*

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RAMNATH GOENKA
IN 1932
BECAUSE THE TRUTH INVOLVES US ALL

In Ujjain, a familiar plot, a disturbing abdication

INDIA IS witnessing a welcome spurt in urban public infrastructure investment, with land the centrepiece of these projects. Land use decisions are the most consequential — and most corruptible — instruments of urban governance. What gets designated "residential"? Which agricultural land turns "commercial"? Which highway corridor gets sanctioned first? Who shapes or reshapes the master plan? Knowledge of which way the state is likely to tilt, either in allocating funds or changing land use, has deepened information asymmetry in land markets, benefitting a few. An investigation in this paper has shone a light on such transactions in Ujjain. The buck, quite literally, stops at the door of Chief Minister Mohan Yadav.

The investigation has revealed that since he took oath in December 2023, Chief Minister Yadav's family and their real-estate firms have bought at least 137 plots of land totalling up to 168 acres. These plots have been bought in areas that have benefitted from the government's infrastructure push. For instance, a significant share of these are in the vicinity of new road projects announced in or around Ujjain. The Yadav family owns land in virtually every zone that has been demarcated for change of land use — as per the Ujjain Master Plan 2035, from agriculture to residential. This is a disturbing pattern, it smacks of cronyism.

In Ujjain, or in any city, permits, licences or approvals needed for construction work have to be obtained from arms of the state government. When individuals or firms connected to the Chief Minister are involved in real-estate transactions, these are easier to come by. Politics distorts the economics of the market when lines are crossed and due process sidestepped, when compliance is given short shrift. The consequences ripple through the city, and the system. Dots can be connected, for example, from the building that collapsed in Saidulajab and the bed and breakfast that caught fire in Hauz Rani recently to the clear disregard for propriety and norms in land acquisition uncovered in Ujjain. The blurring of lines between Mohan Yadav and his family, the politician-in-power and the builder network, and an erosion of checks and balances cast a lengthening shadow on Ujjain's urban governance. Transparency must be brought into the process of land acquisition, the abuse of the state's discretionary power must be curtailed. For the BJP's "good governance" mantra to mean anything, those in power need stronger guardrails. The party leadership must ask the Chief Minister to explain his family's growing land bank. Calling this business as usual will not wash.

A recurring, preventable tragedy in Lucknow

A NARROW staircase, which was the sole exit, no emergency doors and scarcely any ventilation in any of the halls or rooms — the details that are emerging about the three-storey building that went up in flames in Lucknow, on Monday, killing at least 15 people, seem strikingly similar to the lapses in hostels, coaching centres, hospitals and business centres that were the sites of recent fire outbreaks. The Uttar Pradesh government has announced a probe into the illegalities. The building's regulatory history and compliance status have come into focus after the fire, and enforcement actions by local authorities are reportedly being scrutinised. The abdications and failures responsible for the incident should, of course, be identified and the guilty held to account. But the recurring tragedies call for a deeper and more meaningful engagement with the reasons that turn buildings in urban neighbourhoods into tinderboxes.

The Bureau of Indian Standards' National Building Code, which came into effect 10 years ago, has comprehensive fire-safety guidelines. Several state governments, including UP, have incorporated these provisions into their building codes. The state also has a Fire and Emergency Services Act, which mandates swift action after an outbreak. But in the face of administrative laxity and irregular inspections, even the most robust protocols remain on paper. The Lucknow Development Authority (LDA) and the city's Fire Services and Power departments were responsible for auditing the safety of the building that caught fire on Monday. The fragmentation of jurisdictions has played a role in stalling action against the errant owners. These lapses are not very different from the failures that came to light in Delhi earlier this month, when 21 people died after a blaze in a bed-and-breakfast in Malviya Nagar. And, like in the case of several other outbreaks, including at a recreation centre in Rajkot two years ago, precious time was wasted in Lucknow because the building's design impeded rescue operations.

The country's cities are destinations for millions of job and education seekers. Many property owners compromise on safety to cash in on commercial opportunities from such migration. It's high time policymakers realised the loss of lives also takes a high toll in terms of eroding the credibility of the country's institutions. A nation aspiring to be an economic powerhouse cannot allow its cities to become sites of recurring and preventable tragedies.

Keep calm and carry on with Larry

WHAT NUMBER 10, Downing Street needed was a cat flap. What it got, instead, is a revolving door. As the UK prepares, yet again, for a new prime minister — its seventh in a decade — the suspense is no longer over who will occupy the hottest seat in the nation, but on whether Larry the Chief Mouser will bother to establish relations with them. He was, after all, in office when an iceberg lettuce outlasted a head of government. At the present rate of upheaval, he may well be there to welcome his eighth prime minister. A cat may be forgiven, therefore, for wanting to distance himself from the messy affairs of humans.

For Larry stands, calm and unbothered, amid yet another spell of political bad weather. And it's no wonder that he's come to be the one sign of constancy in troubled times; even back in 2024, when Sir Keir Starmer came to office on a historic mandate — with Labour securing 411 out of 650 seats in the House of Commons — a poll of ordinary Britons showed that 44 per cent plumped for the cat as prime minister, compared to Sir Keir (34 per cent) and Rishi Sunak (22 per cent). True, he hasn't always kept his eye on the ball — or mouse. But being caught napping on the job is a negligible offence when others are implicated in financial mismanagement and quid-pro-quo scandals.

Perhaps it is time the laurel crown that he is named for was made literal. For a UK staring at yet more political turmoil, it may be time to keep calm and carry on with Larry.

India doesn't just need start-ups, but scale-ups that become global giants

SACHCHIDANAND SHUKLA

A STATISTIC doing the rounds is that, at the current rate of profit growth, the taxes paid by Samsung and SK Hynix will be around $430 billion over the next three years, almost equal to half of South Korea's national debt. Back home, amid the doom and gloom, two news items sparked hopes for our ability to build globally competitive giants. In early April, it was reported that Amul had become India's first FMCG firm to hit a turnover of Rs 1 trillion. Then came news that RIL had become the first Indian company to cross $10 billion in profits.

India had 35 companies with a turnover of over Rs 1 trillion in FY25. However, only one has crossed $10 billion in profits, a watershed moment for the Indian corporate sector. The US and China boast of dozens of such firms, and Japan has multiple companies consistently above this threshold.

A few questions come to the fore. How important is it to have large firms with big profit pools? Does this divergence between topline and bottom line in terms of scale point to any structural issue? Is there an issue of "economic populism" or anti-big-business sentiment that views profits negatively?

The history of economic development suggests large, well-governed companies have been among the most reliable engines of productivity and innovation, creating the economies of scale necessary to compete on the global stage and raise living standards.

Let us start with productivity. Large firms spread fixed costs, such as those of R&D, compliance and digital infrastructure, across vast output, driving down unit costs and raising efficiency. Innovation, too, is often scale-dependent. Breakthroughs require patient capital, tolerance for failure and multidisciplinary talent — attributes concentrated in large enterprises. The US technology sector illustrates this vividly. Global competitiveness follows from this capacity to invest and integrate. Large firms build brands, control distribution, and orchestrate cross-border supply chains. They shape standards and capture value in global markets. They are significant direct employers and their larger contribution is often indirect: Dense supplier ecosystems, service providers and downstream distribution channels. They also contribute with higher wages.

As for the structural issue, India's corporate story should not be viewed only through the lens of scale via revenues. By that measure, India has made real progress: A growing cohort of firms now cross the Rs 1 trillion revenue mark and balance sheets are in their best-ever shape after years of deleveraging. Yet beneath this success lies an asymmetry that deserves closer attention. India has built large companies. But not enough that are globally dominant, innovation-led and embedded in the highest-margin segments of the world economy.

> India has built large companies. But not enough that are globally dominant, innovation-led and embedded in the highest-margin segments of the world economy

Three features define this gap.

First, Indian firms tend to scale domestically rather than globally. The home market is large and has been a powerful growth engine. Many firms have leveraged this demand to build formidable positions across sectors. But global revenue exposure remains limited outside a narrow band of sectors, notably IT services, pharma and to an extent auto and oil products. Even here, the model is largely export-oriented services, assembly or re-exports rather than ownership of products, platforms or patents. In contrast, the world's most valuable companies, from Apple to Toyota, derive strength from global market share, cross-border supply chains and pricing power built on brand and intellectual property.

Second, India's corporate profit pool is still unusually concentrated in finance and commodities finance. Financials and commodity majors account for a disproportionate share of aggregate profits with profit after tax contribution at 41 per cent and 19 per cent respectively. This is not unique to India, but the skew is more pronounced. These sectors are capital-intensive and often cyclical, with returns shaped by global price movements or credit cycles rather than sustained innovation. In advanced economies, a larger share of profits accrues to technology, pharmaceuticals and advanced manufacturing, sectors where firms command durable margins through intellectual property and network effects.

Third, India's presence in high-margin, innovation-driven sectors remains negligible. There are few domestic equivalents of frontier firms like NVIDIA that dominate critical nodes of the global technology stack. India's digital economy has produced successful platforms, but most are domestically focussed and operate in intensely competitive, low-margin environments. Global rents in software, semiconductors and advanced industrials continue to accrue to firms headquartered elsewhere.

This divergence is not simply a matter of top-down policies or corporate strategy; it also reflects fundamental conditions. India's R&D spending, at sub-1 per cent of GDP, lags far behind that of peers. Access to patient risk capital, particularly for deep-tech ventures, remains constrained. Regulatory uncertainty and fragmented factor markets raise the cost of scaling across states and sectors. And while India has integrated into global trade, it is yet to fully embed itself in the most lucrative segments of global value chains.

India's development journey is entering a new phase amid a fast-changing global backdrop. The next leap, jobs creation at scale and flow of investments, will come not from incremental growth but from creating many profitable firms. Hopefully, we have travelled some distance from the Economic Survey 2017-18 — which observed that the country had shifted "from crony socialism to stigmatised capitalism" — so that profit isn't a dirty word and businesses are not perpetually viewed with suspicion that hinders reforms and erodes investment sentiment.

To power India's transition to a high-income economy, we need dozens more such domestic champions with the scale, ambition, and execution depth that earn more than $10 billion in profits. The Korean examples above or the US Magnificent 7 are cases in point. India doesn't just need start-ups, it needs "scale-ups" that become global giants with large profit pools. The real question that needs answering by policymakers and corporates is then: Are we optimising for scale (only via revenues) or global competitiveness (profits plus pricing power)?

The writer is group chief economist, L&T. Views are personal

Will a nation grow, stagnate, decline? Technology will tell

RAJEEV CHANDRASEKHAR

THERE IS a question every civilisation has had to answer in its own era: What is the engine of prosperity? For most of human history, the answers were familiar — land, labour, capital, natural resources, trade routes. Nations that commanded these inputs commanded wealth and power. The Industrial Revolution added machinery and energy to that list. The 20th century added finance, institutions, and geopolitical leverage. But we are living through a rupture in that long pattern. For the first time, technology is not merely one factor among many that supports economic growth. It is the primary, foundational, and irreplaceable determinant of whether a nation grows, stagnates, or declines.

Consider what the last three decades have revealed. Countries that invested early and seriously in technology — the US, China, South Korea, Taiwan, Israel — have generated disproportionate shares of global wealth and wielded disproportionate geopolitical influence. Contrast this with resource-rich nations that failed to build technological capacity. They remain dependent — their wealth volatile, their growth episodic, their strategic position weak. Covid confirmed this in the starkest possible terms. Nations with strong digital infrastructure maintained economic activity. Nations with mRNA technology capability produced vaccines at unprecedented speed. Nations with advanced logistics and AI-enabled supply chains recovered faster.

Previous technological revolutions unfolded across decades or centuries. Nations could observe, adapt, and catch up. That window is narrowing rapidly. AI, in particular, is not a static capability that can be acquired off the shelf. It compounds. A nation that builds strong AI capability today will have exponentially stronger capability in five years. A nation that delays will face not a gap but a chasm.

Recent moves by the US government to prohibit access to certain AI models are a clear sign that technology denial is and will be a part of the geopolitical toolkit of certain nations. India has the demographic scale and intellectual capital. What it has historically underinvested in is the third ingredient: Technological sovereignty. The capacity to design, manufacture, and deploy critical technology on Indian soil, under Indian control, for Indian strategic and economic purposes. The India Semiconductor Mission, the PLI and DLI schemes, the IndiaAI mission, the Digital India infrastructure, the STA framework for platform and AI regulation — these are steps in the right direction. But they are the first steps. The destination is an India that does not merely consume technology or export talent, but that is a full-spectrum technology power. That destination will only be reached if policymakers, investors, and entrepreneurs internalise that technology is the substrate on which every other sector runs.

There is a final, democratic dimension to this argument that is often overlooked. Technology-driven economic growth is, at its best, the most broadly distributed form of prosperity in history. Digital platforms have given small businesses access to national markets. Mobile payments have given unbanked citizens access to the financial system. Telemedicine has given remote communities access to healthcare. Online education has given first-generation learners access to world-class knowledge. In a country like India, these gains represent the difference between exclusion and participation for hundreds of millions of people. The politics of technology in India cannot be the preserve of elites.

History will record the current era as the moment when technology ceased to be a means to an end and became the end itself. Nations that understood this early and acted with seriousness and urgency will write the story of the century. Those that did not will find themselves reading it. India has every reason and every capability to be among those who write it. The question is only how urgently we choose to.

> History will record the current era as the moment when technology ceased to be a means to an end and became the end itself

The writer is BJP Kerala state president, MLA for Nemom, former minister of state for Electronics & IT, and the architect of India's IT Rules 2021 and the Safe-Trusted-Accountable (STA) framework for platform and AI governance. Views are personal

Removing ranks from CVs is a distraction. Focus on skills

ANINDYA CHATTERJEE

THE ALL IITs' Placement Committee (AIPC) has instructed students to remove JEE ranks and percentiles, GATE scores, and similar entrance exam-related credentials from their CVs. These credentials may still be revealed if a recruiter asks. The directive merely reflects the IITs' decision to avoid including these credentials within CVs forwarded through the IITs' own placement offices. Two reasons are offered. One, such data might reveal clues about the student's reserved or unreserved category status. Two, these credentials do not mean as much as cumulative grades or projects during the years spent earning the degree.

One can debate whether entrance exam-related credentials are worth displaying to recruiters. On one side, the credentials are the students', and they remain free to reveal them, such as by posting them on personal webpages with links in their CVs. On the other side, IITs have the right to say they will only forward CVs that do not include certain information, and that students remain free to look for jobs outside the placement office efforts. The AIPC also says IITs may be stricter with companies that make offers and withdraw them later. If we debar a company from coming for placements to our IIT, are we assuming there are no other IITs that will host it, and that others will take its place? If placements weaken, will we be able to hold our position?

Skill is well compensated only when it is both needed and scarce. With too many graduates, skills are no longer scarce. How much skill is needed is, unfortunately, also open to question. Most people are skilled enough for their jobs. And now, with AI, the meaning of skill itself is being rapidly redefined. In a recent sobering interview, Chief Economic Advisor V Anantha Nageswaran advised young Indians to consider acquiring trade skills, because such skills are resistant to replacement by AI.

Whether placement offices should debar entrance exam-related credentials on CVs is a distraction. Whether IITs can meaningfully punish recruiters who renege on job offers remains to be seen. Whether Indian youth should run *en masse* from engineering to welding and carpentry is debatable, since it is unclear how many such people the country will employ at high wages.

There is another, more deductive view of employment and employability. Rich countries have shrinking populations and will have work that needs doing. Their own children will take the pleasant jobs in the middle, leaving work at two opposite ends. At one end, there will be low-pay, low-prestige, low-entry-barrier jobs, involving unglamorous human services or sustained labour. At the other end will be jobs that are lower-paying than finance, requiring skills with a long learning curve, like science and engineering jobs. Many of these might be sent to India.

How can we prepare our students for such jobs? What are engineering jobs that AI cannot do? Jobs that require skill with both computers and hands, travel to sites, unexpected connections between ideas, and situations where data is unavailable or confidential. These, more than entrance-exam ranks and offer-withdrawing recruiters, need to be thought about.

> With too many graduates, skills are no longer scarce. How much skill is needed is also open to question. Most people are skilled enough for their jobs. And now, with AI, the meaning of skill itself is being rapidly redefined

Chatterjee is professor of mechanical engineering at IIT Kanpur, and author of Build and Sustain a Career in Engineering. *Views are personal*

40 YEARS AGO

June 24, 1986

INDIAN EXPRESS

PM tells Barnala to take firm action
Concern over violence

Six more killed in Punjab incidents

Fresh blasts rock Allahabad

PM urges action on law & order

PRIME MINISTER Rajiv Gandhi asked Punjab Chief Minister Surjit Singh Barnala to give topmost priority to the question of law and order, to instil confidence among the people and take immediate steps to check the panic migration. The Prime Minister spoke to Barnala over the phone and pointed out that the situation in the state was deteriorating at a rapid pace.

Six more killed in Punjab

SIX PEOPLE, including a retired Army officer, were killed and a post office building set afire in Punjab during the past 24 hours as arson continued in curfew-bound Amritsar and Nakodar towns for the third successive day. Punjab Chief Minister Surjit Singh Barnala, began a tour of the two disturbed districts of Gurdaspur and Amritsar for an on-the-spot study of the situation in these areas.

Fresh blasts rock Allahabad

INCIDENTS OF shooting and bomb explosions were reported from the Beniganj and Mirapur localities, towards the end of a five-hour curfew relaxation in the riot-hit southern part of Allahabad. There were no casualties. Details were awaited. The district magistrate, Anil Kumar, claimed the situation in all the affected areas was fast returning to normal.

Janata bags Karnataka seats

THE JANATA PARTY once again triumphed with the middle classes when the ruling party made a clean sweep of all the four seats in the crucial elections to the Legislative Council held from four constituencies. A K Subbiah, who found a new political umbrella in the Congress-I this time, failed when M Satyanarayana Rao, the Janata candidate and former MLC, trounced him in a bitterly fought battle.

● WHAT THE OTHERS SAY

Netanyahu has once again bolstered the extremists. This time: Hezbollah.

— Haaretz, Israel

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Why industry can't afford to wait for the state to drive the robotics revolution

RAJA MANDALA

BY C RAJA MOHAN

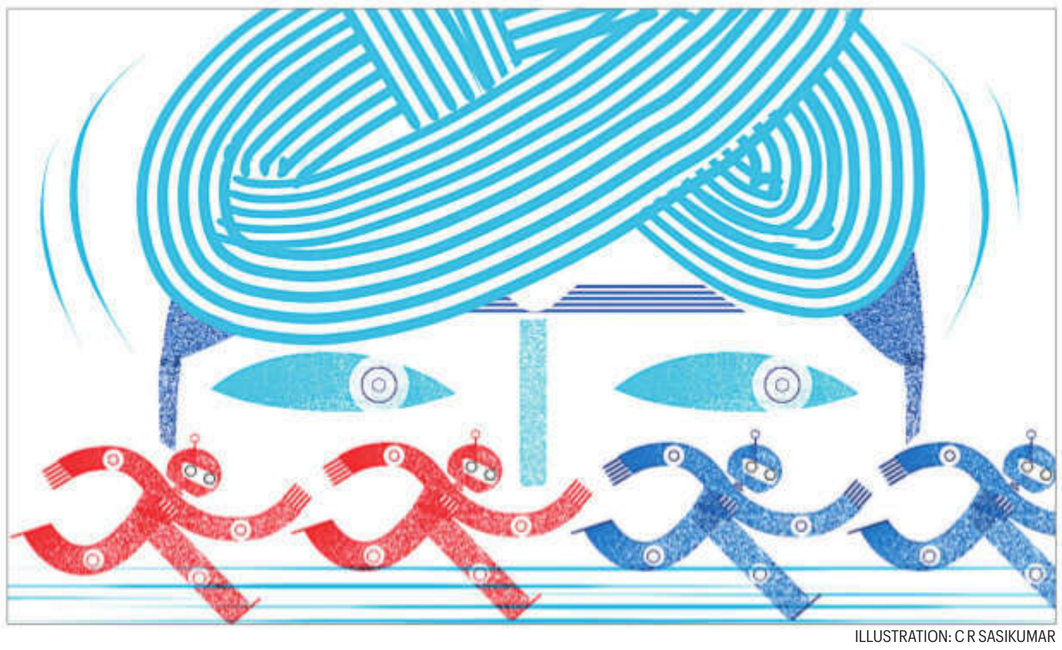

ILLUSTRATION: C R SASIKUMAR

ELON MUSK'S vision of "amazing abundance" imagines a world in which goods and services become plentiful and inexpensive, thanks to the unfolding technological revolution. The idea sounds fanciful, but it has a long lineage. Civilisations have long dreamt of magical sources of plenty — the *akshayapatra* of Indian mythology, the cornucopia of the ancient Greeks. Karl Marx, too, believed that advancing productive forces could eventually liberate humanity from drudgery, but the obstacle was in the exploitative structure of social relations.

Musk's bet is narrower than Marx's. He is convinced that the tech revolution at hand could produce societies of "universal high income". Whether this seductive vision is real or not, the tech transformation is here and is called "embodied intelligence" or "physical AI".

Digital AI generates answers to questions and is moving towards the simulation of reality, but it remains locked inside your computer. "Embodied intelligence" — robots, often built in vaguely human form and known as humanoids, that can sense their surroundings, make decisions and use mechanical limbs to act on them — promises to step into the factory, the hospital ward and the battlefield. Musk's bet is that such humanoid robots could become the most consequential product ever made, doing for production what the computer did for information.

This is not fantastical futurism. Industrial robots have populated factories for decades. The new ambition is to make them adaptable enough, by empowering them with AI, to work in spaces designed for humans rather than machines. That ambition is fast becoming one of the defining strategic contests of this century, and it increasingly runs through Washington and Beijing.

America still leads in frontier artificial intelligence, advanced chip design and the software architecture that will eventually serve as the brain of any humanoid robot. China has built something different: An industrial ecosystem to mass-produce the body. According to the International Federation of Robotics, China accounted for 54 per cent of all industrial robot installations worldwide in 2024 — some 295,000 units, the highest annual total ever recorded by any single country — and its operational stock crossed 2 million, by far the largest in the world. China is fast becoming for robotics what it already is for solar panels, batteries and rare-earth processing: The world's dominant manufacturing platform.

In robotics, then, as in several other frontier technologies, America increasingly supplies the brains while China supplies the bodies. Neither side is content to stay in its lane. Beijing is pouring resources into closing the gap in AI models; meanwhile, Washington is rediscovering industrial policy to rebuild advanced manufacturing at home.

> Unlike China, India cannot isolate its robotics ambitions from the world; its near-term task is to combine international collaboration with the patient building of domestic research, design and manufacturing capability

For now, China dominates the global humanoid robot market, producing roughly 85 per cent of all humanoids worldwide. According to *The New York Times*, Chinese firms like Unitree and AgiBot have begun mass production, and US companies are determined to catch up. Musk plans to begin pilot production of the Optimus 3 humanoid robot soon. He hopes to scale to high-volume manufacturing in the coming years, eventually expanding to a 10-million-unit-per-year production line at a Texas gigafactory.

India's place in this race remains modest. The country installed 9,100 industrial robots in 2024, a 7 per cent rise on the previous year, but that places it only sixth in the world by annual installations — well behind not just the United States, Japan and China but also South Korea and Germany. India's overall robot density of around 10 continues to trail the global average of 132 robots per 10,000 manufacturing workers. It is a fraction of South Korea's extraordinary 1,200. If America and China are contesting leadership in embodied intelligence, India is a mere spectator.

But the stakes for India could hardly be higher. For three decades, the country's comparative advantage has rested on an abundance of cheap labour. (It is a different matter if we have actually leveraged it for collective benefit.) The age of embodied intelligence puts a big question mark over that asset. The very resource that once seemed to favour India risks becoming a constraint in a world where manufacturing competitiveness depends increasingly on robotics rather than on wage differentials.

Self-reliance rhetoric is no substitute for strategy here. Unlike China, India cannot isolate its robotics ambitions from the world; its near-term task is to combine international collaboration with the patient building of domestic research, design and manufacturing capability. There are grounds for some optimism. SSI Mantra, India's first indigenous surgical robotic system, has already conducted telesurgeries across thousands of kilometres, demonstrating that Indian engineers can compete at the technological frontier when talent, demand and regulation align. Several other companies, like GreyOrange, are pressing ahead with robotics development. The challenge lies in building industrial-scale robotics.

The Indian government can and should set incentives, fund research and shape regulation. But policy cannot substitute for actions at the firm level. The GoI's Draft National Robotics Strategy has been around since 2023 and could eventually turn into a robotics mission. But if Indian industry waits for a state-led mission to drive the robotics revolution, it may find, as it has with other technologies before, that the revolution has already happened elsewhere.

Musk's "amazing abundance" may remain a distant horizon or be realised only in part. The race to build the machines that might get the world there, however, has already begun. India's place in it will be decided mainly by the appetite of Indian capital to invest, innovate and take risks at the scale the moment demands.

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With Labour's love lost, a deeper challenge for UK's next PM

RISHABH BHANDARI

IT SAYS a considerable deal about the current state of British politics that there was an inevitability about Sir Keir Starmer's resignation as prime minister. Announcing his departure almost a decade to the day since the Brexit referendum, he joins the growing procession of prime ministers with short-lived tenures. The country will soon have another prime minister, with Andy Burnham seen as the frontrunner. But a change in leadership is not a panacea. For any occupant of Downing Street to succeed, deep-seated structural issues need to be addressed.

The scene was set for Sir Keir's downfall, given the disastrous local elections last month. With Labour losing over 1,400 seats, the result seemed to reflect the national mood. The electoral angst cut across Labour's traditional heartlands in the north, Wales and Scotland. In the intervening weeks, the resignations of Wes Streeting as health secretary and John Healey as defence secretary piled on the pressure. And when Burnham's return to Westminster was confirmed in last week's Makerfield by-election, the game was up.

The scale of the turmoil is accentuated by the fact that this is a government with a commanding majority and only two years into its mandate. Sir Keir had promised a national renewal, a return of politics to public service, and to begin the work of change. But voters lost faith in his regular U-turns on policies. The gap between rhetoric and delivery became unbridgeable.

Is post-Brexit Britain too difficult to govern sustainably? As the country seeks its seventh prime minister in a decade, the broader question is a reasonable one. Theresa May wasn't able to persuade the right-wing elements in her party. But when the party turned to Boris Johnson, the dysfunction became obvious. We then had Liz Truss, who managed to erode the Tory party's reputation for fiscal prudence in no time at all. Amid this chaos, what chance did Rishi Sunak have when the voters wanted change? But Labour has not fared better.

All this has taken place against a backdrop of geopolitical and economic uncertainty. Living standards have been squeezed by food and oil price increases. Concerns over illegal immigration continue to dominate discourse. An ageing population needs more healthcare investment. Younger voters are finding it harder than ever to secure jobs. On the foreign policy front, Britain continues to search for a meaningful role. In this era, increasing defence spending is no longer optional, but Britain is struggling to fund it. What this highlights is the need for difficult conversations with the electorate. That has not been the preferred mode for the mainstream parties.

ILLUSTRATION: TANUSHRI MITRA

The result has been a rise in grievance-based politics with the dramatic emergence of Nigel Farage's Reform party. With over 1,000 seats gained across the country in local elections last month, Reform can legitimately claim electoral momentum. It made advances in Labour's "red wall" up north and surprised critics by gaining in Wales and in Scotland. Clearly, Reform's diagnosis that "Britain is broken" and in need of radical change has resonated. Yet, Burnham's win in Makerfield, where he consigned Reform to a distant second place, shows it isn't invincible. The Tories should take note, too, as they contemplate a continued rightward lurch or a return to centrism.

Turning back to Labour, while the party will acquire a new leader, the real issue is that it has no coherent strategy for growth. Burnham has not set out a detailed blueprint as yet. Granted, he may be a better communicator than Starmer, but that is a low bar. Once a cabinet minister in the Blair era, he tilted to the left during his time as mayor of Manchester.

There are those who are urging the party to push harder towards the left with a change in leadership. That is squarely based on the Labour Party's "infinite capacity for self-delusion", as Tony Blair commented recently. The truth is, Chancellor Rachel Reeves has piled on costs to employers with rises in their national insurance contributions. Increases to the living wage have disincentivised hiring younger staff members. The income-tax burden has also risen. The government has continued to add to welfare costs rather than tighten them.

To have any chance of flourishing, the next British PM needs to incentivise the private sector, setting out tough choices for the country's long-term direction while maintaining a fiscal balance. Persisting with the status quo will be the antithesis of taking back control, as many have discovered.

The writer is a London-based lawyer and political commentator

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Right to walk

BORN FROM a catalogue of preventable tragedies, this new verdict serves as the culmination of a tragic accumulation of failures ('Supreme Court has put pedestrians first. Cities must, too', *IE*, June 23). The reversal of the traffic hierarchy was a critical imperative, and its actualisation comes as a prudent intervention and a timely respite. Unlike vehicular transit, pedestrian access catalyses civic engagement, fosters community cohesion and drives local commerce.

Raghvi Sharma, Sunam

THE SUPREME COURT taking cognisance of the issue of inaccessible roads, which compromise pedestrians' right to movement and increase the risk of fatalities, reflects the erosion of the fundamental rights of citizens, especially vulnerable groups such as children and the elderly ('Supreme Court has put pedestrians first. Cities must, too', *IE*, June 23). Collisions have become a routine affair as footpaths are occupied for everything except movement. It is a critical situation in which the proliferation of motorised vehicles has led to the encroachment of roads for parking, thereby restricting the flow of traffic.

Madhusree Guha, Kolkata

Anti-defection law

The phenomenon of defection and the manner in which it is addressed by constitutional amendments leave much to be desired ('It's time to reimagine the anti-defection law', *IE*, June 23). The fact that a defector was elected on a party's ticket rather than as an independent candidate indicates that the credit for the victory is shared with the party. A good solution could be to restrict the tenure of defecting or merged leaders to six months, after which they would need to seek re-election. This is an established practice when a person assumes office without being a member of either House. There have been instances of prime ministers who had to get elected to Parliament in order to continue in office. Defectors may draw inspiration from them.

Amitabh, via email

The fire-safety crisis is hiding in plain sight

ADARSHA KAPOOR

IN THE last few months, incidents of fire in buildings functioning as coaching institutes, hotels, and similar establishments have attracted wider public attention. The widely reported incidents are typically those that result in loss of human lives. However, many such incidents largely escape public scrutiny because they do not lead to fatalities. The issue is much larger than it appears.

If the pattern of these incidents is studied, certain facts stand out. First, most have occurred in buildings with occupancy levels and usage patterns that exceed those for which they were originally designed. Preliminary reports suggest the building in Lucknow, gutted by fire on Monday, may have been sanctioned for residential use, while it was accommodating commercial and other activities. In essence, there may not be anything wrong with this, as most master plans and building by-laws permit mixed-use development if such buildings comply with fire safety regulations.

Second, many of these buildings are in congested urban areas like urban villages, unauthorised colonies, Tier-II and Tier-III cities. Again, there is nothing wrong with these areas, as they are products of the evolution of urban development. The problem lies in the fact that high-footfall activities are flourishing where access roads are less than six metres wide and often do not allow the entry of fire tenders.

Third, there is a widespread lack of awareness among owners and disregard among administrative agencies when it comes to enforcing emergency-response measures and conducting regular safety audits. In the national capital, municipal representatives visit premises to sensitise owners about the ill effects of stagnant water, yet there is virtually no initiative to educate people about fire-safety measures. Other factors include corruption in the approval of building plans, lack of awareness regarding building insurance, and archaic building regulations.

> There is a widespread lack of awareness among owners and disregard among administrative agencies when it comes to enforcing emergency-response measures and conducting regular safety audits

In recent years, as part of the government's "ease of doing business" initiative, compliance requirements for smaller-occupancy buildings have been relaxed. While this has simplified approvals, applicants often fail to realise that they remain responsible for ensuring their buildings comply with the fire-safety provisions of the National Building Code. These include minimum access widths, refuge areas, fire staircases, and installing fire-safety equipment.

The real-estate bubble has resulted in a multifold increase in property prices. Residences, workplaces, and shops have largely become unaffordable for the middle-, lower-middle and poor sections of society. They are often forced to move into urban villages and unauthorised colonies. Development authorities and planning agencies have been quick to call these out as illegal, but have failed miserably to increase the supply of affordable units. They have also failed to preempt the demand and at least ensure such areas have the necessary infrastructure. Bulldozing them is not a solution. They require a more balanced infrastructure strategy.

This brings us to a critical aspect of building operations and maintenance. There appears to be a complete lack of awareness regarding the importance and application of fire-safety norms, particularly in smaller buildings. Since the Uphaar Cinema incident, fire safety approvals and enforcement mechanisms for large-occupancy buildings like theatres, colleges, office complexes and similar establishments have become stringent. This is reflected in the fact that fire incidents in such buildings are now generally the result of disasters, whether natural or caused by electrical malfunctions. In smaller buildings, owners, residents, visitors, and even administrative officials often remain unaware of basic fire-safety and emergency response measures. Fire drills are rarely conducted in such buildings. Many do not even have fire extinguishers. Equally concerning is the apparent lack of effort to address these shortcomings.

I am compelled to arrive at the fact, though hesitantly, that we are quick to run sealing drives, bulldoze areas we feel are illegally built or give money to the relatives of people who die. But we have failed to take a pause, assess our mistakes and realise that response to such incidents cannot be a one-time affair.

The writer is a practising urban designer

A distance between memory and home

RUKMINI SEN

LIKE MOST of Imtiaz Ali's films, *Main Vaapas Aaunga* is an immersive journey. In fact, it is a film of many journeys: Carefree ones on bicycles, brutal ones on trains, anxious ones in planes and ambulances, on horse-drawn carts in Independence Day processions, crossings through barbed-wire borders on foot, and hopeful rides in cars. Yet beyond these physical movements lie deeper, transformative voyages — of desire, waiting, grief, and remembrance — that create some of its most beautiful cinematic moments.

I want to focus on four images though. The first, of writing. A young woman lying in a green field writing; a young man and an elderly man, at their desks committing memories to paper. They write to romance, to remember, to resist, to resurrect, to redeem, and ultimately, to inhabit a world that is slipping away. Writing becomes an act of preservation, ensuring future generations can read about them. Running through these scenes are glimpses of the Progressive Writers' Association, evoking Saadat Hasan Manto, Amrita Pritam, and Ismat Chughtai, reminding us the pen can outlast the sword.

This commitment to remembering also shapes the film's emotional core and leads to the second imagery. At a time when hearing one another has become a lost art, Ali lends listening a quiet gravitas. The way Nirvair tries to patiently piece together what Ishar's fractured words signify is deeply moving. Life, the film suggests, is an assemblage of fragments, much like Jiya's lost earring, that gets soaked in the bloodshed of violence. It becomes a powerful symbol of the breakdown of harmony. Like the pen, the earring is trampled upon, broken, lost.

The drawing of the Radcliffe Line through Jiya's courtyard crystallises this loss. For Keenu — and indeed for any love divided by Partition — it symbolises the loss of both a home and a land. The search for a lost home, or the longing to return to it through language, music, and memory, becomes eternal. Partition is, therefore, not merely an event to be mourned in retrospect; it plants a desire that continues to haunt the future. The closing-credits song, "*Kya kamaal hai*", gives this longing its most poignant expression.

> 'Main Vaapas Aaunga' is not simply a film about Partition. It urges us to remember so that future generations know that homes were lost even as the yearning to return endured

Equally affecting is the fact that Jiya is also called Afsana — fable or legend. We first hear the name when Keenu returns six years after Partition, only to find she is now someone else's wife. Although he tries to bury the past, memory — *maazi* — has always occupied a central place in Ali's cinema. Afsana remains real yet unreachable, alive only in memory, much like the impossibility of returning to Sargodha, a truth Ishar understands.

Main Vaapas Aaunga is not simply a film about Partition. It urges us to remember so that future generations know homes were lost even as the yearning to return endured.

As a sociologist with roots in the "other side" of Bengal, and as someone with a father affected by dementia — who longed to and could return to his home in Jamshedpur one final time — I see in the film a lesson about memory's role in intergenerational dialogue. It teaches us to value shared cultures, and to recognise that healing can be a lifelong pilgrimage. While scholars like Urvashi Butalia, Ritu Menon, and Kamla Bhasin have written powerfully about rape, abduction, and recovery during Partition, *Main Vaapas Aaunga* moves beyond the language of trauma alone. It imagines a world sustained by sublime love and longing, echoing Kabir's timeless question: *Haman hai ishq mastana, haman ko intezaari kya*?

The writer is professor, Dr BR Ambedkar University, Delhi. Views are personal

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• LEGAL

Intellectual disabilities & the question of choice in giving birth

Vineet Bhalla
New Delhi, June 23

THE KARNATAKA High Court permitted the parents of a 23-year-old woman with severe intellectual and developmental disabilities a total abdominal hysterectomy, or the surgical removal of the uterus, last week. The ruling was the latest instance of courts' intervention in the reproductive autonomy of women with intellectual disabilities — decisions that often involve the complex intersection of law, medicine and human rights.

Why approach courts?

Historically, women with intellectual disabilities have been vulnerable to forced sterilisations and non-consensual medical procedures, often justified by caregivers as a matter of convenience or under the guise of protecting them from the consequences of sexual abuse.

To prevent this, Indian law places strict safeguards on procedures that permanently alter a person's reproductive capacity. Section 10 of the Rights of Persons with Disabilities Act, 2016, prevents persons with disability from being subjected to any medical procedure leading to infertility without their free and informed consent.

A legal dilemma arises when a woman's intellectual disability is so severe that she lacks the cognitive capacity to understand the nature and consequences of a procedure, rendering her unable to give "informed consent". In such scenarios, caregivers and doctors cannot unilaterally make the decision and must approach a court. The court does not simply substitute its own judgment for the individual's; it conducts an inquiry to determine what course of action lies in the "best interests" of the person.

BEST INTERESTS

- For individuals unable to care for themselves, the courts invoke 'parens patriae': a doctrine wherein the court steps into the shoes of a guardian.
- The court conducts an inquiry to determine what lies in the person's "best interests", prioritising their health, dignity, and bodily integrity.

Guidelines on hysterectomies

The issue of consent and medical necessity in hysterectomies was addressed by the Supreme Court in *Dr Narendra Gupta v. Union of India* (2023), which highlighted that "unnecessary hysterectomies" were being carried out on women, particularly from marginalised communities, under government health insurance schemes. These procedures were often allegedly performed in private hospitals without consent or informing the women about side-effects.

Recognising this as a serious violation of the fundamental right to health under Article 21, the SC directed all states and Union Territories to strictly implement the Union Health Ministry's 2022 Guidelines to Prevent Unnecessary Hysterectomies. The court mandated the formation of hysterectomy monitoring committees at the national, state and district levels to audit such surgeries and directed the blacklisting of hospitals found performing the procedure without necessity or consent.

The abortion dilemma

While the Karnataka case dealt with a hysterectomy, most of the jurisprudence regarding the reproductive rights of intellectually disabled women in India revolves around pregnancies, often resulting from sexual assault.

Here, the Medical Termination of Pregnancy Act, 1971, comes into play. Under the Act, if a pregnant woman has a mental illness, a pregnancy can be terminated with the written consent of her guardian. The law, however, does not extend this guardian-consent provision to women with intellectual disabilities. For them, their own consent remains an absolute legal requirement for an abortion.

This distinction came to the fore in *Suchita Srivastava v. Chandigarh Administration*, a landmark 2009 SC judgment. The SC held that a woman's right to make reproductive choices is a fundamental dimension of "personal liberty" guaranteed under Article 21. The court noted that because she suffered from mental retardation and not a mental illness, the state could not force an abortion without her consent.

Courts are also frequently forced to balance reproductive autonomy with the physical survival of the mother and the medical complexities of late-stage pregnancies.

• ECONOMY

Before tariff reset, will US and India strike balance?

The timing of US trade chief Jamieson Greer's visit to India encapsulates the carrot-and-stick approach adopted by America when it comes to trade deals

RAVI DUTTA MISHRA

AS US Trade Representative (USTR) Jamieson Greer leads his first trade delegation to India after over a year of negotiations, the two countries appear to be closer than ever to finally completing their trade deal.

Greer, in an op-ed last year, wrote that US President Donald Trump uniquely recognises that the privilege of selling into the world's most lucrative consumer market is a "mighty carrot" and a tariff is a "formidable stick". America's approach to trade deals across the globe and the timing of USTR's visit to India encapsulates this carrot-and-stick approach.

The US had imposed sweeping reciprocal tariffs on several countries last year under a rarely-used legislation called the International Emergency Economic Powers Act (IEEPA). In February, however, the US Supreme Court struck down these reciprocal tariffs, prompting the administration to use alternative legislation to resurrect its tariff policy.

One of these pieces of legislation was under Section 122, which gives the US authority to impose 10% tariffs for 150 days. These are now set to lapse on July 24 — when Washington is expected to introduce a new, steeper tariff architecture under Section 301 of the US Trade Act of 1974.

The final stretch of the India-US talks come right before this. The US has already proposed 12.5% tariffs on India and is expected to release the findings of its second Section 301 investigation on India and 15 other countries well before July 24.

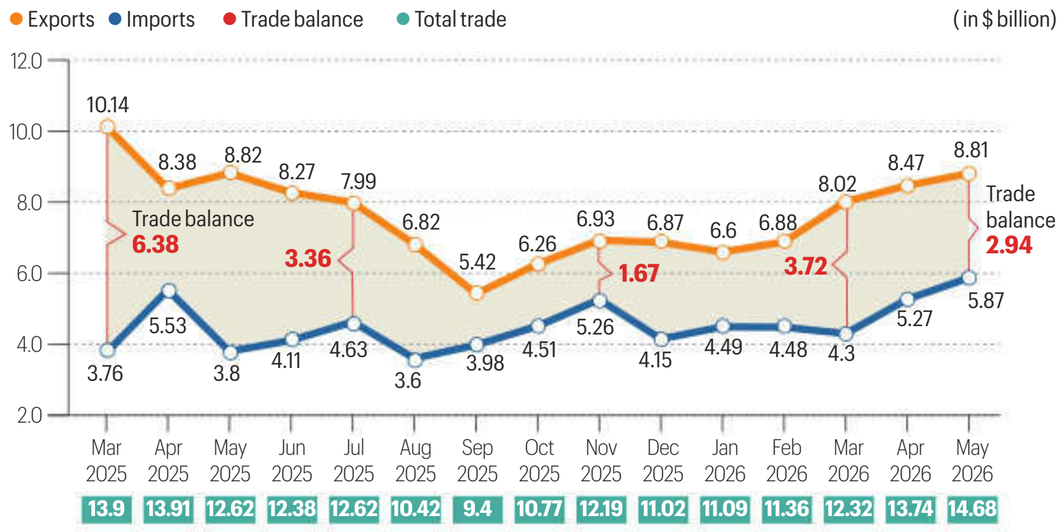
India is among the handful of countries with whom the US is yet to formally sign a trade deal. It has already sealed deals with nearly a dozen trade partners, including the EU, Japan, South Korea and several ASEAN countries.

While the US has been seeking deeper access into Indian markets, New Delhi has demanded a competitive edge in the tariff rates in Washington's new Section 301 architecture, along with assurances that no further Section 301 tariff will be opened against India following the deal. The US has opened three Section 301 investigations in Vietnam. China also remains a key Section 301 target.

Sergio Gor, the US Ambassador to India, said last month that Washington expects that a bilateral trade deal with India will be signed in the "next few weeks and months". He indicated that only "1%" of the deal was left to be concluded, and Indian and US negotiators were working on it. This could explain Greer's first visit to India.

India is primarily worried about a surge in US agricultural products which receive far higher government support compared to incentives given in India. From the US perspective, the talks are aimed at protecting and reviving its industrial base. India, meanwhile, is concerned that high-value imports of tech products will increase, eroding the already shrinking goods trade surplus. Overall, India runs an annual goods trade deficit of over $300 billion.

• INDIA'S SHRINKING GOODS TRADE SURPLUS WITH U.S.



SOURCE: COMMERCE MINISTRY, NOTE: INDIA-US TRADE TALKS BEGAN AFTER PM NARENDRA MODI'S VISIT TO THE U.S. ON FEBRUARY 18, 2025

Narrowing trade surplus

The US imposed 50% tariffs on India in August — 25% was retaliatory and the rest was linked to Russian oil purchases. This made India the worst hit country.

India's export surplus with the US has been declining owing to the steep reciprocal tariffs that were in place for nearly six months *(see chart)*. Data released by the Commerce and Industry Ministry showed that India's export surplus slipped over 40% from $5.02 billion in May 2025 to $2.94 billion in May this year. This came after Trump's repeated targeting of India over the steep trade surplus and barriers imposed by India on US goods.

The declining surplus is concerning for India as New Delhi runs a goods trade deficit with nine of its ten top trading partners. The US is the only major economy to which India exports more than it imports. Besides, India's dependence on the US market has gone up over the last decade. According to official data, the US now accounts for nearly 20% of India's total exports, compared to 10% in 2010-2011.

Shrinking surplus: Why it's a worry

India runs a goods trade deficit with nine of its ten top trading partners.

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The US is the only major economy to which India exports more than it imports.

Data showed that India's petroleum product exports to the US in March this year slipped by 24.02% to $235.47 million compared to $309.91 million. India's imports in March under the same category went up by 130.95% to $321.73 million in March 2026 compared to $139.31 million during March last year.

Another high-volume product category where US imports have been gaining ground is electronic components. While India's exports of electronic components in March this year slipped by 33.41% from $203.54 million to $135.54 million this year, India's imports under this category jumped by 136.30% to $431.89 million in March 2026 compared to $182.77 million in March 2025.

Farm groups have expressed fear over an influx of US agricultural imports. Rakesh Tikait, national spokesperson of the Bhartiya Kisan Union, said in a letter to PM Narendra Modi that in the absence of adequate tariff protection, farmers engaged in growing these agricultural products would not be able to compete with subsidised imports from the US.

'Tough nut to crack'

Greer has been critical of India's position, saying it had been a "difficult nut to crack", highlighting differences in agriculture negotiations; however, he had also said that the US had received the "best offer" from India. In a detailed report prepared by his department, Greer pointed out non-tariff barriers across sectors in India, which are hurting US companies trying to export.

"There's resistance in India to certain row crops and other meats and products. As you said, they're very difficult nut to crack. I agree with that 100%, but they've been quite forward leaning...the type of offers they've been talking to us about have been the best we've ever received, as a country. I think that (India) is a viable alternative market," Greer had said in December while responding to a question before the US Senate Appropriations Committee.

The result of the talks with Commerce Minister Piyush Goyal assumes significance as several investors are holding on to capex investment, awaiting Washington's new tariff architecture. For India, a slowdown in investments has resulted in a rapidly weakening currency. India saw gross Foreign Direct Investment inflows rise to a new record of $94.53 billion in 2025-26, up 17% from the previous year, although the net figure was a mere $7.65 billion, RBI data showed.

Inflows had risen sharply in February on the back of global investor sentiment reversing in the wake of the signing of an interim trade deal between India and the US early that month, which eliminated the penal 25% tariff and reduced the reciprocal tariff to 18% from 25%. Foreign Portfolio Investors had also net bought Indian financial assets in February to the tune of $4.17 billion. However, once the West Asia war began at the end of February, foreign capital exited Indian shores in droves: $13.6 billion in March, $7.56 billion in April.

Greer: China, free trade sceptic

Greer has long been known to be a protege of Trump's tariff war architect, Robert Lighthizer, who authored the book *No Trade Is Free*. Greer has long believed that China stole American intellectual property rights to build a manufacturing base in China, which resulted in the loss of American jobs and that "Chinese ambitions are an existential threat to the US". In the op-ed, Greer said that over the past three decades, the US slashed barriers to allow vast inflows of foreign goods, services, labour and capital. At the same time, other countries kept their markets closed and artificially boosted exports to the US, he wrote.

• GLOBAL

The straightforward constitutional process to replace the UK PM

Arav Shah
New Delhi, June 23

UK PRIME Minister Keir Starmer announced his resignation Monday from both his post as head of the government and as leader of the Labour Party. Labour leader Andy Burnham, the former mayor of Greater Manchester who last week was elected in a parliamentary bypoll from Makerfield, is the frontrunner to succeed him. Since 2016, not a single British PM has come close to completing their five-year term.

How the UK chooses its PM

The UK Parliament consists of two houses: the House of Lords (Upper House) and the House of Commons (Lower House). The party holding the majority of seats out of a total of 650 seats in the Lower House chooses the PM, usually the party leader.

The five-year term of service is a limit to the parliamentary term for the party in power, not the individual PM. This means that the top leadership can face upheaval regardless of the party's popularity.

The PM's selection begins with the general election, where citizens vote to choose their MP who represents their constituency in the House of Commons. The leader of the winning party is subsequently invited by the monarch (presently King Charles III) to form the new government.

The PM's power stems from their ability to command the confidence of their elected MPs, who are "far closer to the ground", said Manjeev Singh Puri, former Ambassador to the European Union. The loss of internal confidence can trigger a party-specific leadership election, which, if successful, results in the replacement of the incumbent PM. This is because the British system treats the PM as the primus inter pares, or first among equals.

"In Britain, MPs are part of a system where they enjoy a high degree of political empowerment. This ensures the PM is deeply subject to internal corrections by the party's backbenchers who may be measuring what he adds to their personal cache of credibility," Puri told *The Indian Express*.

Starmer had been the subject of intense scrutiny following dismal results in the May 2026 local polls and the Peter Mandelson row regarding the Epstein files scandal.

First among equals

- The PM's power stems from their ability to command the confidence of their elected MPs.
- The loss of internal confidence can trigger a party-specific leadership election; if successful, the incumbent PM is replaced.
- This is because the British system treats the PM as the 'primus inter pares', or first among equals.

Replacing PM: Labour rules

Starmer's replacement will be chosen based on Labour's specific internal procedures. The process generally involves:

1. TRIGGERING VACANCY: The leadership contest begins once the current head either resigns, or if a formal challenger is backed by 20% of the MPs within the Labour Party.

2. TIMETABLE: Upon facing a leadership vacuum, the party's National Executive Committee immediately convenes to agree on an election timetable, including leader nominations and the voting timeframe.

3. CANDIDATE NOMINATION: Candidates must be an MP in the House of Commons and have requisite support among members.

4. AFFILIATE SUPPORT: Candidates must also secure nominations from 5% of Constituency Labour Parties or three affiliated organisations, like trade unions. Once the final ballot is set, voting takes place. All party members and affiliates vote via a preferential ballot, ranking the candidates in order of preference. The winning candidate must receive over 50% of the votes; otherwise, candidates are eliminated and their votes are transferred forward.

'Strength, not instability'

The winner of the internal Labour vote does not automatically assume power. To tender his resignation, Starmer must travel to the Monarch's residence, after which the newly elected Labour leader is summoned to an audience with the Monarch.

The opportunity to form a new government is then extended to the new leader — accepting this offer officially makes them the Prime Minister.

"While we may see that the UK will now have had seven PMs across a decade, this might indicate to the electorate the strength of the democratic system and not instability," Puri said.

As long as the governing party retains an overall majority in the Lower House, it holds the power to change the country's leader during times of faltering confidence.

• DEFENCE

From Ukraine to Lebanon, 'invisible' drones are redefining asymmetric warfare

Abhinav Chakraborty
New Delhi, June 23

A FRAGILE ceasefire prevails between the Israel Defense Forces (IDF) and Hezbollah in Lebanon. This came after months of fighting that saw the Iran-backed militia deploying a low-cost weapon to lethal effect against Israel's advanced electronic warfare systems: fibre-optic drones.

'Invisible' drones

Fibre-optic drones, as the name suggests, are connected to their operators through fibre-optic cables — these are high-speed, high-strength, and lightweight network cables that transmit data as pulses of light through tiny strands of glass or plastic. This thin cable is first wound onto a spool and covered with a protective shell before being attached to a drone.

"So it's a big spool of very thin wire, almost hair-like, connected to both the drone and the operator. The entire communication is through this cable, and this thin wire provides security to the drone because no radio emissions can be picked up," Group Captain Rajiv Kumar Narang (retired), a drone systems expert and senior fellow at the Manohar Parrikar Institute for Defence Studies and Analyses, told *The Indian Express*.

When the drone takes off, the cable begins to unwind and can reach reasonable speeds without encountering too much drag. According to Narang, the drone's information and control is managed through this thin wire, which initially allowed operation over shorter distances of about 5 km and later went up to — as per some claims — distances of even 20 to 30 km. Since these cables can transmit operational data during flight, they enable a drone operator to see their target and the surrounding environment in real time.

The Russia-Ukraine war has been the testing ground for innovation in drone warfare. Narang said that given traditional drones emit radio frequency (RF) signals and create their signatures owing to their use of GPS or radio control, they are susceptible to jamming, detection, and fixing of position. Fibre-optic drones emerged as the solution.

WIKIMEDIA COMMONS

A Ukrainian first-person view drone with a fibre-optic wire for communication.

Tackling the threat

These drones have found a new battlefield in southern Lebanon, where Hezbollah has been fighting the IDF. Reports indicate that Israel, despite its sophisticated jamming systems, has found it tough to neutralise this threat and suffered setbacks since April, be it in the form of wounded soldiers or destroyed armoured vehicles.

Effective neutralisation is preceded by detection and tracking. According to Narang, detection requires proactive systems. "We need to develop better radars and, of course, electro-optic systems and infrared systems. They should be able to provide real-time detection, identification, and tracking of small, slow and low flying drones," he said.

Narang said the only source for detection of a fibre-optic drone is its radar cross-section — a metric that determines how visible it is to radar. This requires highly capable radar systems and is extremely difficult with current technological levels.

In terms of neutralisation, the drone's small size and lack of RF signals pose an additional challenge besides the lack of time for detection. Drone neutralisation systems, being multi-sensor and multi-shooter systems, are becoming expensive to achieve assured neutralisation of hostile drones.

A report in *The Jerusalem Post* pointed to efforts by top Israeli defence companies to present a range of solutions to the IDF. Among them were energy-based systems, including one that utilises electromagnetic force to capture and immobilise the drone. Another proposed solution are kinetic interception systems — also called "hit-to-kill" — which destroy targets such as ballistic missiles and hostile drones using kinetic energy, that is, extreme physical force of a direct, high-velocity collision.

For now, Israeli soldiers have taken a cue out of Ukraine's playbook by using rather rudimentary techniques such as protective nets and even metal enclosures on military equipment to block these drones.

Besides, these drones also have their shortcomings. For instance, they are susceptible to bad weather owing to their light body frame. They can also stop functioning if the thin cable snaps.

The Indian context

India's four-day conflict with Pakistan last May in the aftermath of the Pahalgam terror attack also saw extensive use of drone swarms and loitering munitions. Since then, India has sought to learn from its own experience as well as other battlegrounds.

Narang believes swarms would be a "major challenge". He said: "From an Indian point of view, I think we need to think of developing better 'hard-kill' counter-drone systems." 'Hard kill' refers to physically destroying the drone, whether by firing a gun, using a suicide drone, or launching a small missile.

Since jamming may not be an option against fibre-optic drones, Narang said that India could also develop Light Combat Helicopters and Light Combat Aircraft, among others, as airborne counter-drone platforms. Narang also suggested greater use of AI and upgradation of munitions in detection and neutralisation alongside hybrid and mobile air defence systems to enhance accuracy and effectiveness.

FULL REPORT ON
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THE REGULATOR SAID THE PERMISSION IS IN ADDITION TO EXISTING LENDING PROVISIONS

Banks can extend loans against FCNR(B) deposits, says RBI

RBI made FCNR(B) deposits a more attractive source of overseas funding for lenders by absorbing the hedging burden

George Mathew
Mumbai, June 23

THE RESERVE Bank of India (RBI) on Tuesday said Indian banks, including their overseas branches, are permitted to extend loans to non-resident account holders or even issue Standby Letters of Credit (SBLC) in favour of overseas lenders against FCNR(B) deposits mobilised under the new swap facility.

The regulator has said that this permission is in addition to existing provisions that already allow banks to extend secured or unsecured credit and issue guarantees under normal banking norms. The RBI, in its clarification issued as Frequently Asked Questions (FAQ), said banks are permitted to extend loans to the FCNR (B) account holders and mark lien on such deposits. Lien is a legal claim or right over someone else's property until a debt or obligation is paid.

On June 5, the RBI announced the special dispensation that allows banks to mobilise fresh three- to five-year FCNR(B) deposits until September 2026. It also permitted them to swap these deposits with the RBI at a concessional rate, effectively covering the entire hedging cost.

By absorbing the hedging burden, the RBI has made FCNR(B) deposits a more attractive source of overseas funding for lenders. Experts believe the steps announced may attract an additional $50 billion in foreign capital into Indian markets as banks have offered higher interest rates after considering the hedging sops. The RBI will be providing a forex swap for the deposit received. The facility is a plain buy/sell foreign exchange swap from the RBI side covering only the principal amount of the deposits and not the interest component. "The bank will be allowed to undertake swaps for tenors of less than three years provided they have mobilised fresh eligible FCNR (B) deposits for minimum original tenor of three years as per the scheme," it said. Interest rates on deposits, including where differential rates of interest are offered, will be subject to compliance with paragraph 32(2) of the Reserve Bank (Commercial Banks - Interest Rate on Deposits) Directions, 2025.

Banks will continue to offer regular FCNR (B) deposits, without availing Swap facility, for customer deposits with a tenor of 3 years and above up to 5 years, without the requirement of a minimum lock-in period of one year. However, records shall be maintained separately, it said.

ECBs can be raised for any period, as permitted in terms of Foreign Exchange Management (Borrowing and Lending) (First Amendment) Regulations, 2026. However, the ECBs of average maturity of three years and above are eligible for this facility. Further, the tenor of the swap will be co-terminus with the repayment schedule or maturity of the ECB, subject to maximum period of five years, the RBI said.

• FCNR(B) DEPOSIT PUSH

THE SPECIAL dispensation allowing banks to mobilise fresh three- to five-year FCNR(B) deposits until September 2026 was announced by RBI on June 5

IT ALSO permitted them to swap these deposits with the central bank at a concessional rate, effectively covering the entire hedging cost

EXPERTS BELIEVE the steps are likely to attract an additional $50 billion in foreign capital into Indian markets as banks have offered higher interest rates after considering the hedging sops

SENSEX, NIFTY LOST 1.2%; TCS, WIPRO, INFOSYS FELL OVER 3%

South Korean market's 10% crash after multiple highs reveals AI concerns

Akash Mandal
Mumbai, June 23

THE SOUTH Korean stock market crashed 10% on Tuesday, triggering a circuit breaker that halted trading, as fears of the AI bubble bursting gained steam. Other Asian markets also fell, including the Indian market.

South Korea's Kospi index had more than doubled until the crash so far in 2026, leading to concerns that the AI-driven rally had been overstretched. Shares of SK Hynix and Samsung Electronics, which had tripled and quadrupled, respectively, so far this year and have a nearly 55% weight on the benchmark index, crashed over 12% Tuesday, which some reports in the Korean media have deemed as 'Black Tuesday.'

The AI rally has led the Kospi to multiple record highs so far this year, with the latest one coming on Monday. However, some experts now believe the AI rally has now run too far ahead of its fundamentals, and the Kospi's crash could be the initial signs of the bubble potentially bursting going ahead.

"AI investments have obviously been very high, but the rally across various tech indices around the world has been insane. We still need to wait and watch regarding the profitability achieved by AI integration and when these steep AI investments may provide returns. But for now, profits do not reflect enough returns from the massive AI investments, so we do not have the fundamentals to back this rally. Today's crash reflects foreign investors suddenly pulling out funds from the market," the research head of a domestic investment firm said.

The crash was caused by the 'simultaneous panic selling' by foreign investors and institutional investors, who combined pulled out over $6 billion from the South Korean stock market on Tuesday, a report by *Business Korea* said.

Impact across markets

Other Asian markets also inched lower following the crash in the South Korean market. Japan's Nikkei 225 index ended 3.6% lower. Taiwan's Taiex, another index with heavy AI influence due to chipmaker TSMC, lost 1.3%.

The aftershocks of the crash were also felt in Indian market. BSE Sensex, which was trading nearly flat at around 11:40 PM, crashed nearly 600 points in a 45-minute window. The index inched lower for the rest of the session, eventually ending 893.39 points or 1.2% lower at 76,200.68. The National Stock Exchange's Nifty 50 lost 1.2% to end at 23,824.10. The decline was broad-based, with 67% of the stocks traded on the NSE ending in the red.

IT stocks were among the biggest drags on the benchmark indices, with the likes of TCS, Wipro, and Infosys falling over 3%. "Profit booking emerged after Nifty had rallied 4.1% over the previous seven sessions, supported by lower crude oil prices and moderation in foreign outflows following measures aimed at supporting the rupee," according to Siddharth Khemka, head of research, wealth management division at Motilal Oswal.

Wall Street also opened lower late in the evening, with the Nasdaq Composite down 1.6% in early trade. Futures contracts of the Nasdaq Composite and S&P 500 had fallen as much as 2% after the crash earlier in the day. Big tech names such as Intel, AMD, and Micron were down 3-10%. Heavyweight Nvidia was down over 3%. A few global firms had already sounded warning bells for AI.

Jefferies warned that Musk-backed SpaceX's IPO may be the peak of the euphoria surrounding AI. SpaceX's public issue, alongside other big-ticket pending issues like those of OpenAI and Anthropic, could drain liquidity from other stocks, with AI-related stocks that had seen the highest incremental flows recently facing the biggest risk.

FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

Other Asian markets inched lower as well after the crash in South Korean market. REUTERS

• AI-driven markets, companies gave big returns despite crash

Entity	Change on Tuesday	Change in 2026
Saumsung Electronics	-12.3%	158.5%
SK Hynix	-12.5%	292.5%
Kospi index	-10%	94.7%
Taiex index	-1.3%	62.6%

SOURCE: EXCHANGES

June pvt sector growth slips to three-month low, PMI shows

Reuters
Bengaluru, June 23

INDIA'S PRIVATE sector expanded at its slowest pace in three months in June as weaker demand growth weighed on both factory and services activity, while business confidence slipped to its lowest level since January, a survey showed.

The HSBC's flash India Composite Purchasing Managers' Index (PMI), compiled by S&P Global, fell to 57.4 this month from May's 59.3. A PMI reading above 50.0 indicates expansion in activity.

Overall new orders, a key gauge of demand, rose at their slowest pace since March with firms citing competitive pressures and gas shortages as obstacles to securing business.

On the export front, the picture was mixed as services companies saw slightly faster international sales growth but manufacturers recorded their weakest rise in new export orders since March 2023.

The services PMI fell to a 17-month low of 57.3 from 59.8 while the manufacturing PMI slipped to a three-month low of 54.5 in June from 55.0 last month.

Kunal Shah to lead WhatsApp: What CRED, Meta deal means for India's fintech sector

George Mathew
Mumbai, June 23

FROM DROPPING out of Mumbai's Narsee Monjee Institute of Management Studies (NMIMS) to becoming the new Chief Executive Officer (CEO) of WhatsApp, the world's leading messaging platform owned by Meta Platforms, Kunal Shah has had quite a journey in the startup ecosystem.

Shah, 43, the founder of CRED — a members-only fintech platform that rewards users for paying their credit card bills on time — has the distinction of being one of India's notable startup leaders. While moving to Menlo Park, California, the head office of WhatsApp, he also secured a $900 million (around Rs 8,500 crore) investment for CRED from Meta, underscoring Meta's confidence in his vision and leadership. India is WhatsApp's largest market with more than 500 million active users. "As for me, I'll be joining Meta to lead WhatsApp globally. Meta comes in as a minority investor in CRED. No access to member data," Shah said. "While it's come very far, the delta between WhatsApp today and its full potential is massive. I look forward to working with Mark (Zuckerberg, Meta CEO), Chris (Cox, Meta's chief product officer) and the leadership across Meta for the next step in WhatsApp's journey. Will Cathcart (Shah's predecessor at WhatsApp), thank you for scaling something the world relies on quietly, and for making this transition smooth," Shah said on his role in WhatsApp.

His entrepreneurial journey began long before CRED. In 2010, he cofounded FreeCharge, a digital payments and mobile recharge platform that quickly became one of India's most successful startups. The firm was acquired by Snapdeal in 2015 for about $400-450 million, one of the largest startup exits in India at the time.

After exiting FreeCharge, Shah spent time investing in and mentoring startups across India and Southeast Asia. As per his LinkedIn profile, he has been an investor in firms like Razorpay, Unacademy, Spinny, and several other high-growth ventures. He also served in advisory roles with organisations including AngelList and investment firms such as Y Combinator and Sequoia Capital. His profile describes him simply as "Founder: CRED, curious", reflecting the intellectual curiosity that has become part of his public persona. In 2018, Shah founded CRED, and the firm targeted India's most creditworthy consumers and built a premium brand around trust, rewards, and financial discipline. After the Meta announcement, he told CRED staff: "Team CRED, I'll still expect you to be a 10x version of yourselves. I'm stepping away from the operating role and will continue as a shareholder. My commitment doesn't change. Just the role."

FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

CRED rewards users for timely credit card payments on its members-only platform. REUTERS

Concerns over CRED-Meta deal

Mumbai: New Delhi-based economic think-tank Global Trade Research Initiative (GTRI) has raised concerns over Kunal Shah's appointment as WhatsApp head and Meta's $900 million investment in CRED.

"First, American technology companies are gaining increasing control over India's fintech sector and the vast financial data generated by Indian consumers. Second, many Indian fintech startups appear more interested in building companies for eventual sale to foreign buyers than in creating long-term Indian-owned digital champions," GTRI said.

The Meta-CRED transaction comes at a time when the country's digital-payments ecosystem is increasingly dominated by platforms linked to US firms. Walmart controls about 72% of PhonePe, Google owns Google Pay and Meta owns WhatsApp Pay, GTRI said. ENS

Infosys eyes $400 bn AI-first services opportunity by 2030

Poulomi Chatterjee
Bengaluru, June 23

INFOSYS SEES a $300-400 billion opportunity emerging in AI-first services by the end of the decade as enterprises race to modernise decades-old technology systems to deploy artificial intelligence (AI) at scale, Chairman Nandan Nilekani said on Tuesday.

Speaking at the company's 45th annual general meeting, Nilekani said that the next phase of AI adoption would require companies to overhaul legacy technology infrastructure, eliminate technical debt and integrate AI systems with core transaction platforms, creating a significant growth opportunity for technology services firms.

"The AI deployment gap that large enterprises are facing creates a massive opportunity for companies like Infosys," Nilekani said. "AI will not replace companies like ours. It will amplify those who move with purpose and adapt with speed."

According to Nilekani, while generative AI has captured boardroom attention globally, many enterprises continue to struggle with moving beyond pilot projects because of the complexity of integrating AI with existing systems.

As organisations seek to modernise applications, strengthen cybersecurity frameworks and improve data governance, the role of systems integrators is likely to become more important rather than less, he said.

"The biggest opportunity lies in combining AI systems, including models and agents, with traditional transaction systems that still underlie enterprise operations," Nilekani said. "It is said that to anticipate the future, we should skate to where the puck is going. In this case, the puck is coming to where we have already positioned ourselves."

He added that enterprises are increasingly opting to build customised software capabilities rather than purchase off-the-shelf solutions as they look to embed AI into business processes. "Their preference will be to build versus buy for software. All this creates even larger opportunities for us," he said.

The company is already working with 90% of its top 200 clients on AI initiatives, Nilekani disclosed.

Chief Executive Officer and Managing Director Salil Parekh said Infosys' annualised AI services revenue has crossed $1 billion and continues to grow faster than the company's overall business. FE

> **"The biggest opportunity lies in combining AI systems, including models and agents, with traditional transaction systems that still underlie enterprise operations."**
> NANDAN NILEKANI, CHAIRMAN, INFOSYS

LRS remittances fall 11.9% in Apr as overseas investments slow

George Mathew
Mumbai, June 23

RESIDENT INDIVIDUALS remitted $2.29 billion under the Liberalised Remittance Scheme (LRS) in April 2026, marking an 11.9% decline from $2.59 billion recorded in March 2026 and $2.48 billion in April last year. The fall in outward remittances was driven largely by a sharp contraction in overseas deposits and investments in equity and debt instruments, reflecting a more cautious approach by Indian residents toward international financial assets.

Under the LRS of the Reserve Bank of India (RBI), resident individuals, including minors, can freely remit up to $2,50,000 per financial year for permissible current or capital account transactions. These transactions include education, studies abroad, travel, medical treatment abroad, purchase of property and investments in foreign stocks.

Data released by the RBI for April 2026 showed that remittances for deposits abroad fell to $94.79 million from $176.35 million in March 2026, a steep decline of 46.2%. Similarly, investments in overseas equity and debt instruments dropped by 45.8% year-on-year (y-o-y) to $238.63 million from $440.22 million. Together, these categories accounted for the largest reductions in remittance outflows during the month. Despite the overall slowdown, travel continued to dominate outward remittances. Spending on overseas travel rose 5.8% y-o-y to $1.16 billion, up from $1.09 billion in March. Travel alone accounted for roughly 51% of total remittances under the scheme, underlining the continued strength of international tourism and business travel among resident Indians.

As per the data from RBI, spending on overseas holiday travel and payments made to settle international credit card transactions recorded a notable increase between March and April this year. Such expenditures rose from $623.05 million in March to $686.65 million in April, reflecting stronger outbound travel activity and higher overseas spending by Indian residents. The increase suggests growing demand for international leisure travel, as well as a rise in cross-border transactions conducted using international credit cards during the period.

FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

• EXPERTS SAID THE RESULTS MAY REFLECT BEIJING'S PUSH TO PROJECT SELF-SUFFICIENCY IN COMPUTING SYSTEMS MORE THAN ITS POSITION IN THE GLOBAL AI RACE

China beats US with world's fastest supercomputer

Reuters
San Francisco, June 23

CHINA HAS overtaken the US to win the top spot on a list of the world's fastest supercomputers, but the results may say more about Beijing's desire to show self-sufficiency in computing systems than its standing in the global AI race, experts said.

The LineShine system at the National Supercomputing Centre in Shenzhen, China, uses domestically designed chips and won the top spot on the TOP500, a biannual global ranking of supercomputers, with the country's first listing in three years.

The ranking comes as the US and China are increasingly competing in advanced computing, with US President Donald Trump on Monday signing an executive order that aims to put the US ahead of China in the emerging field of quantum computing.

In the June 2026 edition of TOP500, LineShine beat out the previous titleholder, El Capitan, a supercomputer housed at Lawrence Livermore National Laboratory that the US government uses to develop and maintain its nuclear weapons stockpile.

But technology and policy experts interviewed by *Reuters* said the results do not mean that China has the world's fastest computer for AI work because of changes in the computing industry in recent years and the methods used to compile the list. LineShine ranked fourth on a benchmark test designed to simulate computing work that is more similar to AI.

Benchmark tests

For decades, supercomputers strung together many separate machines to work on complex scientific problems such as simulating how atoms interact with one another and were mostly the domain of national labs and universities.

To be ranked on the TOP500 list, supercomputer operators must run a set of benchmark tests that aims to mimic such work.

But in more recent years, cloud computing companies such as Microsoft, Amazon.com and Alphabet's Google built out massive supercomputers of their own but geared them for AI work instead.

Most of those companies do not opt to compete for a spot on the TOP500 list.

A study last year by AI policy researchers Konstantin Pilz, James Sanders, Robi Rahman and Lennart Heim found that SpaceX-owned xAI's Colossus system was already likely more powerful than the US government's El Capitan.

"If the hyperscalers submitted their systems, this 'world's fastest' would not crack the top five," said Jimmy Goodrich, a senior fellow at the University of California's Institute for Global Conflict and Cooperation.

Chip design efforts

The Chinese victory on the list more likely shows that China wanted recognition for its chip design efforts, which is a change from recent years, experts said. China first took the top spot on the TOP500 in 2010 and traded titles back and forth with the US and Japan until 2023, when China stopped submitting its systems after years of chip- and computing-related export controls from Trump's first administration and later under President Joe Biden.

The ranking comes as the US and China are increasingly competing in advanced computing. REUTERS

• BRIEFLY

Adani's Mundra Airport starts ops

Mundra: Adani Mundra Airport on Tuesday announced the launch of its inaugural scheduled flight service connecting Mumbai and Goa. The launch of eight new air services by Star Air from the state-of-the-art terminal beginning Tuesday, will create an express corridor, reducing travel time for trade, commerce, logistics and tourism, fuelling the economic engine of India's largest port Mundra. ENS

• MARKETS

Sensex	NIFTY	Gold ▼	US Dollar ▲
76,200.68	23,824.10	₹1,44,995	₹94.74
-893.39	-278.80		
-1.16%	-1.16%	Silver ▼	Oil ▼
		₹2,27,483	$75.28

NOTE: GOLD, SILVER RATES AS PER INDIA BULLION AND JEWELLERS ASSOCIATION GOLD PER 10G, SILVER PER 1 KG; CRUDE OIL (INDIAN BASKET) AS OF JUNE 22, 2026

CLASSIFIEDS & TENDERS

Classifieds

PERSONAL

I, Vishal Jain S/o Subash Jain,R/o-D-55-A, Chander Nagar,Ghaziabad-201011,have changed my minor daughter's name from Shenaya Jain to Shenaya M Jain. 0040862096-2

I,hitherto known as DANGI ASHOK KUMAR DEVNANDAN SINGH,S/O-DEVNANDAN SINGH R/O-RZC-II-262,GALI NO.6, MAHAVIR, ENCLAVE-1,PALAM, MANGLAPURI, NCT OF DELHI-110045, have changed my,name and shall hereafter be known as ASHOK KUMAR. 0040862186-11

I,Kiran Singh W/o Mohit Singh,R/o-WZ-133,Naraina-Village,New Delhi-110028,have changed my name Kiran to Kiran Singh for all future purposes 0040862192-6

I,Prisha,D/O-Ajay Kumar Sharma, R/O-701,Crystal Tower,Urbtech Xaviers,sector-168,Noida, Chhaprauli-Bangar,Gautam Budh-Nagar,Uttar Pradesh-201305,Have Changed My Name to Prisha Nahar,for All,Future Purposes. 0040862186-6

I,Tejaswini alias Tejaswini Kaushal,D/o Rajan Kaushal,R/o D-15/100, Sector-7, Rohini,Delhi-110085,have changed my name to Tejaswini Kaushal for all future purposes 0040862184-1

I,SMT . DURGA KASHYAP,W/O-RAVINDER SINGH MALIK R/O-PIPLI KHERA (5)SONIPAT, HARYANA 131039,Changed my name to DURGESH for all future purposes. 0040862192-2

I,Anu Varun,D/o-Dharam Pal,M/o-Mishka Chaudhry, R/o-H.No.285, Ground Floor,Sector- 31,Gurugram (Haryana)-122001, have changed my name to Anu Choudhry. 0040862192-8

I,Rogengar Imran Mohd Yamin alias Malik Imran Mohd Yamin Majidan alias Imran Mohammed Yamin Malik,S/o Mohammed Yamin Nizamuddin,R/o-C-11/30,Yamuna Vihar, Shahdara,Seelampur,Delhi-110053,have changed my name to Imran Malik for all future purposes. 0040862094-1

I,AJAY KUMAR S/o Satyawan Singh,R/oH.No.563, Post-Office Mehrauli, Saidullajab, Delhi-110030, have changed my name to AJAY KUMAR PUNIA permanently. 0040862187-11

I, Rita Kumari, W/O Sujeet Kumar Jha, R/O-F-603, Block-F, CGRC, DDU Marg, Minto Road, Delhi-02, have changed my name to RITA JHA. 0071043682-1

I,KANISHAKA KUMAR,S/O-Shambhoo Dayal Dixit,H.No.-67,Data Ram-Apartment,Sec-18, Rohini, Delhi-110089,have changed my name to KANISHAKA KUMAR DIXIT for all,future purposes. 0040862187-4

I, Abhijeet Sinha R/o-L21, Gulshan Vivante Apts. Sec-137, Noida have changed my minor son name from Achintya Sinha to Achintya Sinha for all purposes. 0071043619-1

I,Dhanender alias Dhanendra S/O Jai Prakash R/O-1/3231, Ram Nagar Extension,Shahdara,Delhi-110032,have changed my name to Dharmendra for all purposes. 0040862188-6

I, Deepak Agrawal S/o Gajnand Agrawal R/o Flat No-602, Tower Sierra S1, M3M Marina, Sector-68, Badshahpur,Gurgaon, Haryana-122101,have changed the name of my minor daughter Avanya Agrawal to Durvi Agrawal aged 4 years. 0071043751-1

I hitherto known as Santosh Sharma W/o K D Sharma R/o I-3/133, Block-I, PKT-3Rohini Sector-16, Delhi-110085, have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as Shakuntla Sharma 0071043644-1

I,NIKHIT SABIA,D/O MUNIR AHMED,R/O-K-39, ABUL-FAZAL ENCLAVE-1, JAMIA-NAGAR, OKHLA, SOUTH,DELHI-110025, HAVE CHANGED MY NAME NIKHIT SABIA TO NIKHAT SABIA PERMANENTLY. 0040862186-8

I,JAMEEL AHMED S/o. Hare Khan R/o. RZ-273,Gali No.3,Durga Park,Palam Village,Delhi-110045,have changed my name to MAULANA JAMIL AHMED permanently. 0040862187-6

I, Javed S/o Hasmat Ali R/o-147, Badarpur, Loni, Ghaziabad have changed my name to Mohd Javed Alvi. 0071043630-1

I,SUNITA W/O NARESH KUMAR MAGO,R/o House No-G-1/234, 2nd Floor,Sector-16 Rohini, Delhi-110089,have changed my name to ISHA MAGO 0040862192-1

I JITENDER KUMAR MONGA S/O JANAK RAJ MONGA R/O - 74 B-BLOCK PREET VIHAR DELHI-110092 HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO JATINDER KUMAR MONGA 0040862095-1

I,Km.Usha Alies Usha,W/o-Arun Kumar,R/o-C-363,Street No.15,Bhajanpura, North-East Delhi-110053,have changed my name to Usha Rani for all purposes. 0040862186-1

I, MD Mukhtaar Ahmed S/O Jafeerul R/O 192, Preet Vihar freehold Sector-23, Sanjay Nagar, Ghaziabad, Kavi Nagar, Uttar Pradesh-201002, have changed my name to Mukhtar Ali. 0040862188-1

I Sabiya Bano W/o Md. Taslim R/o 146, T-Huts Cement Siding, Shakur Basti, Saraswati Vihar, North West, Delhi -110034 have changed my name to Savina Khatoon for all purposes. 0040862082-1

I,Ramesh Chandra,S/O-Shri Ram R/O-89,Ground floor,Indra Colony-1,Sector-52, Gurgaon,Haryana-122001,have changed my name to Ramesh Chander,for all future purposes. 0040862187-9

I, Shamim Ahmad C/o Zamir Ahmed, 12A/18G, Gali-No-11, Khasra No-306, Vijay Mohalla, Maujpur, Delhi-53 have changed my name to Shamim Ahmed. 0071043678-1

I,Lucky D/O Dharmendra R/O 1/3231,Ram Nagar Extention, Shahdara,Delhi-110032,have changed my name to Tejaswani for all purposes. 0040862192-11

I Chhotu Shahni S/o Raju Shahni R/o House No.- K20/146-E., Rajmandir, Varanasi, Uttar Pradesh - 221001, have changed my name to Aalok Shahni 0071043701-1

I,MONAL RAMESH DAGA,W/o-Pawan Birla,R/o-1/10942,St.No.7, Subhash-Park, Naveen Shahdara, Shahdara, Delhi-110032,have changed my name to NEELIMA BIRLA permanently. 0040862187-8

I Rachna Pandey w/o Avinash Tiwari r/o 102, Gali No.-22. Karan Vihar, Karnal, Haryana-132001 have changed my name as RACHNA. 0040862122-1

I, Ashok Kumar S/o Dayal Chand R/o,Flat-No-A-601, K.M.Apartment, Plot-No-12, Sector-12, Dwarka, South-West Delhi,Delhi-110078 have changed my-name to Ashok Kumar Khatreja. 0040862192-3

I, Rashmi Chauhan, W/o Rajesh Singh Chauhan, R/o ATS Greens Paradiso, Tower-9, Flat No. 09062, CHI IV, Greater Noida, GB Nagar, 201310, have changed my name from Rashmi Chauhan to Rashmi Berry. Henceforth I would be known by the name of Rashmi Berry for all future purposes. 0071043667-1

I,Anil Kumar,S/o-Indra Jeet Sharma,R/o-B-68,fatehpur beri,South Delhi-110074,Have changed my name to Anil sharma 0040862186-3

I, Ved Prakash Gupta, S/o Desh Bandhu Gupta R/o Tower 12/801, The Close North, Nirvana Country, Sector-50, Gurugram- 122018 hereby declare that Ved Gupta and Ved Prakash Gupta refer to one and the same person, namely myself. For future purposes I have changed my name to Ved Prakash Gupta. 0040862083-1

I, Essha Guptaa D/O Shri Rajat Gupta R/O D-277, Vivek Vihar, Delhi-110095, have changed my name to Esha Gupta for all purposes. 0040862188-3

I,MOHAMMAD ASAD,S/O-SALEEMUDDIN,R/O-6897,BERI WALA BAGH,AZAD MARKET,GALI MIYA SAHAB WALI,DELHI-110006,have changed my name to MOHD ASAD,for all,future Purposes. 0040862204-2

I Dinu Yadav S/o Astu Yadav R/o H. No - A - 55, Schoolpara 1 Mohlai, Gram-Mohlai, Tehsil-Kondagon, Distric-Kondagon,Chhattisgarh-494226, have changed my name to Ghinoo Ram Yadav 0071043710-1

I,Saliha Khatoon,W/o Salahuddin,R/o F-25 Shaheen Bagh,Jamia Nagar,New Delhi-110025,have changed my name to Saliha 0040862187-1

I,SATYAWAN S/o Dilip Singh R/o H.No.563, Khasra No.377/337,Post Office Mehrauli, Saidullajab, Delhi-110030,have changed my name to SATYAWAN SINGH permanently. 0040862187-10

I, Vishal Jain S/o Subash Jain,R/o-D-55-A, Chander Nagar,Ghaziabad-201011,have changed my minor son's name from Viyom Jain to Viyom Vishal Jain. 0040862096-1

I,MOHIT S/o Balvinder Kumar R/o-F-1/295 Sultanpuri,Sultanpuri F-Block,Delhi-110086 have changed my name to MOHIT SATTI for all purpose. 0040862192-5

I, Asif Mohammad S/o Mohd Arif R/o-01, Rawli Road, Kaila Mandi, Muradnagar, Ghaziabad have changed my name to Mohd Asif. 0071043635-1

I, ASHUTOSH KUMAR S/o Kailash Jha, B-401, Kenwood Tower, Charmwood Village, Eros Garden, Faridabad-121009 have changed my name to ASHUTOSH KUMAR JHA. 0071043679-1

I,Ajay Kumar,S/O-Pawan Kumar,R/O-701,Crystal Tower, Urbtech Xaviers, Sector-168, Noida,Chhaprauli Bangar,Gautam Budh Nagar,Uttar Pradesh-201305,Have Changed My Name to Ajay Kumar Sharma,for All,Future Purposes. 0040862186-5

I,Bibi Nasreen,W/o Mohammed Tasim Ahmed,R/o F-35,Shaheen Bagh,Jamia Nagar,New Delhi-110025,have changed my name to Laila Khalid 0040862187-3

I, Sumit Shivbihari Dubey, hereby declare that In my educational certificates and academic records, my mother's name has been recorded as Pushpa. My mother's full, correct, and legal name is Pushpa Shivbihari Dubey. The names Pushpa and Pushpa Shivbihari Dubey refer to one and the same person, who is my biological mother. My address is: C/o Shivbihari Dubey, A-102, Pocket-3, Kendriya Vihar-2,Noida PO:-Maharishi Nagar, Dist-Gautam Buddha Nagar, Uttar Pradesh-201304. 0071043611-1

It is for general information that I, Rajagopala Chellamani Srikanth son of Late RC Mani residing at Flat No.3-E-302,AWHO, Sector-Chi-1,Gurjinder Vihar,Greater Noida,Gautam Buddha Nagar (U.P.)-201315, declare that name of mine has been wrongly written as RC Srikanth in my service record.The actual name of mine is Rajagopala Chellamani Srikanth which may be amended accordingly. 0040862188-5

I, Pooja Nayyar D/o. Bharat Bhushan Nayyar Residing 1/36 , First Floor Ward No . 1, Mehrauli, New Delhi 110030, have Changed my Name from Pooja Nayyar To Upasana Nayyar for all future purposes. 0040862088-1

I Dharam Vir Singh Alias Dharam Vir S/o Nain Singh R/o 356, Gang Das Mohalla, Aya Nagar, South Delhi, Delhi-110047, have changed my name to Dharam Veer 0071043714-1

I,Meenal Bajaj W/o Gaurav Bajaj R/o A-82, Ramprastha, Chander Nagar, Ghaziabad, U.P.-201011, have changed my name to Meenal Arora. 0040862192-4

I,M K Saxena,S/o-H.C Saxena,R/o-B-226,Third-Floor,Front-Side,Flat-No.D-1,Chhattarpur Enclave,Phase-2,New Delhi-110074,have changed my name to Manoj Saxena. 0040862187-13

I, Vishal Jain S/o Subash Jain,R/o-D-55-A, Chander Nagar, Ghaziabad-201011,have changed my minor daughter's name from Manvi Jain to Manvvii Jain. 0040862096-3

I,Abdul Raza Mandageri, and my,wife Jhumur Dutta had our son's passport issued under the name KABIR.However, in all his current documents,his name is KABIR DUTTA.Therefore, a new passport may kindly be issued in this updated name KABIR DUTTA,S/o ABDUL RAZA MANDAGERI(Father) & JHUMUR DUTTA(Mother)R/o Sector-56,Gurugram, Haryana-122011 0040862192-7

I , Kaninghat krishna Kumar S/o Edathiparambil Sreedharan Nair R/o 97-B,Pocket - 6, MIG Flats, Mayur Vihar, Phase - 3, Delhi - 110096. Hereby declare that my name & my Father's name has been wrongly mentioned in Education Documents as K KRISHNA KUMAR & father's as E SREEDHARAN NAIR. It is clarified that Edathiparambil Sreedharan Nair is my father and in all records my name as Kaninghat krishna Kumar both names shall be treated as be-longing to the same individual for all purposes. 0040862157-1

I,Jitendra Aggarwal/Jitendra Kumar Agarwal,S/o-Umrao Lal Agarwal, R/o-E-291,Second Floor,Greater Kailash-1,Delhi,have changed my name to Jitender Agarwal,for all purposes. 0040862186-7

I,SHITANSHU,S/o Ram Sharan Tripathi,R/o-H.NO. B-244,S/F, Vivek Vihar, Phase-1,Delhi-110095,have changed my name to SITANSHU TRIPATHI for all future purposes 0040862187-5

I,Charanjit Kaur,W/o Inderjit Singh R/o 20/B/88AB ,1stFloor Tilak Nagar Delhi ,110018 Have Changed name to Charanjeet Kaur. 0040862186-9

I, Atul Gulati S/o Naresh Kumar Gulati, R/o 11113, ATS One Hamlet, Sector-104, Noida, Maharishi Nagar, Gautam Budh Nagar, UP-201304, have changed my name to ATUL GULATEE for all purposes. 0071043659-1

I,Ojaswini alias Ojaswini Kaushal, D/o Rajan Kaushal,R/o D-15/100,Sector-7,Rohini,Delhi-110085,have changed my name to Ojaswini Kaushal for all future purposes. 0040862184-2

I, Keshav Sharma S/o Sanjeev Sharma, R/o E-3/460, E-Block, Near Metro Station, Sector-18 Rohini, Rohini Sector 15, PO: Rohini Sector 15, North West Delhi-110089,have changed my name to Kanz, I have changed my name not my religion. 0071043755-1

I,Aseen S/o Sukhbir R/o-Harijan Basti, Ladrawan, Bahadurgarh Distt.Jhajjar(Haryana)-124507,have changed my name to Aseen Khan for all Purposes. 0040862192-10

I, Mohammad Arif S/o Mohd Ashfaq R/o-01, Rawli Road, Kaila Mandi, Muradnagar, Ghaziabad have changed my name to Mohd Arif. 0071043694-1

I,Priyanka Yadav,D/o-Dev Kumar Yadav,W/o-Naresh Kumar,R/o VPO-Salarpur, Bhiwadi,Alwar, (Rajasthan)-301018,have changed my name to Priyanka,for all,future Purposes. 0040862186-10

I,HEENA KHARBANDA,W/O-VIKAS KHARBANDA,R/O-HOUSE NO.-B-3/264 SECOND-FLOOR,PASCHIM-VIHAR DELHI-110063,have change my name,from HEENA KAPOOR to HEENA KHARBANDA,for all,future purposes. 0040862187-7

I, Mohammad Asif S/o Mohd Arif R/o-01, Rawli Road, Kaila Mandi, Muradnagar, Ghaziabad have changed my name to Mohd Asif. 0071043633-1

I, Mohammad Afaq S/o Mohd Haneef R/o 132, Mohalla Bansfodan, Najibabad, Bijnor, Uttar Pradesh-246763, have changed my name to MOHD AFAQ for all future purposes. 0071043662-1

I,SUSHMITHA,D/O-SAHENDRA SINGH YADAV,R/O-VILLAGE SANSERI POST OFFICE JONAICHA KHURD DISTT. ALWAR, RAJASTHAN-301706,CHANGED MY NAME TO KUMARI SUSHMITA YADAV. 0040862186-2

I, Nimijaa Gupta D/O Shri Rajat Gupta R/O D-277, Vivek Vihar, Delhi-110095, have changed my name to Nimija Gupta for all purposes. 0040862188-2

I SHEO PRATAP SINGH S/O SH. SHEO DAYAL SINGH KUSHWAH R/O 501A,INDRAPRASTHA VILLA APARTMENTS PLOT NO E-8A,SECTOR-61, NOIDA, DISTT. GAUTAM BUDH NAGAR,UP-201301 HAVE CHANGED MY NAME SHEO PRATAP SINGH FOR ALL FUTURE PURPOSES. 0040862084-1

I,MOHAMMAD ARSHAD,S/O-SALEEMUDDIN,R/O-6897,BERI WALA BAGH,AZAD MARKET,GALI MIYA SAHAB WALI,DELHI-110006,have changed my name to MOHD ARSHAD for all future Purposes. 0040862204-1

I, Bati W/o Naresh Chand, R/o CN-20, Rajapur Village, Rohini Sec-9, Delhi-110085, have changed my name from Bati to Bati Devi vide Affidavit dated 20.06.2026. 0130066122-1

I, Abhishek Singh S/o Bharat Singh R/o 89, Salkia School Road, Salkia, Haora(M.Corp), Howrah, West Bengal-711106, have changed my minor son's name from Aaryav Singh aged 11 years to Dhairyya Singh forever 0071043707-1

I,Rajmohan Singh/Raj Mohan Singh Bhasin/Raj Mohan Singh,S/O.Sujan Singh Bhasin,R/O.370-L,Model-Town,Dussehra Ground,Yamuna Nagar,Haryana- 135001,have changed my name to Rajmohan Singh Bhasin,for all,Purposes 0040862186-4

I,Raziya Begum,W/o Abdul Hakeem,R/o A-7/5 Shaheen Bagh,Jamia Nagar,New Delhi-110025,have changed my name to Salma 0040862187-2

I, Babita Gupta W/o Sh Sachin Saini, R/o 136/2/3/1, Cross Road, Batra Gali, Gambhir Flats, Sant Nagar, Burari. Near Shiv Choudhary Dairy. Delhi- 110084, declare that I have changed my name from Babita Gupta to Babita for all future purposes. 0071043602-1

I, RRajat Gupta S/O Shri Bal Ram Gupta R/O D-277, Vivek Vihar, Delhi-110095, have changed my name to Rajat Gupta for all purposes. 0040862188-4

I, Narendra Kumar Sharma S/o Ranveer R/o Vard 9, Gaon Bharuhiya, Sirmour, Rewa, Madhya Pradesh - 486445, have changed my minor daughter's name from Ruvi aged 16 years to Roobi Sharma forever 0071043712-1

LOST & FOUND

I, Sunny Wadhwa, S/o Pritam Lal Wadhwa R/o House No-670, Sector-12, Part-2, Sonipat, Haryana, I have lost my property documents as allotment letter and possession letter. and allotment No 257, Possession date is 09-06-2012. property address is D-111, Grahlaxmi Sahakari Awas Samiti Limited (Celestial Palace) Sector Pi Greater Noida G.B. Nagar U.P. Please return if anyone found 0071043684-1

I, simran W/o Mohd tasleem R/o 349 UGF Gagan Vihar Krishna Nagar Delhi 110051 have lost my possession letter of my plot.No. C-22 housing sector C-2, TDS City Loni Ghaziabad UP if any found it contact above. 0071043622-1

PUBLIC NOTICE

पब्लिक नोटिस

मेरे मुवक्किल, **[illegible]**, पुत्र स्वर्गीय सरदार [illegible] सिंह, निवासी T-29, F-10/2, Gali No. 20, Bhil Basti, Baljeet Nagar, New Delhi-110008 ने मुझे अधिकृत करते हुए उक्त सार्वजनिक सूचना सर्वसाधारण को सूचित करने हेतु कहा है। जैसा कि मेरे मुवक्किल ने मुझे बताया है कि वह निम्नलिखित संपत्ति के वैध एवं एकमात्र स्वामी है: **संपत्ति संख्या T-29, F-10/2, Gali No. 20, Bhil Basti, Baljeet Nagar, New Delhi-110008** उक्त संपत्ति से संबंधित मूल दस्तावेज कहीं गुम हो गये हैं। काफी खोजबीन करने के बावजूद उक्त दस्तावेज प्राप्त नहीं हो सके हैं। उक्त संपत्ति से संबंधित मूल दस्तावेज मेरे मुवक्किल से घर बदलने के दौरान गुम/खो गये हैं। उक्त दस्तावेजों के गुम होने के संबंध में आवश्यक सूचना संबंधित **LR No. 389976/2026, Dated 22.06.2026** पुलिस विभाग को दे दी गई है। उक्त संपत्ति के विषय में यदि किसी व्यक्ति को कोई आपत्ति हो तो वह इस नोटिस के प्रकाशन की तिथि से 7 दिनों के भीतर मेरे मुवक्किल को सूचित करे। अन्यथा मेरे मुवक्किल को उक्त संपत्ति के संबंध में कागजात दस्तावेज अपने नाम अथवा अपनी इच्छा अनुसार किसी अन्य व्यक्ति के नाम निष्पादित/तैयार कराने का पूर्ण अधिकार होगा। **Shashi Ranjan** (Advocate) Ch.No.609, Patiala House Court, Delhi-01.

PUBLIC NOTICE

Be it known to the General Public that my clients Sh. Ajay Kumar son of Sh. Sohan Pal and his wife Smt. Suman Devi, both residents of B-813, Gautampuri, Badarpur, New Delhi-110044 have severed all their relations with their son Rohit Kumar and his wife Jyoti and their children resident of B-813, Gautampuri, Badarpur, New Delhi-110044 because of their misbehavior, have been disinherited/ debarred from all their movable and immovable properties. Anybody dealing with the above persons shall do so at his/their own risk and responsibility.

Sd/-
B.S. RANDHAWA (Advocate)
Ch. No.983-984 Patiala House Courts
New Delhi-110001

PUBLIC NOTICE

General Public is hereby informed that Mr. DAVINDER PAL SINGH S/o Shri Avtar Singh R/o C2/137,Second Floor, Janakpuri New Delhi- 110058, SMT. CHARANJIT KAUR W/o Shri Jasvinder Singh R/o WZ-256, Upper Ground Floor, Gali No. 14, Shiv Nagar, New Delhi, SMT. KULPREET KAUR W/o Shri Varinder Bedi R/o WZ-61, First Floor, Gali No.3, Shiv Nagar, New Delhi-110058, SMT. SANDEEP KAUR W/o Shri Swaran Singh H-362, Vikas Puri, Tilak Nagar,Delhi-110018, SMT. ANITA SABHARWAL W/o Shri Vikas Sabharwal B-40A/1, Naraina Vihar, Delhi-110028 have entered into an agreement to sell for purchase of a plot no. M-113, Vikas Puri, Delhi-110018 measuring area 104 Sq. Mtr. with MS. SHWETA KATHURIA D/o Shri Raj Kamal Kathuria R/o M-113, Vikas Puri, New Delhi 110 018, SMT. NEHA VYAS W/o Shri Puneet Vyas R/o F-14Y, F-Block, DDA Flat, Jahangir Puri, Shanjar Pur, NS Mandi, Delhi-110033. Both Ms. Shweta Kathuria and Mrs. Neha Vyas are only legal heirs of Late Shri Raj Kamal Kathuria who was the owner of the said property. My client has come to know that Ms. Shweta Kathuria and Mrs.Neha Vyas are trying to sell / alienate/create third party interest or enter into an agreement to sell with some third person in relation to the said property/ plot. Any person dealing with Ms. Shweta Kathuria and Mrs. Neha Vyas W/o Shri Puneet Vyas or any of their representative in respect of the said property/ plot for which Ms. Shweta Kathuria and Mrs. Neha Vyas have entered into an agreement to sell with my clients and have received huge amount as earnest money and advance payment, in whatsoever manner to the detriment to my clients rights, shall be doing so at his/her own risk, cost and consequences.

Sd/- Jagjit Singh Sahni , Advocate
Ch. No.421, Lawyers Chambers, Western Wing, Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi-110054

PUBLIC NOTICE

NOTICE IS HEREBY GIVEN to the general public that my client(s), is/are intending to purchase the immovable property described in the Schedule below from **SMT. RAVINDER KAUR W/O SH. BALJIT SINGH R/O WZ-79A, GALI NO. 8, KRISHNA PARK, TILAK NAGAR, NEW DELHI-110018** Any person(s), bank, financial institution, or entity having or claiming any right, title, interest, ownership, share, lien, charge, mortgage, lease, tenancy, easement, or demand of any nature whatsoever in, to, or upon the said property, or any part thereof, through inheritance, gift, sale, or otherwise, is hereby required to make the same known in writing with supportive documentary evidence to the undersigned at the address given below.

Objections or claims must be submitted within 15 days from the date of publication of this notice. If no valid claims or objections are received within the stipulated period, my client will proceed to complete the sale transaction of the said property, and no claims of any nature will be entertained thereafter. Any such claims will be considered waived.

SCHEDULE OF PROPERTY
LIG Flat No. A2A-237, JANAKPURI, NEW DELHI-110058

PIYUSH JAIN (ADVOCATE)
ADD- C4E-341, JANAKPURI
NEW DELHI-110058
CONTACT- +91 9650337788
EMAIL- advocatepiyushjain@gmail.com
Date: 20.06.2026
Place: NEW DELHI

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PUBLIC NOTICE

NOTICE IS HEREBY GIVEN to the general public that my client Ms: Geeta D/o. Mr. Tulsi Dass, is intending to purchase the immovable property described in the Schedule below from Smt. Ravinder Kaur W/O Sh. Baljit Singh, R/o. WZ-79A, Gali No. 6, Krishna Park, Tilak Nagar, New Delhi-110018, Any person(s), bank, financial institution, or entity having or claiming any right, title, interest, ownership, share, lien, charge, mortgage, lease, tenancy, easement, or demand of any nature whatsoever in, to, or upon the said property, or any part thereof, through inheritance, gift, sale, or otherwise, is hereby required to make the same known in writing with supportive documentary evidence to the undersigned at the address given below. Objections or claims must be submitted within 15 days from the date of publication of this notice. On my email: advocatesanjaymann@gmail.com or WhatsApp No. 9810758412. If no valid claims or objections are received within the stipulated period, my client will proceed to complete the sale transaction of the said property, and no claims of any nature will be entertained thereafter. Any such claims will beconsidered waived.

Sd/-
SANJAY KUMAR
Advocate
Ch. No. C-10, C.L. Joseph,
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi-110054

NORTH WESTERN RAILWAY
Open Tender through E-Tendering

CWM/Carriage & Wagon workshop North western railway Bikaner acting for and on behalf of the president of India invites E-Tender No. 07-MECH-BKNW-BOXNHL-26. **Name of work and its location:** Rehabilitation of BOXNHL Wagons as per scope of work at C & W Workshop, NWR, Bikaner. **Estimated Cost of work:** Rs. 3,74,61,294.00 (Inclusive of GST). **Earnest money:** Rs. 7,49,200.00. **Last Date and time for submission and opening of E-tender:** 14.07.2026 at 14:30 Hrs. E-Tender will be opened at 15:00 Hrs. on same day. **Website particular where complete details of e-tender can be seen:** www.ireps.gov.in 905-MG/26

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EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY
E- TENDER NOTICE
(Pt. Deen Dayal Upadhaya Division)

E-TENDER NOTICE NO: SG-DSE-T-OT-04-26 1.Name of work with its location: Provision of CCTV Cameras at Non-Interlocked Manned LC Gates at different locations over DDU division. **2. Approx. Cost of the work:** Rs. 4,86,43,985.53/- (Four Crores Eighty Six Lakh Forty Three Thousand Nine Hundred Eighty Five and Paisa Fifty three only). **3. Earnest Money:** Rs. 9,72,900 (Nine Lakh Seventy Two Thousand Nine Hundred only). **4.Closing date & time for Submission of e-tendering:** 13-07-2026 up to 12.30 Hrs. **5.Website particulars where complete details of tender can be seen etc: www.ireps.gov.in**

Divnl. Signal & Telecom Engineer
East Central railway, DDU
PR/0440/DDU/S&T/T/26-27/28

NORTH WESTERN RAILWAY
E-Tender Notice

No. EL/118/16-2026-27/W6/TF Dt. 23.06.2026. DRM (Electrical) Jaipur, for and on the behalf of president of Union of India, invites e-tenders for following works: **S.No.: 1. NIT No.:** EL-JP-16-2026-27. **Name of work:** Electrical work in connection with [1] Provision of additional PF Shelter at AWR, RHG, KRH, BU, MKH, PSL, HIS, AIA, GLNA, KNAR, MJNL & SRRG, [2] Provision of additional PF Shelter at BKI, DO, ARNA, BAK, JW, JHIR & KUT, [3] Provision of RCC over head tanks with capacity 2.25 lakhs litres each at Bandikui (02 nos.), Phulera (01 no.), Sanganer(01 no.) in JP Division, [4] Replacement of (MLB) by Provision of Electric Lifting Barriers (ELB) at 13 manned level crossing gates in Jaipur Division. **NIT Cost:** Rs. 13340239.26. **Earnest Money:** Rs. 266800.00. **Tender opening:** 17/07/2026. **Note:- Date & time of closing of e-tenders:** On tender opening date Upto 15.00 hours. **Date & time of e-tender opening:** On tender opening date after 15.00 hours. **Complete details of tender can be seen on website No.: http://www.ireps.gov.in.** **908-MG/26**

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CHITTARANJAN LOCOMOTIVE WORKS
E-TENDER NOTICE

Tender Notice No.: PCMM/CLW/HWH/E-Procurement/26/25, Dated: 19/06/2026. PCMM/CLW/HWH on behalf of the President of India invites electronic bids from established reliable manufacturer for supply of the followings. The following E-Tender/s is for supply of materials for manufacture of Electric Locomotive. The Prospective/ likely suppliers are requested to look up the website **www.ireps.gov.in** for detailed instructions**.** These are E-Tenders only electronic offer bids shall be accepted. **Sl. No.; Tender No.; Description of Stores; Quantity; Due On; Tender Cost** are as follows : **[086]; 14262674;** Set of Blower Gasket To Drg./Spec. No. CLW/ES/3/0457/F (Set Detail Attached); As Per Tender/ Document; **24/07/2026;** ₹ 0.00. **[087]; 14262620B;** Spring Loaded Switch -1 To Drg./ Spec. No. CLW/ES/3/0032/H; As Per Tender/ Document; **27/07/2026;** ₹ 0.00. **[088]; 14262610;** Crew Fan To Drg./Spec. No. CLW/ ES/3/0110/E; As Per Tender/Document; **30/07/2026;** ₹ 0.00. **[089]; 14262979;** LED Based Flasher Light To Drg./Spec. No. (i) ELRS/ SPEC/LFL/0017 (Rev.1, Sept.2004) & (ii) CLW/ES/SK-3/L-21/C; As Per Tender/ Document; **03/08/2026;** ₹ 0.00. **[090]; 14262505;** Primary Voltage Transformer To Drg./Spec. No. CLW/ES/3/0009/C; As Per Tender/Document; **31/07/2026;** ₹ 0.00. **[091]; 14262652;** Set Of Non-Metallic Pipe (Smoke Detector Pipe) To Drg./Spec. No. CLW/ES/ 3/0254/E (Set Detail Attached); As Per Tender/ Document; **10/08/2026;** ₹ 0.00. **[092]; 31261174A;** Pressure Sensor Oil Circuit Transformer As Per Specification No. CLW/ ES/3/0035/H; As Per Tender/Document; **20/07/2026;** ₹ 0.00.

PR2/394 **PCMM/CLW/Howrah**
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कार्यालय परियोजना प्रबन्धक, यूनिट-49 कन्सट्रक्शन एण्ड डिजाइन सर्विसेज, उत्तर प्रदेश जल निगम (नगरीय), (उ०प्र० सरकार का उपक्रम) ई-6, प्रियदर्शनी नगर, निकट बी०डी०ए० ऑफिस, बरेली - 243122

निविदा सूचना सं०- 948/कार्य-15/229
दिनांक: 22/06/2026

ई-निविदा सूचना

उत्तर प्रदेश जल निगम की ओर से जनपद बरेली में मण्डलीय संयुक्त निदेशक (प्रशि०/शिक्षु०) के नवीन कार्यालय भवन का निर्माण कार्य, अनुमानित लागत रू० 118.55 लाख (जी०एस०टी० रहित एवं लेबर सेस सहित) हेतु सी०एण्ड डी०एस० में यथोचित श्रेणी में पंजीकृत ठेकेदारों से दिनांक 13.07.2026 को 15.00 बजे तक ई-निविदाएं आमन्त्रित की जाती हैं। उक्त कार्य हेतु ई-निविदा प्रपत्र दिनांक 23.06.2026 से दिनांक 13.07.2026 को 15.00 बजे के मध्य उत्तर प्रदेश सरकार की e-procurement वेबसाइट https://etender.up.nic.in से डाउनलोड किये जा सकते है तथा ई-निविदा दिनांक 14.07.2026 को 17:00 बजे सी०एण्ड डी०एस० यूनिट 49, उ०प्र० जल निगम (नगरीय) बरेली में निविदा खोली जायेगी। ई-निविदा प्रपत्र का मूल्य रू० 10000.00+ GST (18%) अतिरिक्त देय होगा।

निविदा से सम्बन्धित विस्तृत विवरण विभाग की बेवसाइट www.cdsupjn.org एवं प्रोक्योमेन्ट पोर्टल https://etender.up.nic.in पर उपलब्ध है। समस्त शुद्धि पत्र (Corrigendum) https://etender.up.nic.in पर ही अपलोड किये जायेंगे, **इनका पृथक से कोई प्रकाशन नहीं किया जायेगा।** निविदादाताओं को सलाह दी जाती है कि वे उक्त वेबसाईट का समय-समय पर अवलोकन करते रहें।

Rajasthan State Road Development And Construction Corporation Ltd., JAIPUR

निविदा सूचना/2026-27

निम्नलिखित कार्य के लिए केन्द्र/राज्य सरकार के अभियांत्रिकी विभागों एवं उनके अधिकृत संगठनों में पंजीकृत एवं अनुभवी संवेदकों से निर्धारित प्रपत्र में ई-प्रोक्यूरमेन्ट प्रक्रिया हेतु ऑनलाइन निविदायें आमंत्रित की जाती है

कार्य का विवरण	कार्य की कुल अनुमानित लागत (रू०)	निविदा सूचना संख्या
Widening (7 to 10 Meter) of Shahpura to Ajeetgarh BOT Road. **UBN: RRC2627WLOB00293**	2179.46 Lakh	**अल्पकालीन** ई-175/26-27
Construction of Integrated College of Yoga, Ayurved & Naturpoathy at Bikaner. **UBN: RRC2627WLOB00296**	2000.54 Lakh	ई-179/26-27

निविदा से सम्बन्धित प्रपत्र में निविदा शुल्क, धरोहर राशि, डाउनलोड करने व खोलने की तारीख सहित सम्पूर्ण विवरण एवं संशोधन वेबसाईटः http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in, http://sppp.rajasthan.nic.in तथा http://pwd.rajasthan.gov.in/rsrdc पर देखा जा सकता है। इच्छुक संवेदकों को अपने डिजिटल हस्ताक्षर के माध्यम से वेबसाईट http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in पर रजिस्टर्ड करवाना आवश्यक है। **महाप्रबंधक**

No. NIT/2026-27/3596.3607 **Date:22.06.2026**

CENTRE FOR DEVELOPMENT OF TELEMATICS

सी-डॉट C-DOT

Advt. No. C-DOTD/ADMIN/2026/01 **Date: 24 June 2026**

NOTICE FOR THE ENGAGEMENT OF VISITING MEDICAL CONSULTANT AT C-DOT

Applications are invited for engagement of a visiting Medical Consultant at C-DOT Delhi Office on contractual basis

S. No	Name of Post	Mode	Remuneration	Qualification & Experience	Location
1.	Visiting Medical Consultant	On Contractual Basis	INR 4,000/- per visit	MBBS with MD/MS from a recognized institution, valid NMC/State Medical Council registration, and minimum 10 years of clinical experience	Delhi

The consultant will be required to visit C-DOT Campus at Mehrauli, New Delhi for two hours daily on working days. The contract will initially be for two years, extendable based on satisfactory performance and mutual consent. Preference will be given to doctors associated with reputed hospitals/clinics in Delhi/NCR.

Interested Doctors are requested to submit their CV along with copies of MBBS and MD/MS degree certificates at the email ID: **admin.del@cdot.in**.

CBC-06268/12/0006/2527

JHARKHANDBIJLI VITRANNIGAMLIMITED
(CIN:U40108JH2013SGC001702)
Regd.Office– Room No. 202, 2nd Floor, Engineering Building, Dhurwa, Ranchi-834004
FaxNo.–(0651)–2400799(E-mail–accounts.compilation@jbvnl.co.in)

Time Extension Notice (EOI Notice No. 158/PR/JBVNL/2026-27)

Due to unavoidable circumstances dates of **EOI Notice No. 158/PR/JBVNL/2026-27** dated **18.06.2026** has been extended as below: -

Sl. No.	Particulars	Revised Date & Time
i	Date of Publication of EOI	18.06.2026
ii	Date of Downloading	25.06.2026 from 10:00 AM
iii	Last Date/Time of Receipt of EOI	14.07.2026 up to 03:00 PM
iv	Date & Time for Opening of Technical Bid	15.07.2026 at 03:00 PM
v	Opening of Financial Bid	To be Intimated after technical evaluation

All prospective bidders are requested to take note of the above revision. The extension shall form an integral part of the EOI document.

PR No. 382593

स्वहित एवं राष्ट्रहित में ऊर्जा बचावें। कृपया अपनी शिकायतों को 18003456570(कॉल सेन्टर) पर दर्ज करायें।

Sd/-
General Manager (A&R)
JBVNL

PR.NO.383085 Jharkhand Bijlee Vitran Nigam Ltd(26-27):D

Government of Jharkhand
Commercial Taxes Department

Corrigendum

Ref. Bid No. GeM/2026/B/7641208 Dated: 11-06-2026

Corrigendum with reference to Re-Tender for "Selection of an agency for IT Operation, Maintenance & Up-gradation of Jharkhand VAT Applications and GST State Operations" for the Dept. of Commercial Taxes, Govt. of Jharkhand.

The details of Corrigendum with reference to Bid No. GeM/2026/B/7641208 dated 11-06-2026 can be downloaded from the website- gem.gov.in and ctax.jharkhand.gov.in. The important dates related to this bid is hereby revised as below :-

Last date for Bid Submission	06-07-2026 at 5.00 PM
Bid Opening Date/Time	06-07-2026 at 5.30 PM
Technical Presentation Date	14-07-2026 at 1.00 PM
EMD Detail	55 lakh INR (with Validity of minimum 180 days through Electronic Bank Guarantee.)

Sd/-
Additional Commissioner,
Department of Commercial Taxes,
Jharkhand, Ranchi.

PR 383091 Commercial Taxes(26-27)#D

GUJARAT URJA VIKAS NIGAM LTD

GUVNL

CIN U40109GJ2004SGC045195
ISO 9001:2015 Certified Company
Sardar Patel Vidyut Bhavan, Racecourse, Vadodara 390007
PBX: (0265) 2310582-86, www.guvnl.com

NOTICE INVITING TENDER

Tender Search Code on ISN-ETS: GUVNL-2026-TN000002

GUVNL invites tenders for setting up of 450 MW / 900 MWh Standalone Battery Energy Storage Systems in Gujarat under Tariff-Based Competitive Bidding with Viability Gap Funding supported through PSDF (Phase-IX) followed by e-reverse auction. For tender documents, please visit the website **www.bharat-electronictender.com** and **www.guvnl.com**. The last date of online bid submission is **13-Jul-2026**.

General Manager (Power Trading)

Department of Horticulture
Potato Technology Centre
Shamgarh, Karnal

Hi-Tech Potato Cultivation पर प्रशिक्षण कार्यक्रम के लिये आवेदन आमंत्रित

सूचना

सर्वसाधारण को सूचित किया जाता है कि आलू प्रौद्योगिकी केन्द्र, शामगढ, जिला करनाल, हरियाणा में वर्ष 2026-27 में आलू फसल से संबंधित निम्नलिखित प्रशिक्षण करवाया जाना है :

S.No.	Period	Duration	No. of Participants	Date of Advertisement	Final list of Participants for traning	Topic
1	20.07.2026 to 24.07.2026	5 Days	20	24.06.2026	20.07.2026	High-tech Pototo Cultivation
2	17.08.2026 to 21.08.2026	5 Days	20		17.08.2026	High-tech Pototo Cultivation
3	14.09.2026 to 18.09.2026	5 Days	20		14.09.2026	High-tech Pototo Cultivation
4	12.10.2026 to 16.10.2026	5 Days	20		12.10.2026	High-tech Pototo Cultivation
5	16.11.2026 to 20.11.2026	5 Days	20		16.11.2026	High-tech Pototo Cultivation

हरियाणा राज्य के सभी जिलों के किसान दिनांक 25.06.2026 को प्रातः 11:00 बजे से उद्यान विभाग की वैबसाइट **kaushal.hortharyana.gov.in** के माध्यम से उक्त प्रशिक्षण हेतु आनलाइन आवेदन कर सकते हैं। प्रशिक्षार्थियों का चयन पहले आओ, पहले पाओ के आधार पर किया जायेगा। किसानों के रहने व खाने का प्रबंध उद्यान विभाग, हरियाणा द्वारा किया जायेगा। आवेदनकर्ता अपने जरूरी कागजात जैसे कि आधार कार्ड, परिवार पहचान पत्र और पैन कार्ड की फोटो प्रति प्रशिक्षण के दौरान प्रथम दिन अपने साथ लेकर आयें।

अधिक जानकारी के लिये केन्द्र की ईमेल आई.डी. pteshamgarh@gmail.com पर मेल करें अथवा आवेदक मो० नं० 7988318067 पर किसी भी कार्यदिवस में संपर्क कर सकते हैं।

नोटः- प्रशासनिक कार्यों से प्रशिक्षण की अवधि को आगे बढाया जा सकता है।

उपनिदेशक उद्यान
आलू प्रौद्योगिकी केन्द्र, शामगढ, करनाल।

No.46478/HR

UJVN Ltd.
(An Uttarakhand Govt. Enterprises)
H.O. "UJJWAL" Maharani Bagh, GMS Road, Dehradun-248006
Telephone-0135-2763808 Fax: 0135-2763508
CIN No. U40101UR2001SGC025866 Website: www.ujvnl.com

RO No. 525 **TENDER NOTICE** Date: 22.06.2026

Office of the Executive Engineer (Civil) Maneri Bhali Stage – Ist Maneri, Uttarkashi invites sealed tenders from interested parties. Brief summary of tender are given below:

NIT No : 03 & 04/EE(Civil)/MB-I/TN/2026-27

Name of Works : (1) Civil Maintenance & repair of various types of residences at Kuteti Devi Colony, Uttarkashi & (2) Annual Operation & Maintenance of Gauge and Discharge Site at Heena, Uttarkashi.

Estimated cost : (1) Rs. 24.97 Lac (GST Extra), & (2) Rs. 12.71 Lac (GST Extra)

Date of availability of bid document on website : 23-06-2026 from 17:00 hrs

Last Date for submission of bids : 15-07-2026 upto 11.00 hrs

For fuller & further details, kindly visit our website. The tender documents can be downloaded from Nigam's website **www.ujvnl.com**

Executive Engineer (Civil) MB-I, Maneri

"AVOID WASTEFUL USE OF ELECTRICITY"

NORTHERN RAILWAY
OPEN-E-TENDER NOTICE

The Sr. Divisional Engineer-III, Northern Railway, Delhi Division invites E-Tender for the following work.

Name of work	Annual Zone for P.E. 30.06.2027 for repair to service building, station building ANVT and other structure in the section of SSE/W/ANVT under ADEN/NDLS.		
Approx cost of work	₹1,24,99,094.79/- (Rupees One Crore Twenty Four Lakh Ninety Nine Thousand Ninety Four and Seventy Nine Paise Only)		
Earnest Money to deposited	₹2,50,000.00/- (Rupees Two Lakh Fifty Thousand Only)	**Cost of tender document**	₹0.00/-
Date & Time of submission of tender bid and opening of tender.			22.07.2026 @ 15:00 Hrs.
Website particulars where complete details of tender documents can be seen.			www.ireps.gov.in

•The tenderer/s must be registered on the Indian Railway E-Procurement system (IREPS) site i.e. **www.ireps.gov.in** for participating in the e-tender system. •For all terms and conditions please refer tender document. •No manual offers are acceptable. •Cost of tender document and Earnest money will be acceptable through net banking or payment gateway only

No.: 128-W/280/e Tender Notice/NIT/29/2026-27/W-3 Dated: 22.06.2026

SERVING CUSTOMER WITH A SMILE 2158/2026

कार्यालय परियोजना प्रबन्धक, यूनिट-09
कन्स्ट्रक्शन एण्ड डिजाइन सर्विसेज
उत्तर प्रदेश जल निगम (नगरीय)
2-शंकरनगर (नियर संदीप गैस एजेन्सी)
दिल्ली रोड, सहारनपुर.फोन 0132-3580995
ई-मेल: pmu9cds@gmail.com
प्रधान कार्यालय: टी.सी.-38वी, विभूति खण्ड,गोमती नगर, लखनऊ-226010

NIT No. : 1218/ E-Tender/ 139
Date : 22.06.2026

अति अल्पकालीन ई-निविदा सूचना

उत्तर प्रदेश जल निगम (नगरीय) की ओर से अधोहस्ताक्षरी द्वारा जनपद-सहारनपुर में मण्डलीय संयुक्त निदेशक प्रशि0/शिक्षु के नवीन कार्यालय भवन का निर्माण कार्य, अनुमानित लागत रु0 118.54 लाख (लेबर सेस सहित एवं जी0एस0टी0 रहित) हेतु दिनांक 01.07.2026 अपरान्ह 05:00 बजे तक ई-निविदा आमन्त्रित की जाती हैं। उक्त कार्य हेतु ई-निविदा प्रपत्र दिनांक 23.06.2026 से दिनांक 01.07.2026 की अपरान्ह 05:00 बजे के मध्य उत्तर प्रदेश सरकार की e-procurement वेबसाइट https://etender.up.nic.in से डाउनलोड किये जा सकते हैं तथा ई-निविदा दिनांक 02.07.2026 को अपरान्ह 01:30 बजे कार्यालय परियोजना प्रबन्धक यूनिट-09, सी0एण्ड डी0एस0, उ0प्र0 जल निगम (नगरीय), सहारनपुर में खोली जायेंगी। ई-निविदा प्रपत्र का मूल्य रु011800.00 (रु0 10000.00+GST (18%) अतिरिक्त) देय होगा। निविदा से सम्बन्धित विस्तृत विवरण विभाग की वेबसाइट www.cdsupjn.org एवं प्रोक्योरमेन्ट पोर्टल https://etender.up.nic.in पर उपलब्ध है। समस्त शुद्धिपत्र (Corrigendum) https://etender.up.nic.in पर ही अपलोड किये जायेंगे, इनका पृथक से कोई प्रकाशन नहीं किया जायेगा। निविदादाताओं को सलाह दी जाती है कि वे उक्त वेबसाइट का समय-समय पर अवलोकन करते रहें।

NORTH WESTERN RAILWAY

E-Tender Notice

E- Tender Notice No. **SNT-GS-BKN-2025-26-04R2.** Chief Project Manager, Gati Shakti, N.W.Rly. Bikaner for and on behalf of President of India invites open E-Tender for the following works up to 15:00 Hrs on 17/07/2026 as below:- **S.N.:** 1. **Tender No.:** SNT-GSBKN2025-2604R2. **Name of Work with its Location**: Augmentation of facilities of Goods Shed alongwith the provision of CCTV at Kolayat station of Bikaner Division. **Approx. Cost of Work:** Rs. 5896926.16. **Bid Security Amount (in Rs.):** Rs. 117900.00. **Date and Time for submission of tender & opening of tender:** Bidding start date on 03/07/2026 & Tender closing Date & time up to 15:00 Hrs on 17/07/2026. **Note: Other terms & conditions will be shown on the website** www.ireps.gov.in. 904-MG/26

Follow us on : /NWRailways NWRailways_

NORTH EASTERN RAILWAY

Dy. Chief Electrical Engineer, Mechanical Workshop, N.E. Railway, Gorakhpur for & behalf of President of India invites "OPEN" E-Tender through online (e-tendering) for the following work.
Tender No. & Description of Work: EL-MWS-GKP-2026-27-06, Provision of Lighting Arrangement & Other Miscellaneous Electrification Works in Rail Museum, Gorakhpur. Approx Value: ₹45,56,889.55/-, E.M.D. Money: ₹91,100/-, Cost of Tender document: 0.00, Completion time/period from the date of issue of acceptance letter -2 Months
E-tender online will be submitted up to 11:00 Hrs on dated 15.07.2026. For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railway IREPS official website **www.ireps.gov.in.**

Dy. Chief Electrical Engineer (WS)
CPRO/EL-76 Gorakhpur

Never travel on roof and foot boards.

Corrigendum

No.VBD/Nuh/26/199 Dated:-22.06.2026

Advertisement No. VBD/NUH/2026/197 दिनांक 11.06.2026 के संदर्भ में सर्वसाधारण को सूचित किया जाता है कि स्वास्थ्य विभाग जिला नूंह के अंतर्गत कार्यालय सिविल सर्जन नूंह एट मांण्डीखेड़ा में मलेरिया के तहत निकाले गये ब्रीडिंग चैकर के पदों को भरने की अंतिम तिथि 15.06.2026 रखी गई थी लेकिन प्रशासनिक कारणों से उनहित को देखते हुए इन पदों की अंतिम तिथि 26.06.2026 सांय 4 बजे तक सुनिश्चित कि गई है। अन्य नियम व शर्तें पूर्ववत: रहेंगी।

Sd/-
Dy. Civil Surgeon
No. 46460/HRY **Nuh at Mandikhera**

BPS GMC FOR WOMEN, KHANPUR KALAN, SONIPAT

सर्व साधारण को सूचित किया जाता है कि भगत फूल सिंह महिला मैडिकल कॉलेज खानपुर कलाँ सोनीपत में Old answer seat, old patient admission file, old Practical file, Cardboards Cartons, old News paper को नीलाम करने के लिये खुली नीलामी दिनांक 02.07.2026 को 11.00 AM बजे की जाएगी। नियम व शर्ते महाविद्यालय की वेबसाईड **www.bpsgmckhanpur.ac.in** पर देखी जा सकती है।

Sd/-
Incharge Purchase
BPS GMC for Women,
No.46482/HR **Khanpur Kalan, Sonepat**

HARYANA REAL ESTATE REGULATORY AUTHORITY

New Mini Secretariat, 2nd Floor, Sector-1, Panchkula.
E-mail: hrerapkl-hry@gov.in, officer.rera.hry@gmail.com
Website: www.haryanarera.gov.in

PUBLIC NOTICE

It is hereby brought to the notice of the general public, homebuyers, investors, and all concerned persons that Aerens Jai Realty is presently developing a residential plotted colony on land measuring 53.9 acres in Sector-22 & 24, Yamunanagar. However, the said colony is being developed without a RERA Registration.

As per Section 3 of the Real Estate (Regulation and Development) Act, 2016, no promoter shall advertise, market, book, sell, or offer for sale any plot, apartment, or building in a real estate project without obtaining registration from the Real Estate Regulatory Authority.

Therefore, the general public is hereby cautioned:

- Not to book, purchase, invest in, or make any payment for any plot or unit in the project being developed on land measuring 53.9 acres in Sector-22 & 24, Yamunanagar by Aerens Jai Realty.
- Any transaction made in violation of the above provisions shall be at the sole risk, cost, and consequences of the purchaser and the Authority shall not be responsible for any loss or dispute arising therefrom.

This public notice is issued in the interest of the general public to prevent fraudulent or illegal real estate transactions and to ensure compliance with the provisions of the Real Estate (Regulation and Development) Act, 2016. For verification of registered projects, the general public is advised to visit the official website of Haryana Real Estate Regulatory Authority (HRERA) Panchkula

Executive Director,
No. 46459/HRY **HRERA Panchkula**

MISSION DIRECTOR, NATIONAL HEALTH MISSION, J&K

Jammu Office: Regional Institute of Health & Family Welfare, Nagrota, Jammu - 181221 Fax: 0191-2674114; Telephone: 2674244;
e-mail: mdnhm-jk@jk.gov.in
Kashmir Office: Block 'A', Ground Floor, Old Secretariat, Srinagar Pin: 190001
Fax: 0194-2470486; 2477309; Telephone: 2477337;
e-mail: mdnhm-jk@jk.gov.in

Toll Free Integrated Centralized Call Centre cum Health Helpline No.: 104

Notice Inviting Online Bids for engagement of agency for management of existing manpower, and supply of new manpower on 'as & when required' basis, for Data Entry Operations and as Support Staff under NHM at various Administrative Offices/ Healthcare Facilities of Health & Medical Education Department in J&K

State Health Society, NHM, J&K invites online bids from reputed firms/service providers for engagement of suitable agency for management of existing manpower, and supply of new manpower on 'as & when required' basis, for Data Entry Operations and as Support Staff under NHM at various administrative offices/ healthcare facilities of Health & Medical Education Department in J&K, as per detailed Scope of Services and Terms & Conditions mentioned in the Standard Bid Document (SBD)::

S. No.	Particulars	Date/Time
1	Date of Publishing SBD	24-06-2026 at 1000 Hrs
2	Start Date of Downloading SBD from Website	24-06-2026 at 1000 Hrs
3	Websites for Downloading SBD	https://jktenders.gov.in, https://jknhm.jk.gov.in
4	Last Date of Downloading SBD from Website	15-07-2026 upto 1400 Hrs
5	Seek Clarification Start Date	24-06-2026 from 1000 Hrs
6	Seek Clarification End Date	04-07-2026 upto 1600 Hrs
7	Website for Submission of Bids (Technical as well as Financial)	https://jktenders.gov.in
8	Start Date for Submission of Online Bids	08-07-2026 from 1000 Hrs
9	Last Date for Submission of Online Bids	15-07-2026 upto 1600 Hrs
10	Date for Opening of Technical Bids	15-07-2026 at 1730 Hrs
11	Date for Opening of Financial Bids	To be Notified Separately
12	Place of Opening of Bids	State Health Society, NHM, Regional Institute of Health & Family Welfare, Near Sainik School, Kandoli Nagrota, Jammu - 181221 (J&K)
13	Tender Processing Fee	Refer SBD for details
14	Earnest Money Deposit	Refer SBD for details

Sd/-
Mission Director
(Tender Inviting Authority)
National Health Mission, J&K

No: SHS/NHM/J&K/Estt./555 Dated: 20.06.26
DIP NO.: DIPK-NB-837/26 DATE 23.06.2026

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-TENDER NOTICE NO. 10/2026 Date: 22.06.2026

E-TENDER NOTICE

Sr. DSTE/North Central Railway, Agra acting for and on behalf of the President of India invites **"Open Tender"** through Online only (E-Tendering) for the following work:

E-Tender NO.: AGRA-ST-2026-24	Approx. Cost of work: 1,00,81,423 .62

Name of work: Provision of new conference system along with Screen and PA system in the Govardhan Conference Room in DRM office of Agra Division.

Tender closing date: 16.07.2026. For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railway Website **www.ireps.gov.in.** Bidders will be able to submit their original / revised bids through web portal **www.ireps.gov.in** up to **15:00 hrs** on above mentioned date. Manual offers are not allowed against this tender and any such manual offer received shall be ignored. **1426/26 (ADM)**

North central railways @ CPRONCR www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	MUNICIPAL CORPORATION ROHTAK	CONST. OF DOG SHELTER IN LIMITS OF MC ROHTAK.	19.06.2026 30.06.2026	105.23 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9467283967 xenmcrohtak@gmail.com
2	MUNICIPAL CORPORATION ROHTAK	REPLACEMENT OF FAULTY SOLAR LIGHTS, DRIVER/PCB, BATTERIES AND DAMAGED SOLAR PANEL IN VARIOUS PARKS IN MUNICIPAL CORPORATION, ROHTAK	19.06.2026 26.06.2026	56.70 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9467283967 xenmcrohtak@gmail.com
3	MUNICIPAL CORPORATION ROHTAK	CONSTRUCTION OF BITUMEN ROAD NEAR TIKONA PARK SORROUNDING ROAD IN SECTOR-4, WARD NO. 09, MC ROHTAK	20.06.2026 26.06.2026	46.85 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9467717422 xenmcrohtak@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in No. 46467/HRY

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	MUNICIPAL COMMITTEE KALANAUR	REPAIR AND MAINTENANCE OF STREETS AND DRAINS UNDER PROGRESS OF MAHARI SADAK AND OTHER COMPLAINDS AT MC KALANAUR + 1 WORKS	22.06.2026 30.06.2026	48.77 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9802401200 municipalcommitteekalanaur@gmail.com
2	MUNICIPAL COMMITTEE KALANAUR	HIRING OF VEHICLES AND MANPOWER FOR DOOR-TO-DOOR COLLECTION, TRANSPORTATION OF MUNICIPAL SOLID WASTE FROM MC KALANAUR TO PROCESSING SITE/ DUMPSITE IN MC KALANAUR FOR 3 MONTHS.	CLOSING DATE 30.06.2026	EMD 48,875/-	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9802401200 municipalcommitteekalanaur@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in No. 46465/HRY

UJVN Limited

(An Uttarakhand Govt. Enterprises)
H.O.: "UJJWAL", Maharani Bagh, G.M.S. Road, Dehradun-248006
Telephones: 0135-2763808, Fax: 0135-2763508
CIN No.U40101UR2001SGC025866, Website:www.ujvnl.com

पत्र सं0: 527 दिनांक: 23 / 06 / 2026

e-Tender Notice

Office of the Executive Engineer (Civil-R&R-Tehri), Lakhwar Multipurpose Project, UJVN Limited, Dakpathar (Dehradun), invites online bids from interested parties. Brief summary of tender is given below:
Tender No.04/EE(Civil-R&R-Tehri)/LMP/2026-27
Name of work-Construction of RCC Retaining and Gabion Wall near Compartment No. 4, North-Binhaar (Near Nala) at left bank of Yamuna River of Lakhwar MPP.
Estimated cost -Rs. 4,91,35,397.00 (excluding GST)
Date of availability of bid document on website-24.06.2026 at 17:00 Hrs.
Last date for submission of bids on website-17.07.2026 up to 17:00 Hrs.
For full & further details, kindly visit e-procurement portal "**http://uktenders.gov.in**"

Executive Engineer (Civil-R&R-Tehri)

"Avoid wasteful use of Electricity"

कार्यालय अधिशासी अभियन्ता निर्माण शाखा, उत्तराखण्ड पेयजल निगम, ऊधमसिंह नगर।

कलैक्ट्रेट परिसर (मण्डी निदेशालय के सामने), रुद्रपुर जिला- ऊधमसिंह नगर, पिन-263153 Ph: 05944-250747

पत्रांक: 1077/ निविदा विज्ञापन/14 **Tender Notice** Date: 23.06.2026

Name of Work: Preparation of DPR of sewerage work Including conducting topographical survey including conducting topographical survey by Total station. Preparation of conducting topographical survey, Discharge measurement of existing drains/ Nallah, preparation of Technical note, Design of sewerage network, preparation of L- section layout drawing, household survey, cost estimate considering existing sewer network SPS & STP for Khatima Town of District Udham Singh Nagar, Uttarakhand

1	Date of Invitation of tender	24.06.2026
2	Date of publication of tender & time	25.06.2026 17:00 hrs
3	Date for Document Download at website: Start Date- 25-06-2026 & time 17:00 hrs and End Date-14-07-2026 & time 17:00 hrs	
4	Date of Pre-bid meeting	30.06.2026, 11:00 hrs
5	Online Bid Submission Start Date 01-07-2026, & Time 17:00 hrs and End Date 15-07-2026, & Time 17:00 hrs	
6	Offline Bid Document submission End Date & Time	16.07.2026, 17:00 hrs
7	Online Bid Opening Date & Time	17.07.2026, 16:00 hrs

Other Terms and Conditions of bidding contained in bid documents can be seen on the e- GPS portal i.e. **http://www.uktenders.gov.in**

Executive Engineer

कार्यालय अधिशासी अभियन्ता मध्य गंगा नहर निर्माण खण्ड-7 बिजनौर।

अतिअल्पकालीन निविदा सूचना-03/अधि0 अभि0/2026-27

महामहिम राज्यपाल उत्तर प्रदेश की ओर से निम्नलिखित कार्यों हेतु मुहरबन्द निविदायें वगीर्कृत श्रेणी में पंजीकृत ठेकेदारों से दिनांक 29.06.2026 को अपरान्ह 5.00 बजे तक आमन्त्रित की जाती है। जो दिनांक 30.06.2026 को अपरान्ह 12:00 बजे मुख्य अभियन्ता (मध्य गंगा नहर परियोजना) सिंचाई विभाग, उ०प्र०, अलीगढ़ द्वारा निर्धारित समिति के द्वारा कार्यालय अधिशासी अभियन्ता, मध्य गंगा नहर निर्माण खण्ड-7, बिजनौर के कार्यालय कक्ष में उपस्थित नितिदादाताओं/ उनके अधिकृत प्रतिनिधियों की उपस्थिति में खोली जायेंगी। नितिदा प्रपत्र दिनांक 27.06.2026 के पूर्वान्ह से दिनांक 29.06.2026 के अपरान्ह 3:00 बजे तक किसी भी कार्य दिवस में अधोहस्ताक्षरी के कार्यालय एंव अधिशासी अभियन्ता, मध्य गंगा नहर निर्माण खण्ड-4, अमरोहा एंव अधिशासी अभियन्ता, मध्य गंगा नहर निर्माण खण्ड-6, मेरठ के कार्यालय में निर्धारित मूल्य देकर प्राप्त किये जा सकते है। निविदा प्रपत्र क्रय करते समय (1) पंजीकरण (2) जिलाधिकारी द्वारा निर्गत चरित्र प्रमाण पत्र (IDT-1) (3) हैसियत प्रमाण पत्र (IDT-2) (4) स्वघोषणा प्रमाण-पत्र (IDT-3) की मूल प्रतियां प्रस्तुत की जायेगी अधिकृत प्रतिनिधि को ठेकेदार द्वारा प्रदत्त अधिकार पत्र जिसमे प्रतिनिधि के हस्ताक्षर प्रमाणित किया हुआ हो भी जमा करने के पश्चात निर्धारित मूल्य देकर प्राप्त किये जा सकते है।

धरोहर धनराशि एन.एस.सी./एफ.डी.आर. के रूप में जो कि अधिशासी अभियन्ता, मध्य गंगा नहर निर्माण खण्ड-7, बिजनौर के पक्ष में बन्धक होगी, जमा कराना अनिवार्य होगा अन्यथा निविदा स्वीकार नहीं कि जायेगी। एक या समस्त निविदाओं को बिना कारण बताये निरस्त करने का पूर्ण अधिकार अधोहस्ताक्षरी को होगा। यह भी अतगत कराना है कि मध्य गंगा नहर परियोजना का उद्घाटनशीघ्र अतिशीघ्र किया जाना प्रस्तावित है। अतः सम्बन्धित सभी कार्य समयअवधि के अन्तर्गत ही पूर्ण किये जाने है।

क्र. सं.	कार्य का विवरण	कार्य की अनुमानित लागत (लाख रू. में)	जमानत धनराशि (Earnest money) (लाख रू. में)	कार्य को पूर्ण करने की अवधि	निविदा प्रपत्र का मूल्य + स्टेशनरी चार्ज + जी.एस.टी. रू. में	पंजीकृत श्रेणी न्यूनतम
1	2	3	5	6	7	8
1	मुख्यनहर के कि0मी0 1.500 से कि0मी0 1.585 तक नहर की तली से सिल्ट / ठेक हटाने का कार्य।	7.91	0.16	07 दिवस	300+500+54 = 854.00	सी. एवं उच्चतर
2	मुख्य नहर के कि०मी० 1.590 से कि0मी0 1.675 तक नहर की तली से सिल्ट / ठेक हटाने का कार्य।	7.90	0.16	07 दिवस	300+500+54 = 854.00	सी. एवं उच्चतर
3	मुख्य नहर के कि०मी० 1.685 से कि0मी0 1.770 तक नहर की तली से सिल्ट / ठेक हटाने का कार्य।	7.92	0.16	07 दिवस	300+500+54 = 854.00	सी. एवं उच्चतर
4	मुख्य नहर के कि०मी० 1.775 से कि0मी0 1.865 तक नहर की तली से सिल्ट / ठेक हटाने का कार्य।	7.90	0.16	07 दिवस	300+500+54 = 854.00	सी. एवं उच्चतर
5	मुख्य नहर के कि०मी० 1.875 से कि0मी0 1.965 तक नहर की तली से सिल्ट / ठेक हटाने का कार्य।	7.89	0.16	07 दिवस	300+500+54 = 854.00	सी. एवं उच्चतर
6	मुख्य नहर के कि०मी० 1.975 से कि0मी0 2.070 तक नहर की तली से सिल्ट / ठेक हटाने का कार्य।	7.92	0.16	07 दिवस	300+500+54 = 854.00	सी. एवं उच्चतर
7	मुख्य नहर के कि0मी0 2.080 से कि0मी0 2.175 तक नहर की तली से सिल्ट / ठेक हटाने का कार्य।	7.93	0.16	07 दिवस	300+500+54 = 854.00	सी. एवं उच्चतर
8	मुख्य नहर के कि०मी० 2.180 से कि0मी0 2.275 तक नहर की तली से सिल्ट / ठेक हटाने का कार्य।	7.91	0.16	07 दिवस	300+500+54 = 854.00	सी. एवं उच्चतर
9	मुख्य नहर के कि0मी0 2.285 से कि0मी0 2.380 तक नहर की तली से सिल्ट / ठेक हटाने का कार्य।	7.93	0.16	07 दिवस	300+500+54 = 854.00	सी. एवं उच्चतर
10	मुख्य नहर के कि0मी0 2.385 से कि0मी0 2.480 तक नहर की तली से सिल्ट / ठेक हटाने का कार्य।	7.92	0.16	07 दिवस	300+500+54 = 854.00	सी. एवं उच्चतर
11	मुख्य नहर के कि0मी0 2.490 से कि0मी0 2.590 तक नहर की तली से सिल्ट / ठेक हटाने का कार्य।	7.91	0.16	07 दिवस	300+500+54 = 854.00	सी. एवं उच्चतर
12	मुख्य नहर के कि0मी0 2.595 से कि0मी0 2.695 तक नहर की तली से सिल्ट / ठेक हटाने का कार्य।	7.93	0.16	07 दिवस	300+500+54 = 854.00	सी. एवं उच्चतर
13	मुख्य नहर के कि0मी0 2.705 से कि0मी0 2.805 तक नहर की तली से सिल्ट / ठेक हटाने का कार्य।	7.90	0.16	07 दिवस	300+500+54 = 854.00	सी. एवं उच्चतर
14	मुख्य नहर के कि0मी0 2.810 से कि0मी0 2.910 तक नहर की तली से सिल्ट / ठेक हटाने का कार्य।	7.94	0.16	07 दिवस	300+500+54 = 854.00	सी. एवं उच्चतर
15	मुख्य नहर के कि0मी0 2.915 से किमी0 3.000 तक नहर की तली से सिल्ट / ठेक हटाने का कार्य।	7.92	0.16	07 दिवस	300+500+54 = 854.00	सी. एवं उच्चतर
16	मुख्य नहर के कि०मी० 3.005 से कि0मी0 3.130 तक नहर की तली से सिल्ट ठेक हटाने का कार्य।	7.93	0.16	07 दिवस	300+500+54 = 854.00	सी. एवं उच्चतर
17	मुख्य नहर के कि०मी० 3.140 से कि0मी0 3.295 तक नहर की तली से सिल्ट / ठेक हटाने का कार्य।	7.91	0.16	07 दिवस	300+500+54 = 854.00	सी. एवं उच्चतर
18	मुख्य नहर के कि०मी० 3.305 से कि0मी0 3.495 तक नहर की तली से सिल्ट / ठेक हटाने का कार्य।	7.94	0.16	07 दिवस	300+500+54 = 854.00	सी. एवं उच्चतर
19	मुख्य नहर के कि०मी० 3.500 से कि0मी0 3.695 तक नहर की तली से सिल्ट / ठेक हटाने का कार्य।	7.95	0.16	07 दिवस	300+500+54 = 854.00	सी. एवं उच्चतर
20	मुख्य नहर के कि०मी० 3.705 से कि0मी0 3.910 तक नहर की तली से सिल्ट / ठेक हटाने का कार्य।	7.90	0.16	07 दिवस	300+500+54 = 854.00	सी. एवं उच्चतर
21	मुख्य नहर के कि०मी० 3.915 से कि0मी0 4.130 तक नहर की तली से सिल्ट / ठेक हटाने का कार्य।	7.92	0.16	07 दिवस	300+500+54 = 854.00	सी. एवं उच्चतर
22	मुख्य नहर के कि०मी० 4.140 से कि0मी0 4.355 तक नहर की तली से सिल्ट / ठेक हटाने का कार्य।	7.94	0.16	07 दिवस	300+500+54 = 854.00	सी. एवं उच्चतर
23	मुख्य नहर के कि0मी0 4.360 से कि0मी0 4.570 तक नहर की तली से सिल्ट / ठेक हटाने का कार्य।	7.92	0.16	07 दिवस	300+500+54 = 854.00	सी. एवं उच्चतर
24	मुख्य नहर के कि०मी० 4.580 से कि0मी0 4.795 तक नहर की तली से सिल्ट / ठेक हटाने का कार्य।	7.63	0.16	07 दिवस	300+500+54 = 854.00	सी. एवं उच्चतर
25	मुख्य नहर के कि०मी० 4.800 से किमी0 5.000 तक नहर की तली से सिल्ट / ठेक हटाने का कार्य।	7.90	0.16	07 दिवस	300+500+54 = 854.00	सी. एवं उच्चतर
26	मुख्य नहर के कि०मी० 5.005 से कि0मी0 5.245 तक नहर की तली से सिल्ट / ठेक हटाने का कार्य।	7.71	0.16	07 दिवस	300+500+54 = 854.00	सी. एवं उच्चतर
27	मुख्य नहर के कि०मी० 5.250 से कि0मी0 5.485 तक नहर की तली से सिल्ट / ठेक हटाने का कार्य।	7.73	0.16	07 दिवस	300+500+54 = 854.00	सी. एवं उच्चतर
28	मुख्य नहर के कि०मी० 5.495 से कि0मी0 5.730 तक नहर की तली से सिल्ट / टेक हटाने का कार्य।	7.90	0.16	07 दिवस	300+500+54 = 854.00	सी. एवं उच्चतर
29	मुख्य नहर के कि०मी० 5.740 से कि0मी0 6.020 तक नहर की तली से सिल्ट / ठेक हटाने का कार्य।	7.80	0.16	07 दिवस	300+500+54 = 854.00	सी. एवं उच्चतर
30	मुख्य नहर के कि०मी० 6.025 से कि0मी0 6.310 तक नहर की तली से सिल्ट / ठेक हटाने का कार्य।	7.91	0.16	07 दिवस	300+500+54 = 854.00	सी. एवं उच्चतर
31	मुख्य नहर के कि०मी० 6.325 से कि0मी0 6.645 तक नहर की तली से सिल्ट / ठेक हटाने का कार्य।	7.93	0.16	07 दिवस	300+500+54 = 854.00	सी. एवं उच्चतर
32	मुख्य नहर के कि०मी० 6.660 से कि0मी0 7.000 तक नहर की तली से सिल्ट / ठेक हटाने का कार्य।	7.92	0.16	07 दिवस	300+500+54 = 854.00	सी. एवं उच्चतर
33	मुख्य नहर के कि०मी० 7.010 से कि0मी0 7.535 तक नहर की तली से सिल्ट / ठेक हटाने का कार्य।	7.94	0.16	07 दिवस	300+500+54 = 854.00	सी. एवं उच्चतर
34	मुख्य नहर के कि०मी० 7.550 से कि0मी0 8.090 तक नहर की तली से सिल्ट / ठेक हटाने का कार्य।	7.95	0.16	07 दिवस	300+500+54 = 854.00	सी. एवं उच्चतर
35	मुख्य नहर के कि०मी० 8.100 से कि०मी० 8.630 तक नहर की तली से सिल्ट / ठेक हटाने का कार्य।	7.90	0.16	07 दिवस	300+500+54 = 854.00	सी. एवं उच्चतर
36	मुख्य नहर के कि०मी० 8.645 से कि0मी0 9.200 तक नहर की तली से सिल्ट / ठेक हटाने का कार्य।	7.96	0.16	07 दिवस	300+500+54 = 854.00	सी. एवं उच्चतर
37	मुख्य नहर के कि०मी० 9.230 से कि0मी0 9.940 तक नहर की तली से सिल्ट / ठेक हटाने का कार्य।	7.96	0.16	07 दिवस	300+500+54 = 854.00	सी. एवं उच्चतर
38	मुख्य नहर के कि०मी० 10.000 से कि0मी0 10.670 तक नहर की तली से सिल्ट / ठेक हटाने का कार्य।	7.94	0.16	07 दिवस	300+500+54 = 854.00	सी. एवं उच्चतर
39	मुख्य नहर के कि०मी० 10.690 से कि0मी0 11.320 तक नहर की तली से सिल्ट / ठेक हटाने का कार्य।	7.90	0.16	07 दिवस	300+500+54 = 854.00	सी. एवं उच्चतर
40	मुख्य नहर के कि०मी० 11.335 से कि0मी0 12.000 तक नहर की तली से सिल्ट / ठेक हटाने का कार्य।	7.92	0.16	07 दिवस	300+500+54 = 854.00	सी. एवं उच्चतर

यह निविदा/बिड सूचना सिंचाई विभाग की वेबसाईट (**http://www.idup.gov.in**) पर उपलब्ध है। वेबसाईट से ड्राईंग उपलब्ध न होने की स्थिति में सम्बन्धित अधोहस्ताक्षरी के कार्यालय में देख सकेंगे ।

UPID-252829 Date 22/06/2026
www.upidadv.gov.in

(एस०एन० उपेन्द्र)
अधिशासी अभियन्ता

कार्यालय-अधिशासी अभियन्ता, ग्रामीण अभियन्त्रण विभाग, प्रखण्ड-गाजियाबाद।

पत्रांक:- 475/ग्रा०अ०वि०/निविदा/पत्रां0 सं0-60/2026-27 दिनांक 15-06-2026

मैन्यूवल निविदा सूचना-07

1. महामहिम राज्यपाल उत्तर प्रदेश की ओर से अधिशासी अभियन्ता, ग्रामीण अभियन्त्रण विभाग प्रखण्ड गाजियाबाद द्वारा निम्नलिखित कार्यों की प्रतिशत दर पर निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है। उक्त कार्यों के लिये ग्रामीण अभियन्त्रण विभाग में क्लास "ए, बी, सी व डी" मार्ग / भवन श्रेणी में पंजीकृत ठेकेदार ही निविदा डालने योग्य होंगे। निविदादाता किसी एक अथवा समस्त कार्य की निविदा डाल सकता है। निविदादाता से अपेक्षा की जाती है, कि निविदा डालने से पूर्व निविदा प्रपत्र के क्लॉज सं0-3 में अंकित न्यूनतम अर्हता के सम्बन्ध में शर्तों का भली-भाँति अध्ययन कर लें।
2. कार्य का विवरण निम्नवत है-

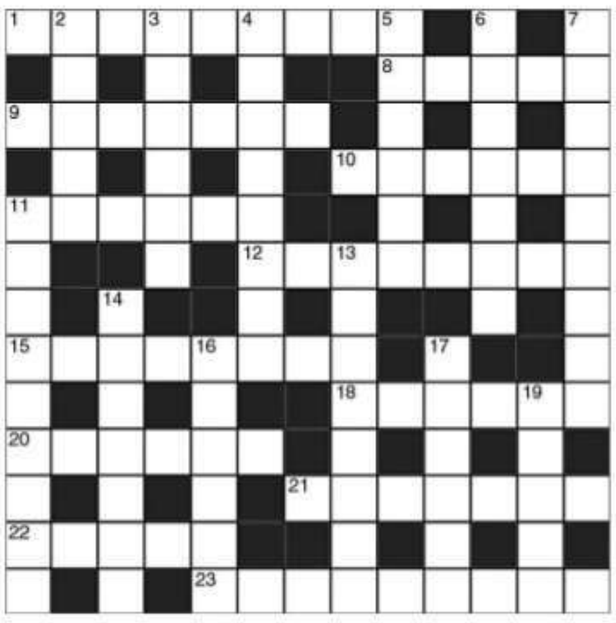
क्र. सं.	विधान सभा क्षेत्र / जनपद	योजना का नाम	कार्य का नाम	निर्माण लागत (रू. लाख में)	बिड सिक्योरिटी (रू. लाख में EMD	निविदा प्रपत्र का मूल्य जी.एस.टी. सहित	कार्य पूर्ण करने की अवधि
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
1	साहिबाबाद गाजियाबाद	वि.नि. साहिबाबाद	वार्ड संख्या-49 में ब्लॉक सी के 14 पार्को में कुल 56 बैंचो की स्थापना का कार्य।	3.87	0.20	677.00	04 माह
2	साहिबाबाद गाजियाबाद	वि.नि. साहिबाबाद	वार्ड संख्या-49 में ब्लॉक सी, ए एवं एफ के 14 पार्को में कुल 56 बैंचो की स्थापना का कार्य।	3.87	0.20	677.00	04 माह
3	साहिबाबाद गाजियाबाद	वि.नि. साहिबाबाद	वार्ड संख्या-49 में ब्लॉक एफ एवं आर के 8 पार्को में कुल 32 बैंचो की स्थापना का कार्य।	2.22	0.15	589.00	04 माह
4	साहिबाबाद गाजियाबाद	वि.नि. साहिबाबाद	वार्ड संख्या-94 एवं 40 के ब्लॉक ए, बी एवं सी के 9 पार्को में कुल 144 बैंचो की स्थापना का कार्य।	9.92	0.50	766.00	04 माह
5	साहिबाबाद गाजियाबाद	वि.नि. साहिबाबाद	वार्ड संख्या-74 वसुन्धरा में सैक्टर-13 व 11 के 11 पार्को में कुल 67 बैंचो की स्थापना का कार्य ।	4.62	0.25	677.00	04 माह
6	साहिबाबाद गाजियाबाद	वि.नि. साहिबाबाद	वार्ड संख्या-74 वसुन्धरा में सैक्टर-15 व 14 के 14 पार्को में कुल 72 बैंचो की स्थापना का कार्य।	4.97	0.25	677.00	04 माह
7	साहिबाबाद गाजियाबाद	वि.नि. साहिबाबाद	वार्ड संख्या-61 वसुन्धरा में 15 पार्को में कुल 77 बैंचो की स्थापना का कार्य।	5.31	0.30	766.00	04 माह
8	साहिबाबाद गाजियाबाद	वि.नि. साहिबाबाद	वार्ड संख्या-61 वसुन्धरा में 13 पार्को में कुल 68 बैंचो की स्थापना का कार्य।	4.69	0.20	677.00	04 माह
9	साहिबाबाद गाजियाबाद	वि.नि. साहिबाबाद	वार्ड संख्या-74 वसुन्धरा में 9 पार्को में कुल 70 बैंचो की स्थापना का कार्य।	4.83	0.20	677.00	04 माह
10	साहिबाबाद गाजियाबाद	वि.नि. साहिबाबाद	वार्ड संख्या-61 वसुन्धरा में 16 पार्को में कुल 73 बैंचो की स्थापना का कार्य।	5.04	0.27	766.00	04 माह
11	साहिबाबाद गाजियाबाद	वि.नि. साहिबाबाद	वार्ड संख्या-68 के ब्लाक ए,ब, सी एवं एच0आई0जी0 के 16 पार्को में कुल 71 बैंचो की स्थापना का कार्य।	4.90	0.25	677.00	04 माह
12	साहिबाबाद गाजियाबाद	वि.नि. साहिबाबाद	वार्ड संख्या-68 के ब्लॉक सी, डी, एवं राधा कुंज एवं अम्बेडकर के 17 पार्को में कुल 74 बैंचो की स्थापना का कार्य।	5.11	0.30	766.00	04 माह
13	साहिबाबाद गाजियाबाद	वि.नि. साहिबाबाद	वार्ड संख्या-85 में विभिन्न स्थलों के 18 पार्को में कुल 146 बैंचो की स्थापना का कार्य।	9.999	0.50	766.00	04 माह
14	साहिबाबाद गाजियाबाद	वि.नि. साहिबाबाद	वार्ड संख्या-80 के विभिन्न स्थलों पर 19 पार्को में कुल 145 बैंचो की स्थापना का कार्य।	9.99	0.50	766.00	04 माह
15	गाजियाबाद गाजियाबाद	वि.नि. गाजियाबाद	वार्ड नं0 59 के दिल्ली गेट छत्ता मौहल्ला में म0सं0-12 से म0सं0-13 तक सी०सी०रोड एवं नाली निर्माण कार्य ।	1.10	0.10	589.00	04 माह
16	गाजियाबाद गाजियाबाद	वि.नि. गाजियाबाद	वार्ड नं0 58 मवई गांव में अनिलपाल के मकान से प्रेमसिंह के मकान तक सी०सी०रोड एवं नाली निर्माण कार्य।	3.18	0.20	677.00	04 माह
17	गाजियाबाद गाजियाबाद	शिक्षा.वि. गाजियाबाद	पी०एम०श्री प्रा०विद्यालय कुशलिया विकास खण्ड रजापुर में खेल के मैदान का निर्माण कार्य।	2.65	0.15	677.00	04 माह
18	साहिबाबाद गाजियाबाद	शिक्षा.वि. गाजियाबाद	पी०एम०श्री कम्पोजिट विद्यालय सैंथली विकास खण्ड मुरादनगर में खेल के मैदान का निर्माण कार्य।	2.65	0.15	677.00	04 माह
19	साहिबाबाद गाजियाबाद	शिक्षा.वि. गाजियाबाद	पी०एम०श्री कम्पोजिट विद्यालय मीरपुर हिन्दु विकास खण्ड लोनी में खेल के मैदान का निर्माण कार्य।	2.65	0.15	677.00	04 माह
20	साहिबाबाद गाजियाबाद	शिक्षा.वि. गाजियाबाद	पी०एम०श्री कम्पोजिट विद्यालय सारा विकास खण्ड भोजपुर में खेल के मैदान का निर्माण कार्य।	3.70	0.20	677.00	04 माह
21	साहिबाबाद गाजियाबाद	शिक्षा.वि. गाजियाबाद	पी०एम०श्री कम्पोजिट विद्यालय सुहाना विकास खण्ड मुरादनगर में खेल के मैदान का निर्माण कार्य।	3.70	0.20	677.00	04 माह
22	साहिबाबाद गाजियाबाद	शिक्षा.वि. गाजियाबाद	पी०एम०श्री कम्पोजिट विद्यालय मोरटी विकास खण्ड रजापुर में खेल के मैदान का निर्माण कार्य।	3.70	0.20	677.00	04 माह

निविदा प्रपत्र अधिशासी अभियन्ता, के कार्यालय से प्रत्येक कार्य दिवस में 11.00 बजे से अपरान्ह 4.00 बजे तक दिनांक 09.07.2026 से 15.07.2026 तक प्राप्त की जा सकती है तथा डाक द्वारा निविदा प्रपत्र प्राप्त करने के लिए अतिरिक्त धनराशि 200.00 देकर प्राप्त की जा सकती है तथा इसके लिए दिनांक 14.07.2026 सायं 4.00 बजे तक अनुरोध स्वीकार किया जायेगा। डाक में देरी से निविदा प्राप्त करने के लिए विभाग जिम्मेदार नहीं होगा। निविदा प्रपत्र अधिशासी अभियन्ता, के कार्यालय में दिनांक 16.07.2026 को 12.00 बजे तक जमा की जा सकती है, जिनको उसी दिनांक 16.07.2026 को 12.30 बजे अधिशासी अभियन्ता के कार्यालय में बिड खोली जायगी। इच्छुक निविदा दाता अधिक जानकारी कार्य से संबंधित कार्यालय से प्राप्त कर सकते हैं।

अधिशासी अभियन्ता
ग्रामीण अभियन्त्रण विभाग,
प्रखण्ड-गाजियाबाद।
महामहिम राज्यपाल उ०प्र०की ओर से

UPID-252834 Date 22/06/2026
www.upidadv.gov.in

• CROSSWORD 6023



ACROSS

1 Container for spread (5,4)
8 Gun is out of order in practice (5)
9 Butler's narrow point of view? (7)
10 Accounts book with margin going from left to right (6)
11 Corrupt passage (6)
12 Sovereign is underweight considering (8)
15 The extent to which diets can vary (8)
18 It has a certain current value (6)
20 At some distance from Rodney (6)
21 Murder makes a monarch sick at heart (7)
22 That is as Julius Caesar wrote it (2,3)
23 Tradesman bursts into tears (9)

DOWN

2 Thread rope through some of the centre evenly (5)
3 Racial extraction of Elizabeth Nicholson (6)
4 Ammunition in the news (8)
5 It holds soup for two Egyptian leaders in turn (6)
6 He's bound to seek a religious goal (7)
7 A concrete addition to the total (9)
11 Lady dines out showing gluttony perhaps? (6,3)
13 Visionary details I put out (8)
14 Apart and sure to play around (7)
16 They don't mind their own business (6)
17 Olympian master of arts (6)
19 The scope of a mountain chain (5)

SOLUTIONS CROSSWORD 6022 **ACROSS:** 1 Cutters, 4 Preen, 7 Edit, 8 Foregone, 10 Pinpointed, 12 Splice, 13 Issued, 15 Out of order, 18 Fallible, 19 Toby, 20 Risen, 21 Whitsun **DOWN:** 1 Cheap, 2 Triangle, 3 Scorns, 4 Pretension, 5 Eros, 6 Needled, 9 Conclusion, 11 Outdoors, 12 Sent for, 14 Mob law, 16 Rayon, 17 Alms

JUMBLED WORDS

Given below are four jumbled words. Solve the jumbles to make proper words and move them to the respective circles below. Select the letters in the shaded circles and jumble them to get the answer for the given quip.

The only real ___ in life is not to be true to the best one knows (7)

EXALT

LAUREL

OHUIR

AACILF

SOLUTIONS: Latex, Houri, Allure, Facial
ANSWER: The only real **failure** in life is not to be true to the best one knows

• OVER THE HEDGE

BY MICHAEL FRY & T LEWIS

• CALVIN & HOBBES

BY BILL WATTERSON

• MARVIN

BY TOM ARMSTRONG

SUDOKU 6359

DIFFICULTY LEVEL 2s
INSTRUCTIONS

To solve a Sudoku puzzle, every digit from 1 to 9 must appear in each of the nine vertical columns, in each of the nine horizontal rows and in each of the nine boxes.

DIFFICULTY LEVEL
1s = Very easy; 2s = Easy;
3s = Medium; 4s = Hard;
5s = Very Hard;
6s = Genius

8								1
		2	9		1	8		
	9	5	4		6	3	7	
		7	6		4	1		
		1	5		3	2		
	3	6	8		5	9	1	
		8	1		9	7		
2								8

SOLUTION SUDOKU 6358

4	3	6	5	8	2	7	1	9
8	7	2	6	9	1	5	3	4
5	1	9	3	4	7	6	8	2
6	2	5	9	7	3	1	4	8
3	8	7	2	1	4	9	5	6
9	4	1	8	6	5	3	2	7
7	9	4	1	5	8	2	6	3
2	5	8	7	3	6	4	9	1
1	6	3	4	2	9	8	7	5

• ROYAL STARS

BY GEORGIA NICOLS

ARIES (MAR 21 - APR 20): Continue to focus on home and family issues, especially repairs and improvements. This is a lovely day to socialise and enjoy fun activities with kids; however, disputes about shared property or taxes could create power struggles. Tonight: Check your finances.

TAURUS (APR 21 - MAY 21): This is a busy time for you with short trips, appointments and conversations with everyone. You might be redecorating at home and entertaining. Be patient with partners and authority figures today. Tonight: Listen and cooperate.

GEMINI (MAY 22 - JUNE 21): The Venus in your House of Communications will smooth difficult conversations today. Power struggles related to your job, pet or health are hard to avoid. Guard against being obsessive. Tonight: Get busy.

CANCER (JUNE 22 - JULY 23): You are a nurturing sign, and today you might feel compelled to have your way with issues related to your kids, social outings and the arts. This could put you at odds with someone, especially about funding or the cost of something. Tonight: Socialise.

LEO (JULY 24 - AUG 23): Today, the Moon and Pluto are at odds with your sign. This could create impulsive behaviour. Something might upset you to the point that you lose focus on everything else. Tonight: Relax at home.

VIRGO (AUG 24 - SEP 23): This is a popular time for you, and you might be interacting with younger people more than usual. Travel and educational plans might be on the table. Avoid emotional power struggles today. Don't let people manipulate you. Tonight: Discussions.

LIBRA (SEP 24 - OCT 23): You like pleasant harmony in your surroundings. You are noticed now. These are good reasons to avoid public money squabbles with your kids or a romantic partner. Tonight: Check your money.

SCORPIO (OCT 24 - NOV 23): Today the Moon is in your sign at odds with your ruler Pluto, making you emotionally intense, perhaps even obsessive about something. You are a strong-willed sign, and when you want something, you can be threatening or overpowering. Tonight: You win.

SAGITTARIUS (NOV 24 - DEC 22): Something going on behind the scenes is filling your thoughts. It's all you can think about. Focus on work and being productive today. You also might travel for pleasure — something that always pleases you. Tonight: Enjoy privacy.

CAPRICORN (DEC 23 - JAN 20): Be easygoing and cooperative when talking to friends and members of groups and organisations. Why not channel this playful, competitive energy into something enjoyable? Let go of what is creating your angst. Tonight: Be friendly.

AQUARIUS (JAN 21 - FEB 19): Increased chaos and activity at home might be frustrating now. You're prepared to work. Today, however, power struggles with authority figures might arise. Never underestimate the power of courtesy. Tonight: Others notice you.

PISCES (FEB 20 - MAR 20): Focus on playful opportunities to socialise with others. Work colleagues will also be pleasant and supportive. Don't get bogged down in politics, religion or racial issues. You need a clear mind to address these matters. Tonight: Learn and explore ideas.

BENGALURU EAST CITY CORPORATION
O/o Executive Engineer, Kadugodi Division,
Hoodi Main Road, Hoodi, Bengaluru-560048

No: BECC/EE/KGD/TN/01/2026-27, Dated: 23-06-2026

Invitation for Tenders (Short Term)

(Through GoK KPP Portal https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in only)

The Executive Engineer, Kadugudi Division invites Item Rate tenders from eligible tenderers for the work details in the table given below. The Bidders shall be a registered in/CPWD/KPWD/Railways/MES / any State or Central Govt. organization.

S.N.	Name of the work
1	Comprehensive Development of Roads and Drains and other allied works in ward no. 31-Kadugudi, 32-Channasandra, 34-Kaverinagara, 28-Byrathi, 30- Belathur, 29-Hoodi, in Kadugudi Division of Mahadevapura Constituency. (Annexure-2, Sl No.27 to 32) **Amount put to tender :** 980.00 Lakhs. **EMD :** 14,70,000/-.

Calendar of events: 1) Last date of submission queries : 30-06-2026 within 3.00 P.M. 2) Date & time for Pre Bid Meeting : 30-06-2026 at 4.00 P.M. 3) Last Date & Time for receipt of tenders : 04-07-2026 Upto 4:00 P.M. 4) Date & Time for Opening Technical bid : 06-07-2026 at 4.30 P.M. 5) Date & Time for Opening Financial bid : 07-07-2026 at 4.00 P.M 6) Validity of Tenders : 180 Days.

Sd/- Executive Engineer, Kadugodi Division

KARNATAKA POWER TRANSMISSION CORPORATION LIMITED
(CIN : U40109KA1999SGC025521)

No. CEE/T&P/SEE-2/2026-27/3008-21 Date:23.06.2026

BRIEF TENDER NOTIFICATION
(THROUGH KARNATAKA PUBLIC PROCUREMENT PORTAL ONLY)

KPTCL invites Bids on electronic mode for the following works against following enquiry number on **Partial Turnkey basis.**

Enquiry No. and Name of the works
KPTCL/2026-27/SS/WORK_INDENT3917
Combined Package for: **Work-A:** Establishing 2x20MVA, 66/11kV sub-station at **Narasimhagiri (Belligatta)** with associated line for a distance of **0.679kms** in Kudligi Taluk, Vijayanagar District. **Work-B:** Construction of 66kV LILO line to 66kV **Venkatapura** sub-station from existing 66kV MSD (Munirabad-Sokke-Davanagere) for a distance of **0.952kms** and construction of two No's of terminal bays at existing 66kV Venkatapura sub-station in Hosapete Taluk, Vijayanagara District.

The bids will be received through electronic tendering mode only. The details regarding participation in the E-tendering process can be obtained by logging on to KPTCL website **https://kptcl.karnataka.gov.in** with hyperlink 'E Procurement KPTCL' or **https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in on or after 29.06.2026 @ 15:00hrs. Last date & time for receipt of Bids and any extension of Due date for Bid submission will be intimated in the KPP portal.** Any details required in this regard can also be obtained from the office of the undersigned during office hours.

All Corrigendum/Addendums shall be noticed by the bidders before the last date of submission of the Bids.

Sd/- Chief Engineer, (Electy).,
Tendering & Procurement, KPTCL, 9th Floor,
Indhana Bhavana, Anand Rao Circle, Bengaluru-560 009.

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C./ 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Abdul Mehraj, S/o: Abdul Gaffar, R/o: A-Z, A-3, 4th Floor, Gali NO-2, Chauhan Bangar, Garhi Mendu, Seelampur, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No.: 38/2020, U/s: 188 IPC, P.S. Jama Masjid, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Abdul Mehraj** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Abdul Mehraj** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Abdul Mehraj** of **P.S. Jama Masjid, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **28.07.2026.**

By Order
Ms. Rashi Raheja
Ld. JMFC-13, Central,
Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/8379/CD/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person(s) **Anil S/o** Veeru **R/o** Police Chowki Ke Samne Wali Gali, J.J Colony Sawda, PS Kanjhawala, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **E-FIR NO. 80105888/2025, U/S: 303(2) Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita-2023, 07.11.2025 PS: Gazipur, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Anil,** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Anil,** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person(s) **Anil, E-FIR NO. 80105888/2025, U/S: 303(2) Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita-2023, 07.11.2025 PS: Gazipur, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **25.08.2026.**

By Order
Amit Rana
Judicial Magistrate First Class-06
East District, Court No. 12,
Karkardooma Court, Delhi

DP/8397/ED/2026
(Court Matter)

NORTH WESTERN RAILWAY **E-Tender Notice**

E-Tender Notice No 82 to 88-26-27 Divisional Railway Manager. North West Railway. Bikaner for and on behalf of President of India invites open E-Tender for the following works **up to 15.00 hours on 13.07.2026** as below- **Tender No.: 82. Name of Work with its Location:** Supply of 136732.40 cum Stone ballast (Machine Crushed) 65 mm Gauge as per revised specification of RDSO track ballast of IS/RDSO-GE/0001:2023. February 2023 and loading the same into Railway Wagons/Hoppers at Ballast Depot Sarupsar, under ADEN/Suratgarh. **Approx. Cost of Work:** Rs. 282047492.75. **Earnest Money:** Rs. 5641000.00. **Tender No.: 83. Name of Work with its Location:** Provision of S&T service building in c/w Interlocking of 02 Nos. of manned LC gates i.e. LC-14. 34-1 in HMH-SDLP section over Bikaner Division under ADEN/Hanumangarh-11. **Approx. Cost of Work:** Rs. 8891031.40. **Earnest Money:** Rs. 177800.00. **Tender No.: 84. Name of Work with its Location:** Provision of water softening plant & related ancillary work in railway colony at Kalanaur kalan, Lahli & Bamla under ADEN/BNW. **Approx. Cost of Work:** Rs. 15106470.29. **Earnest Money:** Rs. 302100.00. **Tender No.: 85. Name of Work with its Location:** Provision of SSP & height gauge at LC gates for HMEL siding at RKK station on Hisar- Bathinda section under ADEN/Sirsa. **Approx. Cost of Work:** Rs. 4884661.92 **Earnest Money:** Rs. 97700.00. **Tender No.: 86. Name of Work with its Location:** Supply of Drinking Water on Station mid section, in Gangs & Level Crossings, Restshelter on LGH (Ex.)-PLC (Ex.) Section in the jurisdiction of under ADEN/Line/Bikaner for Twenty Four Months. **Approx. Cost of Work:** Rs. 6130448.90. **Earnest Money:** Rs. 122600.00. **Tender No.: 87. Name of Work with its Location:** Raising of ML PF No.1 & 2 at Sird & Nokhra stations over Bikaner Division along with extension to 480m under jurisdiction of ADEN/Line/Bikaner. **Approx. Cost of Work:** Rs. 141219257.92. **Earnest Money:** Rs. 2824400.00. **Tender No.: 88. Name of Work with its Location:** Extension of PF No.1 at KLYT to accommodate 24 coaches trains and raising of ML PF No.1 & 2 at Bap along with extn to 480m over Bikaner Division under jurisdiction of ADEN-Line-Bikaner. **Approx Cost of Work:** Rs. 118381786.08. **Earnest Money:** Rs. 2367600.00. **Note- Other terms & conditions will be shown on the website www.ireps.gov.in.**

Follow us on : /NWRailways NWRailways_ www.ireps.gov.in

कार्यालय प्राचार्य, सोबन सिंह जीना राजकीय आयुर्विज्ञान एवं शोध संस्थान अल्मोड़ा
निकट विकास भवन, पाण्डेखोला, अल्मोड़ा, जिला-अल्मोड़ा-263601 (उत्तराखण्ड)
ई-मेल -principal.gmcalmora@gmail.com, http://www.ssjgimsralmora.org
मोबाइल सं०:- 9412410759 फोन/ फैक्स नं०:- 05962-230557
GSTIN: 05AAAGS2989B1ZA | PAN: AAAGS2989B | TAN: MRTS16286E

पत्रांक : 2693/जी.एम.सी.-ए/सर्जरी विभाग/ई०एन०टी०/विज्ञापन/G1 दिनॉक 23/06/2026

जैम बिड सूचना

सोबन सिंह जीना राजकीय आयुर्विज्ञान एवं शोध संस्थान, अल्मोड़ा से सम्बद्ध गो०ति०रा०बे० चिकित्सालय, अल्मोड़ा के सर्जरी विभाग एवं ई०एन०टी० विभाग हेतु निम्नलिखित संयत्र / उपकरणों की अधिप्राप्ति हेतु जैम पोर्टल पर प्रतिष्ठित निमार्ताओं / अधिकृत विक्रेताओं से बिडस आमंत्रित की जाती है। जैम बिड से सम्बन्धित अन्य समस्त सूचनायें भारत सरकार की वैबसाईट **http://gem.gov.in** से निमनानुसार प्राप्त की जा सकती है:-

S.No	GeM Bid Number	Name of Equipment
1	GEM/2026/B/7673258	Diode Laser Surgical Unit
2	GEM/2026/B/7683846	Enhanced Digital Ear Examination Treiner, Ear Ossicles Tympanic Membrane and Cochlea Model, Ear Syringing Model, Tracheostomy Care Simulator, Head Musculature with Larynx Model, Head and Neck Model Showing Vasculature and Nerves, Epistaxix Trainer, Cricothyrotomy Simulator.

प्राचार्य,
राजकीय मेडिकल कॉलेज,
अल्मोड़ा

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(SEE SECTION 82(2) (ii) Cr.P.C./84 BNSS)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person(s) **KAPIL VERMA R/o A-8, Module-7, Divine Park View, Abhay Khand-3, Indirapuram, Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh-201014** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in FIR No./Ct. Case No. **5010/24 U/s 138 NI Act, PS Kirti Nagar, Distt. West, New Delhi** and it has been returned to a Warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **KAPIL VERMA** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **KAPIL VERMA** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person(s) **KAPIL VERMA** of FIR No./Ct. Case No. **5010/24 U/s 138 NI Act, PS Kirti Nagar, Distt. West, New Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before dated **23.07.2026** at **10:00 AM.**

By Order
Ms. Poonam Singh
JMFC (NI Act)-04
West Distt., Room No. 04 (Annex-I)
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/8501/WD/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused person Namely **Mohan Lal @ Monu S/o** Ram Prasad **R/o** 6/95 Shankar Road, Rajinder Nagar, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 324/2023 U/s. 379/411 IPC PS: Karol Bagh, New Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Mohan Lal @ Monu** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Mohan Lal @ Monu** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Mohan Lal @ Monu** accused of **FIR No. 324/2023 U/s. 379/411 IPC PS: Karol Bagh, New Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **28.07.2026.**

By Order
Sh. Nishat Bangarh
JMFC-01, Room No. 180
Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/7993/CD/2026
(Court Matter)

ANDHRA PRADESH CAPITAL REGION DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY (APCRDA)
Rayapudi, Thullur Mandal, Amaravati-522237 (A.P.)

NIT No: MAU61-USI0HB/4/2026-HB/2nd call, Dt: 22-06-2026

E PROCUREMENT TENDER NOTICE (SECOND CALL)

Name of Work: "APCRDA-H&B Maintenance-Operation and Maintenance of Street Lighting in VIP Routes of Amaravati Capital Region and Seed Access Road for one year" Estimate Amount: Rs. 1,03,50,000/-. The bid can be downloaded on AP e-procurement portal from **24.06.2026 to 09.07.2026 up to 14.00 Hrs.** Due date for submission of Bid **09.07.2026 up to 15.00 Hrs,** Technical bid opening **09.07.2026 @ 16.00 Hrs.** For further details please refer to **www.apeprocurement.gov.in** and **www.crda.ap.gov.in**

Sd/- Commissioner, APCRDA, Rayapudi

OFFICE OF THE SECRETARY
A.P. SOCIAL WELFARE RESIDENTIAL EDUCATIONAL INSTITUTIONS SOCIETY
D.No. 12-467-9, Moksha Sai Plaza, Service Road, Tadepalli, Guntur District-522 501

e-Procurement Tender Notice No.8-11 APSWRE-Tech-2026, Dated.23.06.2026

Tenders are invited through e-Procurement from eligible registered companies/firms for the following works/services to all the Dr.B.R.Ambedkar Gurukulams in AP for AY-2026-27: i) Supply and delivery of Stationery items with an ECV 3.11Crores, ii) Supply and Delivery of Non-Perishable Dietary Items and Milk in 3 Packages-1, II & III with an ECV of Rs.37.30Cr, 37.00Cr, 35.50Cr respectively.

The downloading of tender documents shall commence from **24.06.2026.** The closing date and detailed tender schedule may be viewed on the e-Procurement portal.

Further details may be viewed at: Andhra Pradesh e-Procurement Portal **Contact No.:** 0863-2347445 **Note:** Any corrigendum, changes, or amendments, if any, shall be communicated only through the above e-Procurement platform.

Sd/-
SECRETARY APSWREIS, Tadepalli
No: 5201PP/CL/ADVT/1/1/2021-22 Dt: 23.06.2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(See Section 82 Cr. P.C./84 BNSS)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused **Shahrukh** S/o Mohd. Yusuf, R/o Flat No. 608, Tulsi Niketan near MK Restaurant Bhopura, Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 80115987/2025 U/s 303(2)/317(2) Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, PS I.P Estate, Delhi** and it has been returned to warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said accused **Shahrukh** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Shahrukh** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that **Shahrukh** in **FIR No. 80115987/2025 U/s 303(2)/317(2) Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, PS I.P Estate, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **21.09.2026.**

By order
Ms. Preeti
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03
Central District, Room No. 150
Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/8316/CD/2026

MADHYA GUJARAT VIJ CO. LTD.
Corporate office : 5th Floor, Sardar Patel Vidyut Bhavan, Race Course, Vadodara-390007 Customer Care No. 19124

TENDER NOTICE NO.: ID (1) 315210, (2) 315064, (3) 315280 & (4) GeM Bid No: GEM/2026/B/7471075

MGVCL Web site: www.mgvcl.com **Dept-GOG: http://guj-epd.gov.in**

Online tenders are invited from the registered Manufacturers whose works in India having GST registration only for Purchase of **(1)** 3C LT Aerial Bunched (AB) Cable of Sizes: 3Cx120(Ph)+1Cx 120(N) + 70(M) mm², **(2)** 11/0.433KV three phase 16kVA (Aluminium wound) Level-1 / Star-1 rated CRGO / Amorphous Core distribution transformers & **(3)** "Reflective Jackets" as per specification, terms & conditions of Tender.

AND

Online Tenders (GeM Bid) only from registered manufacturers whose works in India having GST registration only for Purchase of 3.5C LT PVC Cable of Sizes: 50 MM², 70MM², 150MM² as per specification, terms & condition of tender under RDSS.

Tender documents available on web-site: **https://mgvcltender.nprocure.com** (for online submission, view and download) and GUVNL/MGVCL websites **www.gseb.com & www.mgvcl.com** (for online submission, view and download). Interested vendors may surf the above web sites.

Note : Be in touch with our websites till opening of tender.

Additional Chief Engineer (Proc.)

The inevitability of a Ronaldo riposte strikes... twice

Shuvaditya Bose
New Delhi, June 23

WE HAVE been here before. Us, the hapless sports scribes, who marshalled every tenet of footballing logic to argue against his presence. The weary supporters, who no longer found the energy to defend their idol. The opponents, who assumed he had lost his powers of intimidation. And between us — the writers, the supporters and the defenders — him. Cristiano Ronaldo.

Whenever the writing on the wall has appeared too glaring to ignore, whenever numbers have suggested his stocks were falling, the inevitability of a Ronaldo riposte has arrived. As it did in Houston on Tuesday, where he led Portugal to a 5-0 win over Uzbekistan.

If not for that inevitability, the post-game discourse could have been strikingly different. The narrative of Ronaldo being counterproductive to Portugal's title hopes would have gained fresh momentum. And for a fleeting moment, it seemed it would. Ronaldo missed a tap-in from a sublime Nuno Mendes cross in the fourth minute.

Indeed, even the seemingly immortals possess elements of mortality. Even Lionel Messi missed a penalty yesterday. The difference between the ordinary and the genius, however, was showcased in his response. A brace. That, though, was Messi — leading goal-scorer in World Cup history, a reigning world champion and a player who still bends matches to his will.

Could Ronaldo? At 41? After the disastrous performance against DR Congo? Amid a goal drought in major tournaments stretching to 10 games?

The rebuttal had arrived even before questions could be framed. In two minutes. A profounding yes.

Throughout his career, Ronaldo has defied the shackles of irrelevance through reinvention. At his age, he does not necessarily need to do so. Would life not be easier, reclining on a sun lounger in his Riyadh mansion, while collecting €200 million per season and avoiding the relentless scrutiny of a World Cup? Undoubtedly. But when has Ronaldo ever chosen easy?

Cristiano Ronaldo scored twice for Portugal against Uzbekistan. AP

He reinvented today. For the first goal in the sixth minute, surely. Spotting the overlapping run of Joao Cancelo on the right, Ronaldo darted into the space between centre-back Abdulla Abdullaev and midfielder Odiljon Khamrobekov. The finish possessed a ferocity reminiscent of younger days. Abduvokhid Nematov's dive was merely decorative.

And then, for the second goal, which represented a different sort of reinvention — psychological. Pedro Neto earned Portugal a free-kick right at the edge of the box — also known as the Ronaldo territory. One could not imagine anyone else taking it. Yet, upon consulting with Bruno Fernandes, he left it for Nuno Mendes, who had a more favourable angle. 2-0.

> *Spotting the overlapping run of Cancelo on the right, Ronaldo darted into space. The finish possessed a ferocity reminiscent of younger days.*

Bygone era

The third goal belonged to a bygone era. Ronaldo curved his run around the blind side of Rustam Ashurmatov before applying a precise finish beyond the helpless Nematov.

Then, the SIUU. Reverberated in the Houston Stadium with an intensity that makes it hard to believe that it is the very site where he was booed, mocked, and serenaded with chants of 'Messi! Messi!' only five days ago.

Records were broken, too. With the opening goal of the game, Ronaldo became the only player to score in six editions of the men's FIFA World Cup. With his second, he became Portugal's leading goal-scorer in this competition, eclipsing Eusebio. At 10, Ronaldo is two shy of Pele, and five of his Brazilian namesake. If not for Nematov, Ronaldo could have had a hat-trick. Portugal, though, did get a fourth via an Nematov own goal. And then a fifth, courtesy of Rafael Leao.

Are we going overboard? One could argue that it was only Uzbekistan. Ranked 50th — 43 places adrift of Portugal — who had never competed at a stage of magnitude before. Yet, even if the adulation appears excessive given the disparity between the sides, so be it. It has arrived after weeks of relentless criticism. The inevitability of a Ronaldo rebuttal has struck football. Again. It had to. It was always meant to.

GOLDEN BOOT RACE

Messi, Mbappe stars but Haaland on trail

Erling Haaland has four goals to his name at the World Cup. AP

Sandip G
New Jersey, June 23

THE MOMENT the Metlife arena, soaked in water and warned of a flash flood, waited breathlessly for arrived at the stroke of the fiftieth minute. When the man, the boisterous Norwegian sea of red wanted to score a goal, finally scored. The Erling Haaland moment; the Viking stamp on the game. He had to wait too, till he suffered the pangs of isolation through much of the first half, till he watched his colleague Martin Ødegaard fluff a delightful pass; till his grass-cutter crashed onto the base of the post.

Then came two in the space of nine minutes, an adequate cushion to douse a belated comeback from Senegal (3-2), ensuring Norway's progress to the round of 32 in their long-awaited comeback to the World Cup. And how he and his teammates celebrated the monumental victory, performing the rowing celebration in the middle of the pitch, to cracking imitations and rippling applause from the stands.

But the Haaland moment was inevitable, even if he was passive in the first half. Lionel Messi had doled out a brace; as had Kylian Mbappe, portending a golden-boot race for the ages.

Haaland could not slip out of the race, at least for the charm of a three-horse race, at least for breaking the duopoly. And so he did with bizarre calm. A well-weighted pass from Ødegaard, splitting the centre-half pairing of Moussa Niakhaté and Kalidou Koulibaly, found him in adequate space to drill the ball ferociously past Édouard Mendy.

Haaland, with a swaggering smile, ambled to the corner flag, where he and Ødegaard stuck the pose, either side of the flag. The stand beside broke into the symphonic row, chanting Haaland's name. They were rowing; Haaland was riding the wave.

The first goal was cathartic; the second invaluable. Senegal, cutting loose, which was the only way they could have forced a comeback into a game where they defended with stupendous sloppiness, halved the arrears through Ismaila Sarr's sliding finish. A sudden wave of energy seized them. But Haaland snuffed it with a sniper's deadeye finish. It seemed routine, him working out the angle with a neat shot off his instep that bounded off the crossbar.

But the late contortion of his body was sublime, and what makes him an elite striker. He was gunning for a shot with his left foot, which is what he often does. But with a defender nudging behind, he would not be able to manufacture space and control the ball as he would have wished to. So he quickly cavorted, and wrapped his right-foot around the ball that came at hip level. His quick change of mind surprised Mendy. Even if not, his shot was so sweetly-timed that the Senegalese netminder would have been incapable of defanging its venom. The celebrations rolled on a cold and damp night that he lit up. He pointed his ears at the crowd. He wanted more noise, they wanted more goals.

From 3-1, the comeback doors slammed shut for the African Cup finalist.

After his brace, the golden boot race reads: Messi 5; Mbappe 4; Haaland 4. The Norwegian has shown he is a worthy competitor to them, and a potential inheritor to their throne. Mbappe-Haaland sprint could define football in impending years, but this edition, Messi's shadows loom over them. Haaland pressed and probed for a hat-trick goal that would have made him level with Messi. But it didn't arrive.

The 25-year-old has been the poster boy for Norway, which qualified for the tournament after 28 years. In the decades past, they possessed a functional, spirited team without a talisman. In Haaland, they have found one. His emergence is even more special than those of Messi and Mbappe. For, Norway had not a long lineage of elite players. In Haaland, they have discovered someone who can reliably influence games to decide the big moments.

Defensive duties

His defensive contributions in the nervous end-game was equally noteworthy. In the final minute of stoppage time, Senegal were awarded a corner kick. All their men, barring the goalkeeper, were inside the box. Ismail Jakobs flung in a delightful ball, bending into the box and onto the forehead of Sarr, whose brace had offered Senegal a smidgeon of comeback hope. But Haaland towered over him, and although Sarr connected with the ball, the header was off-target because Haaland had blocked his vision.

When the final whistle blew, ending a game redeemed of its first-half ennui by a hysteric second half, Haaland did not forget Marcus Pedersen, who scored Norway's first goal. He hugged and thanked him, just as the whole of Norway would have Haaland. It was not a flawless Norway performance, but they had a flawless Haaland.

• RESULTS

GROUP J

Argentina 2-0 Austria
Dallas Stadium

Jordan 1-2 Algeria
San Francisco Stadium

GROUP I

France 3-0 Iraq
Philadelphia Stadium

Norway 3-2 Senegal
New York New Jersey Stadium

GROUP K

Portugal 5-0 Uzbekistan
Houston Stadium

• MATCH SCHEDULE

GROUP K

Colombia vs DR Congo
Guadalajara, **7.30 am** (Wednesday)

GROUP B

Bosnia vs Qatar
Seattle, **12.30 am** (Thursday)

Switzerland vs Canada
Vancouver, **12.30 am** (Thursday)

GROUP C

Morocco vs Haiti
Atlanta, **3.30 am** (Thursday)

Scotland vs Brazil
Miami, **3.30am** (Thursday)

ZEE5 OTT & UNITE8 CHANNELS

Norway players celebrating after their win over Senegal. AP

Ecstatic Norway celebrate with the Viking Row

NORWAY'S PLAYERS sat on the pitch and performed the "rowing" celebration made iconic by their fans during the World Cup after reaching the knockout stage with a nervy 3-2 win over Senegal. At their first finals since 1998, red-clad Norwegian fans have been doing their Viking row in stadiums, on escalators and even in Times Square, but it has never been more emotional or joyous than after the final whistle on Monday. REUTERS

Algeria rally to knock out Jordan in 2-1 win

ALGERIA STORMED back to beat Jordan 2-1 and eliminate the World Cup debutants on Monday thanks to second-half goals from Nadhir Benbouali and Amine Gouiri. Benbouali's header cancelled out Nizar Al-Rashdan's first-half opener and Gouiri poked home in a goalmouth scramble eight minutes from time to revive Algeria's campaign. "I don't know if we showed our true face but we played a better game than against Argentina," Gouiri said. "The team was a lot better in winning the tackles and winning balls," Petkovic said. REUTERS

ARGENTINA'S ENFORCER

A guard, a troubleshooter; the legs that make Messi magic work

Rodrigo de Paul remains unwaveringly committed to helping legend weave his magic sans burden

EXPRESS AT WORLD CUP

Sandip G
New Jersey, June 23

LIONEL MESSI and Rodrigo de Paul are not just structural parts of the same sentence, but de Paul is the verb that makes Messi the subject moving. Messi can be watched in isolation, at walking pace, with an impermeable halo around him, a fulfilling experience in itself. But to admire Messi, the viewer should admire de Paul too. It is difficult because they are not often together, not in each other's shadows, not indulging in one-twos or interplays, and not passing the ball to each other or assisting. But you miss de Paul, you miss a part of Messi too.

To watch de Paul is to watch where Messi should have been; to understand de Paul is to understand what Messi should have been doing. Messi roams, but de Paul ensures that he leaves no vacuum. He fills the space. Messi doesn't press. He needn't, because there is de Paul pressing for two men. Messi doesn't run, because de Paul is running for him, covering his own distance as well as Messi's. Messi doesn't lunge into tackles, again there is De Paul, who incidentally began his career as a goalkeeper for a small club in his hometown Sarandí, a suburb of Buenos Aires.

Messi doesn't appeal for fouls committed on him, because de Paul does the talking. "I care a lot about Leo, and I know he cares a lot about me," he said before the World Cup. When Messi scored his record-breaking 17th goal, he searched for de Paul's face, and when he found him, he embraced him like best friends would.

The Argentinian press have coined a non-quirky but fitting epithet for him. The bodyguard. Messi's protective shield. Not only in the sense that he compensates for Messi's declining physical prowess, but he is the first to badger the referees when Messi is fouled, he makes a mental note of those that had fouled him, and waits for his ripe moment to exact revenge. Messi's revenge is his revenge too. He sketches the men inhibiting Messi-world, and takes it upon himself to bind them. Perhaps, there should be a new name for his role—The Rodrigo role. He likens himself to a "spare tyre". His teammates have a more fitting description—the engine. He runs an average of 11 kilometres a game; Messi's is around 7. Against Algeria, de Paul ran 10.21 km, compensating for Messi's laggardly 7.2.

There were numerous instances of de Paul's unflinching commitment to Messi. Against Austria, he was constantly checking and controlling David Alaba, the left-sided centre-back, the most experienced hand, tasked to confiscate Messi. He pressed him, drew him into challenging him and sucked out all his energy. Sometimes, he lost the ball, but would keep chasing Alaba or whoever there was, and distract them from Messi. He suffocates, so that Messi could breathe. The steel that makes the silk shine.

He is so vital to Messi that Inter Miami didn't bother grooming another midfielder to enable Messi blaze in his sunset. They simply brought him. He is as essential to him, as Xavi Hernandez and Andres Iniesta were to Messi in Barcelona. Even more profound because Messi was at the peak of his physical prowess then.

The 32-year-old, often, goes uncelebrated like most defensive midfielders. He berates himself as an "inferior midfielder who is good with two other midfielders around me." The self-deprecating self-assessment has a grain of truth about it.

He is not an out-and-out No 6 in the N'golo Kante mould; he is not the conductor of the orchestra like Xavi or Kevin de Bruyne; he is not a box-to-box enforcer like Declan Rice. He is a sum of all their parts, and performs one of the toughest jobs in the sport. To be two men at the same time.

But primarily, he makes the greatest footballer spread his greatness a little longer, a little bit more. Messi has the assurance that there is de Paul performing his duties. And de Paul, he says, has the guarantee that there is Messi to produce supernatural feats. "Playing with him (Messi) is like playing Truco (a popular South American trick card game) having the ace of spades in every hand," De Paul told Argentina channel Ole. "If you know beforehand that you are always going to have that card, you play more at ease, more calm. Messi is the one who takes care of me — he'd come down and tell me 'come here', 'get like this', it's the opposite."

Rodrigo de Paul

Their friendship off the field translates onto the pitch too. "Having such a good relationship with him led to us looking for each other a lot on the field and understanding each other so much," de Paul said in an interview with TyC Sports in 2022. "What happened on the field happened outside. That relationship was always nurturing, to the point where now we understand each other just by looking at each other."

They had never played together until 2018, just before the World Cup. Their personalities are different. De Paul is an extrovert: Messi is withdrawn. Perhaps the polarity brought them together. They bonded over playing the card game, truco, songs and training. "We do warm up games where you dribble, jump a hoop, shoot. I say: 'Leo; I'll take you on.' He loves that. That humanises him. You can see him as existing in another dimension but he's a man," he once told The Guardian. And de Paul is the man that helps the "man" to become a superman.

• FRANCE'S BEATING HEART

Born in London, facilitating France's World Cup — the Olise story

Shivani Naik
Mumbai, June 23

THERE ARE 75 players at the 2026 FIFA World Cup who are born in France – representing around 10 nations. Michael Olise, the lynchpin of the French attack, the puppeteer pulling the strings from the right wing, while setting up Kylian Mbappé's strikes – isn't one. Olise was born in London.

He has been called the 'today and tomorrow' of French football by Mbappé, after his assists first helped France steady early nerves and a ponderous first half against Senegal, when the French captain finally scored. Against Iraq in a rain-drenched game, Olise was quicker to get France going, when his pinpoint service to Mbappé took his captain to 15 World Cup goals in his 100th match. Roving on the right, well out of the defensive unit's peripheral sights, Olise kept pinging in precise passes that the French forwards could convert, with Dembele receiving an Olise assist and scoring the French third in a 3-0 win.

Olise's link-up play

The reason Mbappé and Olise have hit it off so quickly is because his left foot on the right flank works out angles, strikes rotating acceleration with such rhythm that Mbappé is receiving deliveries at his footstep. Like a norden bombsight of an ancient bombardier, Olise has been gauging movement around the box, mapping his teammates' pathways and using his creative vision to open supply lines and pave the path for the captain.

There was grumpiness from English shores when Olise chose to play for France. He grew up in London, born to a Nigerian-English father and Franco-Algerian mother. "I possess four parts of each of these countries. All four parts enrich me," he has maintained. Explaining why he picked France, he said, "I always had a connection with the French national team. It was a childhood dream to play for them given I spent a lot of holidays at my mother's home."

Michael Olise (R) has been a revelation for France. AP

> *The reason Mbappé and Olise have hit it off is because his left foot works out angles, strikes rotating acceleration with such rhythm that Mbappé is receiving balls at his footstep*

His brother still plays for Chelsea, while Michael went over to Bayern Munich, after a fruitful stint at Crystal Palace, where besides becoming the youngest goal-scorer at the club, he showed a flair and generosity for rustling up assists.

As such, Olise is a perfect fit in this multi-cultural French team. He might not have grown up in the urban marginalised banlieues of Paris, but besides the blended nationalities in his genes, Olise was also shaped by several influences. Stints at Arsenal, Chelsea and Manchester City coincided with his long-distance stargazing of French greats Zinedine Zidane and Thierry Henry. He was simultaneously enchanted by the trick-dribbles of Neymar and how he sizzled with pace moving up field.

But at 18, Olise had no doubts about who he wanted to turn out for – he would slot into the 2024 Paris Olympics home squad finishing with a silver. A senior call-up from Didier Deschamps was on the horizon, and he would link up with Mbappé right away, lending France the creative coherence from his right half position. Half of Mbappé's praise for Olise after the Senegal-win was him chuckling about how the press would never be able to demystify him because he abhorred speaking to the media. It's earned him the very French nickname Mr Nonchalant, which amused Mbappé.

As the French attack circled their defensive wall forming a rhythmic ring of short passes to break the Iraqi shape on Monday, Olise was the orchestra conductor. That he revels in lying back and supplying passes works perfectly for the French strikers and Mbappé specifically. Him and Dembele can create chances and destroy defenses.

His ponytail bouncing about doesn't always come into the frame when a goal is scored. But Olise in a interview to Bayern had talked of his fashion interests. "One thing I'm going to enjoy about France is fashion. I'm someone who will dress up smartly even if I'm stepping out to buy bread!" he jokes. Eats and leaves no crumbs either, this Michael.

THE CARLO EFFECT

'Vincelotti' gives Brazil sceptics reason to believe in chances of glory again

At Real Madrid and now with five-time champions, Italian coach has repeatedly brought the best out of the young striker

Shuvaditya Bose
New Delhi, June 23

VINICIUS JUNIOR could scarcely conceal his delight after Brazil's 3-0 victory over Haiti on Saturday. When confronted with the inevitable question — what had changed after an unconvincing 1-1 stalemate against Morocco? — Vinicius offered a remarkably simple explanation: "Today I played in a different position. The coach asked me to."Carlo Ancelotti's role in rekindling Vinicius' interest in football cannot be debated. And neither can be his influence on the 25-year-old's performance against Haiti — a ricochet from his shot leading to Matheus Cunha's opener, a defence-splitting pass leading to the second, and finally, a goal to his name. Forty-five minutes of Vinicius being at his best. And all it needed was a minor adjustment from Ancelotti: "He (Ancelotti) asked me to play inside, between the two centre-backs. I don't usually play there, but whenever he tells me to drop back there, I score goals. I need to listen to him more. I'm sure that when he gets to the dressing room, he will say that he understands football really well."

That, he certainly does. One need not invoke his record five Champions League triumphs — most by a manager — to establish as much. Fortunately for Vinicius, the Italian also understands his game really well, and what facilitates its flourishing.

To be termed the 'New Neymar' in Brazil is hardly a distinction. Desperate to find a new superhero, the trophy-starved nation offers it to any kid who emulates a similar style. Vinicius, however, appeared a worthy heir. Despite making only two senior appearances for Flamengo, Real Madrid scout Juni Calafat deemed him worthy of a €46 million investment. Having lost Neymar to Barcelona, Madrid could scarcely afford another miscalculation.

Carlo Ancelotti (left) with Vinicius Junior. AP

And Vinicius chose the most well-trodden path of winning over rivals: performing at a derby. His brace prevented a defeat against Atletico Madrid B. But Julen Lopetegui found him too raw to be trusted on a regular basis, and Zinedine Zidane brought in his preferred winger, Eden Hazard. As for support from the teammates, there was barely any. Quite the contrary, in fact. At half-time during a match against Borussia Monchengladbach, Karim Benzema was reportedly caught telling Ferland Mendy, "Don't pass to him, brother. I swear he is playing against us."

In his first two seasons, Vinicius had 22 goal contributions in 69 matches. At a club like Real Madrid, coupled with the Euros debited, the numbers were damning. Then came Ancelotti.

That, dribbling came naturally to the player, was known. Extensively documented. But what was uncontainable in Brazil's junior leagues was inefficacious in La Liga. Vinicius often cut an isolated figure in games; disassociated from the play. Defenders could predict every move of the winger. Accordingly, an Ancelotti masterclass: dribbling would be an accessory in Vinicius' game, should need be, but not the centrepiece. That would be his pace and finishing instead.

Operating centrally in half-spaces, as opposed to being glued on the flanks, Vinicius would attack gaps between defenders and exploit them with his pace in transitions. Unsurprisingly, he was more involved in the game than ever before, and more efficacious, too. Under Ancelotti, Vinicius had 157 goal contributions in 198 matches — 0.79 per game; almost twice that of the corresponding figure without Ancelotti (0.40).

Despite his Real Madrid numbers, however, the ruthlessness vanished whenever he traded the white for Brazil's yellow. Only 12 goal contributions across 39 matches — under four managers in this period — would earn him scorn of the fervent fans. That has changed now. Under Ancelotti, he has nine goal contributions in merely 12 matches.

For Brazil, Vinicius has never been this pernicious on opponents. He has never been this devastating. When Brazilian polling institute Datafolha asked citizens whether they expect Seleção to win the trophy, only 29% responded in the affirmative. Should the number have increased, it will be for 'Vincelotti'.

India continue decade of dominance over Pakistan

Express News Service
Mumbai, June 23

IT WASN'T pretty how it ended, and Craig Fulton might not be pleased with the way India began. But India's strength on the ball in the two middle quarters, the second and third, was enough for them to eke out a 4-3 win over Pakistan in a breathless FIH Pro League contest in London on Tuesday. The win extended a remarkable run that has now seen India stay unbeaten against their arch-rivals for more than a decade.

The victory may have been worth three Pro League points, but it carried significance far beyond a single evening. With India and Pakistan drawn in the same pool at August's World Cup and also likely to cross paths at the Asian Games in September, Tuesday's encounter could be the first of several meetings between the rivals over the next 100 days. They will face each other again in the return Pro League fixture on June 26.

The Harmanpreet Singh-led side arrived in London with renewed confidence after an encouraging Dutch leg of the Pro League. On Sunday, India produced one of its best results of the season, defeating Netherlands 3-2 in Rotterdam. After struggling the whole year, the victory against the reigning Olympic champions and one of the favourites for this year's World Cup underlined India's ability.

Indian players celebrate a goal against Pakistan. FIH

Pakistan struck first on Tuesday. Ahmad Nadeem converted a penalty corner in the eighth minute. Abhishek levelled the scores in the 22nd minute with a sharp field goal before Nilakanta Sharma converted a penalty corner two minutes later to put India ahead. The turnaround ensured India carried a 2-1 advantage into half-time.

Animesh wants to regain 'fastest man' title even as Asiad qualification looms

Sprinter Animesh Kujur has a personal best of 10.15s in the 100m event. AFI

Pritish Raj
Bhubaneswar, June 23

"I WANT to be the fastest man in India again, that's the target," ace sprinter Animesh Kujur quipped in the pre-event press conference of the National Inter State Athletics Championships. "The target is to book my berth for the Asian Games," he said after returning from the Asian Relays Championships in Shaoxing, China.

Animesh set a new 100 metre record minutes after Gurindervir Singh lowered the mark at the Federation Cup in Ranchi last month, but the former came back strongly to win the final to become the first Indian to clock a sub 10.10-second time - 10.09S.

Kicking off tomorrow, the inter-state championships will be the selection trial for the Asian Games. Most of the top stars are here, barring a select few like Neeraj Chopra and decathlon specialist Tejaswin Shankar,

•Day 1 Finals

Men's 5000m	5:30 am
Men's pole vault	5:30 pm
Women's 5000m	07:20 pm
Women's 100m hurdles	07:55 pm

Animesh will need to run below 20.88s to qualify, something that he has done four times already this season. "This is my home turf and I am confident that I'll achieve the qualification here," he said.

Since 1986, no Indian pole vaulter has competed at the continental showpiece event. However, Dev Meena and Kuldeep Kumar, joint national record holders in the event, might be on the cusp of history.

"With the 5.45-metre mark already achieved at the Federation Cup, we know that history is not far from us," coach Ghansham Yadav, who trains both Dev and Kuldeep, told *The Indian Express*.

The duo has improved the national record three times this year. At the Federation Cup in Ranchi last month, first Dev vaulted 5.42metres to break the national record. Minutes later, Kuldeep vaulted 5.45m and Dev equalled it in the next attempt to become the joint holders. In March, Dev had set the record to 5.40m. Dev and Kuldeep have been named in the Commonwealth Games 2026 squad and will be the first Indian vaulters to compete at the event.

Jyothi Yarraji, 100m women's hurdles national record holder, is making a comeback after a year. Last year in June, Jyothi suffered an ACL injury, which ruled her out for the season.

She will aim to book her berth for the Asian Games in the event in which the qualifying mark is 13.34s. One of the best middle-distance runners in Asia, Gulveer Singh will be competing in India after two years. He is entered for the 1500m and 5000m.

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